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Clancys' separate civil suits pending

Mistrial's impact on malpractice cases questioned

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

Lindsay Clancy's murder trial ended without a resolution last week, but the mistrial raises a new question: What happens now to the separate medical malpractice lawsuits she and her ex-husband, Patrick Clancy, filed earlier this year?

Patrick Clancy's lawsuit — filed Jan. 20 on behalf of himself and the estates of his children, 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan — is pending, with its first hearing scheduled for Oct. 28 in Norfolk Superior Court. Lindsay Clancy's suit, filed a few days later, is also pending.

The parallel civil cases are not unusual, lawyers said, and they involve different legal questions from the criminal case. While the mistrial could delay the malpractice litigation, it does not determine whether the medical providers can be held liable for their treatment of Lindsay Clancy.

According to Patrick Clancy's lawsuit: Lindsay Clancy sought treatment for her deteriorating mental health, but her provid-

CLANCY, Page A9

The pilots of the Amazon cargo jet that overran a runway at Miami International Airport were not fully in control of the aircraft as it touched down and appeared to have temporarily considered aborting. **A2.**

Iran has signaled that it is willing to escalate its fight with the United States, with senior leaders issuing increasingly sharp warnings. **A3.**

The Trump administration said it would not cancel temporary humanitarian protections for more than 170,000 Salvadorans — for now. **A8.**



Wading game

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

A fourth-quarter Seattle interception in the end zone sealed the deal, as the Patriots lost 13-10 in the season opener. **C1.**

New season, familiar result

Patriots get another shot at Seahawks, but messy end leaves New England with a loss

SEATTLE — Disaster. Truly.

This was the kind of stuff that happened to the 20th-century Red Sox. Mike Torrez-Bucky Dent stuff. Buckner-esque, if you will.

Wednesday night in Seattle, just when it looked like Drake Maye and the Patriots were going to vaporize the Seattle Kryptonite, the quarterback imploded in spectacular fashion. It could hardly have been any worse.

Leading the team that thrashed

DAN SHAUGHNESSY
COMMENTARY

New England in February's Super Bowl, 10-0, midway through the third quarter, the Patriots gave up 13 consecutive points as Maye threw an interception on all three of his fourth-quarter drives.

The last one was the true killer. In easy field goal range, all the way at the Seattle 16 and readying to tie the game, Maye floated a ball to-

ward Mack Hollins in the right corner of the end zone, then watched in horror as Seattle corner Josh Jobe cut in front of Hollins, snared the pass, and came down inbounds for a game-clinching pick.

Ugh.
“We had the game under control, but we lost patience,” said Maye. “A couple of bad decisions on my part. It's unacceptable and I know that. That wasn't how I play football and how I want to play quarterback for the Patriots. I just stopped being pa-

tient.”

Maye did not have a multiple-interception game last year until Super Bowl LX, when the Seahawks got him twice. New England's franchise quarterback had a season-worst game in the biggest game, when he was sacked six times and turned it over three. After that loss, he said, “I'd like to go back to the beginning and re-do it.”

He had his chance Wednesday and finished with a flurry of blun-

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C5

‘I had to cut down on everything.’

CHRIS CONVENIENCIA, who makes about \$73,000 a year as a T operator

With enough drive, he makes ends meet

One in an occasional series exploring how the workers who make the Boston area the place that it is navigate the astronomical cost of living here.

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

The worker: Chris Conveniencia, 25, is an operator on the Green Line.

The job: Conveniencia, who grew up in Roxbury and Dorchester, started working at the T two years ago. He applied for the Green Line job after a stint working in building maintenance at a Marriott, and a series of low-paying gigs before that.

“Everybody always says, ‘Hey, the T is a good job. They have good benefits, pension, all that,’ ” he said.

After a training class to learn the ins and outs of operating the light rail, Conveniencia took to the tracks. “It's muscle memory now,” he said.

Conveniencia bounces between the line's branches on an often-



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Chris Conveniencia said he always tries to be a friendly face: “I know I'm helping everybody get to where they need to go.”

changing schedule, which is how he likes it. “You're always seeing something different,” he said, including the cast of characters that boards his trollies. He strives to be the friendly

face of an often-unfriendly transit system, taking pride in helping riders navigate diversions, giving tourists directions, and holding the

WICKED EXPENSIVE, Page A9

Jackson counting on deep roots in unions to give him a leg up in Maine

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

SKOWHEGAN, Maine — Troy Jackson has spent his first 45 days as a candidate for US Senate introducing himself to Maine voters as someone beyond the man who emerged from the wreckage of Graham Platner's campaign.

But inside the union hall of the United Steelworkers Local 9, Jackson needed no introduction. Arriving for a cookout last Sunday, he seemingly knew everyone wearing the shirt or hat of their union as he shared hamburgers and inside jokes.

That's because while Platner earned the support of the labor movement, Jackson has lived it. His ties with organized labor in Maine span decades, beginning when he was a preteen in the remote north woods of Allagash, watching his logger father participate in a strike.

“That really was the beginning for me of understanding more about working class issues and how we get left behind,” Jackson told the Globe in Skowhegan.

After becoming a logger himself, he experienced firsthand what he believed were unfair ac-

JACKSON, Page A8



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The Nation

NTSB: Pilots tried to abort in deadly crash

Miami accident of Amazon cargo plane killed five

By Karoun Demirjian and David Ovalle

NEW YORK TIMES

The pilots of the Amazon cargo jet that overran a runway at Miami International Airport on Sunday were not fully in control of the aircraft as it touched down and appeared to have temporarily considered aborting the landing, according to a timeline of the final seconds before the deadly crash that federal investigators unveiled late Tuesday.

The sequence of events detailed by National Transportation Safety Board investigators likely cost the pilots hundreds of feet of runway length and crucial seconds in the moments before the plane ran off the runway, striking two vehicles as it exited the airport grounds and crossed a public road, killing five before coming to a stop, according to aviation experts who reviewed the timeline.

“You either land or you go around. You don’t land, attempt to go around, and then get back to landing again, unless there was some mechanical malfunction,” said Steven Arroyo, an aviation expert and retired United Airlines pilot.

“I have never seen anything like this,” he added of the information that NTSB investigators

detailed Tuesday night.

The NTSB has yet to release a transcript from the cargo jet’s cockpit voice recorder, a readout of which they were expected to publicize Wednesday. Investigators were also expected to interview the aircraft pilots, according to Jennifer Homendy, the board chair.

During a news conference late Tuesday night, Chihoon Shin, the lead crash investigator, laid out a timeline of what happened during the last 30 seconds captured by the flight data recorder. Flight data recorders are designed to stop operating when the airplane’s electric power supply is cut off, as would happen during a crash.

The problems with the landing were apparent from the start of that timeline. At 30 seconds out, according to Shin, the plane’s nose landing gear and its right-side main landing gear touched down. At that point, the plane was traveling at nearly 182 miles per hour — faster than what is considered ideal for such planes, according to experts.

It would take another seven seconds before the pilots applied the brakes, and another four seconds after that before the left-side main landing gear would make contact with the runway, Shin said.

That touchdown sequence was “really bad,” said Michael O’Donnell, an aviation consultant who previously led the Fed-



REBECCA BLACKWELL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Officials inspected an Amazon cargo plane Tuesday, two days after it overshot a runway at Miami International Airport.

eral Aviation Administration’s aviation and airport safety divisions.

“The nose should not hit first,” he explained. “That is an unstable approach right there, and that really tells me that the go-around should have been executed a lot sooner and they weren’t in total control of the aircraft.”

But perhaps more critical was what the pilots tried to do next. Fifteen seconds before the recording ended — or four seconds after all their landing gear was on the runway — the pilots

released the brakes, and appeared to try to increase thrust, in what aviation experts said was a telltale sign of a “delayed decision” to abort the landing.

The plane was moving at 138 miles per hour when the brakes were released, and “throttles increased to values consistent with go-around thrust,” Shin said.

The pilots did not idle the throttles and reapply the brakes until 11 seconds before the recording ended, at which point the aircraft was moving at nearly 135 miles per hour, according to Shin. While the brakes remained

engaged for the rest of the recording, he added, the pilots never deployed the airplane’s speed brakes, which are flaps located on the wings, or its thrust reversers, both of which could have helped slow the aircraft.

“There’s all kinds of red flags with a go-around decision made that late,” O’Donnell said, adding, “If you do the math, that’s a lot of runway that went by while they were doing that.”

Investigators did not detail how close to the end of the runway the plane was at the junctures they identified.

“That’s something we still have to determine,” Homendy told reporters.

But at the ground speeds that NTSB investigators specified, the plane would have been moving down the runway at a pace of about 200 feet per second during those four seconds when the brakes were released. It is not clear if those roughly 800 feet, and the lost seconds of deceleration, might have allowed the plane to come to a stop before it struck the vehicles, or have made the difference between life and death for the victims.

‘I’m going to keep telling them what I know, what I saw, what I’ve been through.’

SAL ARGANO, the last of the firefighters assigned to the fire station across from the Twin Towers in 2001 who still works there

At NYC firehouse near Ground Zero, a last voice tells the tale

By Philip Marcelo

ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Sal Argano got lucky. When the World Trade Center was struck by hijacked jets on Sept. 11, 2001, the New York City firefighter was in Brooklyn, on loan to another station, rather than at his usual post at the small Manhattan firehouse just across an intersection from the twin towers.

He rushed downtown to find his firehouse badly damaged but still standing. Six of its members, he’d later learn, were among the 343 New York City firefighters killed in the World Trade Center’s collapse.

“If I wasn’t sent out on rotation there would have been a good chance I would not be here today,” Argano says. “I think about that all the time.”

Almost 25 years later, Argano, now 65, is still on duty at the firehouse — the last of the firefighters assigned there in 2001 who still works there.

Today, the crews at the firehouse respond to emergency calls but also serve as a de facto part of the 9/11 memorial, visited by crowds of tourists daily.



ANGELINA KATSANIS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Firefighter Sal Argano operated a firetruck on a recent run. “I’m not done. I’m gonna be here as long as I can,” he said.

Some visitors come specifically to see the large bronze relief along the side of the building listing the names of the firefighters killed on 9/11.

Others pause to take selfies as they pass by on their way to the National 9/11 Memorial plaza across the street, drawn by the sight of Engine 10 and Ladder 10, the gleaming trucks sitting in the garage that give the station its nickname: Ten House.

“This is definitely one of those companies where if you don’t want to ingratiate yourself to the public, it’s definitely not the right place,” said Captain Terence Brody, who commands Ladder 10 and has worked at the station since 2016. “People around the world know this firehouse. They’re going to come by and say hello.”

Brody, now 55, was still in the fire academy on 9/11. Cadets

grabbed their gear and were bused to ground zero.

The debris hung so thickly in the air around the fallen towers that it looked like it was snowing, he said.

“It was a beautiful sunny Tuesday, and then you’re in this kind of apocalyptic atmosphere,” Brody said. “It was a little overwhelming, to say the least.”

In the days after the attack, Ten House served as both command center and safe space for weary first responders, he said. As the years passed, its crew had a front-row seat to the area’s rebirth.

Robert Favata joined Ladder 10 in 2008, fresh out of the academy. In those early years, he worked beside a giant hole teeming with construction activity. Now 46, he looks out at a transformed landscape.

A pair of waterfall pools sit in the footprint of the old towers, ringed by parapets etched with the names of nearly 3,000 victims. Below ground, the 9/11 Museum houses mangled steel beams, a destroyed fire truck and other artifacts. New skyscrapers ring the memorial.

“When I got here, there was nothing,” Favata says. “I never thought they were gonna finish.”

Argano can be found most days perched near the station’s open bay doors, patiently answering questions, shaking hands, and posing for photos.

He says Ten House firefighters have a unique charge: They’re both living testimonials to the events of 9/11 as well as public faces of the centuries-old FDNY. Argano says he tries to impress on younger firefighters — many increasingly not even born before the attacks — the importance of treating every visitor with respect.

“This is not like any other firehouse,” he said. “We have our fire duty, we have our responses, and then we have a responsibility toward the people outside.”

He acknowledges the task is not always easy. The packs of gawking tourists can be relentless. Their questions can sometimes come across too personal, too insincere, or just simply too out there.

Many of the younger firefighters tend to keep a lower profile for that reason, he said.

After responding to an early morning call this particular day, most of the crew heads to the back of the station to stow their gear or upstairs to help prepare lunch. Argano meanwhile chats up a firefighter from France and his wife and then invites them into the station. At another point, though, a lady asks — perhaps a bit too flippantly — what’s so special about Ten House.

Argano shrugs: “It’s just a fire station.” After she departs, he says it simply wasn’t worth the effort. “If I need to explain to you all of that, then it’s like, ‘Pull up a seat,’” Argano said. “Let me get another cigarette. It’s gonna be a long one.”

Argano, who drives Engine 10, isn’t quite ready to pack it in. He fears something will be lost when no one is there who still remembers.

“I’m not done. I’m gonna be here as long as I can,” Argano said. “I’m going to keep telling them what I know, what I saw, what I’ve been through. Telling them the history of this firehouse. Everything I can remember.”

DAILY BRIEFING

Sinkhole opens near actor’s home

The city of Malibu, Calif., ordered the evacuation of more than 30 properties after a 30-foot-deep sinkhole opened Tuesday under the driveway of a luxury beachfront home that actor Nicolas Cage bought in 2024, causing a gas leak and sparking public safety concerns.

The city of Malibu said in a statement that the sinkhole was reported early Tuesday morning but was believed to have begun developing a day earlier. It said the expanding hole — which was 30 by 60 feet wide as of Tuesday evening — was restricting access for residents and emergency services.

The street is popular among celebrities because access to it is restricted, a listing agent said at the time of the purchase.

The city warned that Marie, a post-tropical cyclone, would continue to bring high tides and rain to the area, likely worsening conditions at the sinkhole site. The storm is expected to weaken and dissipate in the next two days as it moves into the Pacific Ocean.

The National Weather Service had issued a coastal flood advisory for Southern California over the Labor Day weekend, and local authorities said they were monitoring and responding to coastal erosion issues in the area.

NEW YORK TIMES

Tates’ bid for release is denied

Social media influencers Andrew and Tristan Tate must remain in custody as they fight extradition to the United Kingdom, where the brothers are accused of rape and sex trafficking, a federal judge in Miami ruled Wednesday.

US Magistrate Lauren Louie denied a defense motion for release, meaning the Tates will remain jailed during what could be a monthslong extradition process. The Tates failed to demonstrate that they do not present a flight risk or danger to the community or that special circumstances warrant their release, Louis said in her ruling.

“Having failed to meet

these three factors, Respondents’ Motion for Release Pending Extradition Proceedings is DENIED,” she said in the ruling.

The Tates’ legal team said in a statement that the decision to keep them in custody creates a legal contradiction.

The brothers are being detained in the United States because of a British extradition request while simultaneously being required to defend themselves against charges in Romania, the statement said.

The attorneys said they are considering whether to appeal the judge’s decision.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

2 astronauts take emeritus role

CAPE CANAVERAL, Fla. — The two NASA astronauts who led the Artemis II moonshot earlier this year are stepping away from spaceflight.

NASA said Wednesday that Artemis II commander Reid Wiseman and pilot Victor Glover will no longer serve as active astronauts but will continue to support the program as emeritus astronauts.

Glover has taken a leadership job at his alma mater, California Polytechnic State University, while Wiseman’s plans weren’t disclosed. They flew around the moon in April with two other astronauts, setting a new distance record for humanity.

Artemis II’s Jeremy Hansen

retired from the Canadian Space Agency in July. That leaves Christina Koch as the only crew member still on the active astronaut rolls.

As emeritus astronauts, Wiseman and Glover will donate their time to train and mentor NASA workers and share their knowledge for future moon missions.

“Together, they took on one of the most challenging missions in human spaceflight and helped return America to the lunar environment,” NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman said in a statement. “I’m grateful they will continue sharing what they learned.”

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DAILY BRIEFING

Yemen prison death toll at 23

CAIRO — Rescuers in Yemen pulled more bodies from the rubble Wednesday of a prison run by Iran-backed Houthi rebels that was hit in a deadly airstrike earlier this week, as an escalation between the rebels and a Saudi-led coalition threatened Yemen’s fragile ceasefire.

The renewed fighting is also threatening global oil shipments as the Houthis target shipping and oil infrastructure that’s helping keep oil flowing through the Red Sea while the US-Iran war has throttled shipments through the Strait of Hormuz on the opposite side of the Arabian Peninsula.

The prison in Hazm, the Jawf provincial capital, collapsed on Monday when coalition strikes hit the area, killing at least 23 people, including the four whose bodies were found Wednesday.

It wasn’t immediately known how many people were in the prison at the time of the strikes, which also left seven injured.

Following the strike Monday, the Houthis retaliated Tuesday with attacks on southern Saudi cities. The coalition responded Wednesday with more strikes on rebel-held areas. The Saudi-backed government forces advanced in the eastern part of Hazm on Wednesday, the military’s media office said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

UK man charged with aiding spies

LONDON — A British man was charged with assisting Russian military spies in a UK sabotage plot, prosecutors said Wednesday.

Joshua Cammidge, 31, was charged with engaging in conduct to materially assist a foreign intelligence service in carrying out activities in violation of the National Security Act.

Cammidge was arrested last week by counterterrorism police, but authorities didn’t disclose details about what act of sabotage he allegedly planned or intended to commit.

Security Minister Dan Jarvis said it was inappropriate to comment on the specifics of the case, but that police had acted against a potential threat.

“I know people will be concerned about recent incidents across Europe, intended to sow fear, create disruption and undermine support for Ukraine. They will not succeed,” Jarvis said. “We’ll continue to take whatever action is necessary to defend against the range of threats we face from Russia.”

Cammidge was in contact with a suspected representative of the GRU Volunteer Corps, a group controlled by Russia’s military intelligence agency, prosecutors said.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Far-right leader taunts chancellor

BERLIN — A leader of Alternative for Germany taunted Chancellor Friedrich Merz in parliament Wednesday after it thrashed his party in a regional election. The German leader countered that the far-right party won’t win a majority in the country, assailing its stance toward Ukraine and rhetoric on migration.

AFD’s national co-leader, Alice Weidel, told Merz as she opened the annual budget debate in parliament that “in Saxony-Anhalt, people didn’t just punish you, they pulverized your party.”

“You haven’t understood the message that voters in Saxony-Anhalt sent you on Sunday,” she said. “But that isn’t relevant because your time has run out anyway. Citizens want a change of policy and they will get it.”

A combative Merz responded that AFD’s state election result was “remarkable” but noted the party said it would only govern with an absolute majority and then missed that target.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



MARKUS SCHREIBER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ROYAL FAREWELL — Police officers were reflected in a window with a display showing Norway’s late King Harald V prior to his funeral in Oslo on Wednesday. Crowds lined the streets and foreign royals and leaders converged on Oslo for the funeral of the long-serving king, who was remembered as a popular monarch with a down-to-earth touch.

Iran signals readiness to escalate fight

Recent clashes threaten to ignite a full-blown war

By Erika Solomon

NEW YORK TIMES

Iran has signaled that it is willing to escalate its fight with the United States, with senior leaders increasingly sharp warnings in recent days after attacking US warships for the first time.

The country’s leaders are taking a more aggressive approach as Iran faces mounting economic pressure and they worry that their grip on the Strait of Hormuz is slipping. The US blockade is making it nearly impossible for Iran to ship oil, its main money source. And in effect, Iran sees escalation as the primary leverage it has against the United States, analysts said, warning that the recent clashes could reignite a full-blown war.

The US military said Tuesday that it had destroyed five Iranian oil tankers in retaliation for attempted strikes on a US Navy warship, while Iran said it launched strikes at a base used by US forces in Jordan in response. The attacks occurred three days after Iran made its first known attempt at striking a US military vessel.

On Sunday, Mohammed Bagher Qalibaf, Iran’s lead negotiator and the speaker of parliament, told lawmakers that the era of “proportionate responses” to US attacks was over. Iran’s security chief, Mohsen Rezaei, also announced plans to impose a “restricted zone” for shipping in the Persian Gulf that would go beyond the country’s efforts to control the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran has largely withstood the heavy military campaign launched by the United States and Israel in February. But the war of attrition in recent months has created an economic threat that is now pushing the government to intensify its rhetoric and attacks.

A US naval blockade has prevented Tehran from exporting much of its oil, the country’s main source of revenue, making a longstanding economic crisis even worse. On Tuesday, the government raised some gasoline prices because of fuel shortages, a move that is expected to further roil a country already struggling with soaring inflation and unemployment, and a rapidly depreciating currency.

At the same time, US naval escorts have enabled a trickle of oil tankers to pass through the Strait of Hormuz, undercutting Iran’s closure of the waterway, which has caused global oil



US NAVY/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

A sailor stood on the flight deck of Arleigh Burke-class guided-missile destroyer USS Mason last week. Iran has established a new “prohibited zone” beyond the Strait of Hormuz.

UN nuclear watchdog makes rare move

By Stephanie Liechtenstein

ASSOCIATED PRESS

VIENNA — The UN atomic watchdog’s board on Wednesday reported Iran to the UN Security Council for the first time in 20 years, citing it for failure to cooperate in a long-running investigation into uranium traces detected by inspectors at undeclared sites.

Western officials suspect that the traces could provide evidence that Iran had a secret nuclear weapons program until 2003. Iran says that it’s not pursuing nuclear weapons, and that its program is entirely peaceful.

Reporting Iran to the Security Council opens the country to possible sanctions and asset freezes, though such punitive measures are unlikely because Iran’s allies Russia and China hold veto power on the panel.

Twenty-three countries on the International Atomic

Energy Agency’s 35-member board of governors voted for Wednesday’s resolution at IAEA headquarters in Vienna.

China, Russia, and Niger opposed it, while eight countries abstained and one didn’t vote as it was in arrears, according to diplomats who spoke on condition of anonymity to describe the outcome of the closed-door vote.

The resolution was put forward by the United States, Britain, France, and Germany.

The diplomatic move has been under consideration since June 2025, when the IAEA board found Iran officially in noncompliance with its nonproliferation obligations because of Tehran’s lack of cooperation in the investigation.

Iran’s ambassador to the UN in Vienna, Reza Najafi, rejected the resolution, describing it as a “political tool” and saying that it ru-

to full-out war. “It’s highly damaging, but at the same time, they hope it raises global oil prices or fully recloses the Strait of Hormuz,” he said.

Senior Iranian officials have said they are open to negotiating a return to the fragile Memorandum of Understanding that halted the war in April and was meant to lead to talks on an Iranian nuclear deal.

But President Trump has said he has no interest in negotiations, preferring to maintain his strategy of attrition and suf-

ined confidence in the IAEA’s “independence, impartiality and credibility.”

He suggested that compliance with any obligation to allow UN inspections of nuclear sites inside Iran was, in any case, impossible at the moment because of the country’s continuing war with the United States and Israel.

The United States this week destroyed five Iranian oil tankers and Tehran hit back at American targets in Jordan, the latest burst of back-and-forth strikes that have lurched the sides back toward open hostilities in a more than 6-month-old war.

The draft resolution, which was seen by the Associated Press, requested IAEA Director General Rafael Grossi to report the agency’s concerns “to the Security Council and the General Assembly of the United Nations, in accordance with the relevant provisions of the IAEA Statute.”

focusing Iran economically.

Iran’s leadership believes that now may be the best moment to raise the stakes, before the US midterm elections in November, when an unpopular war could hurt Trump and the Republican Party.

“All signs point to a make-or-break moment,” said Mohammad Ali Shabani, an Iran analyst and editor of the regional news website Amwaj.media. “I’m not sure the Iranians are going to wait until after the elections to be attacked if diplo-

macy fails.”

Iran’s move to strike two US warships with ballistic missiles was a significant escalation, said Hamidreza Azizi, a senior Iran analyst at the International Crisis Group.

Iranian forces had previously made no serious effort to target US naval ships and seemed reluctant to conduct attacks that could cause heavy American casualties. “These calculations have obviously changed,” he said.

The US decision to retaliate by striking three Iranian oil tankers — and sinking one of them — was an indication of how seriously Washington took the Iranian attack.

“Both sides are trying to dictate their red lines and trying to push the red lines of the other side as far back as they can,” Azizi said.

It was also a recognition that Iran’s military capabilities have evolved. Before the war started, the United States did not think Iran could target US military bases in the region with precision, he said.

But in recent months, Iran has shown it can do so, including with a strike on a US base in Jordan in July that killed two American soldiers.

Iran has also been very public about its efforts to capture and learn from its enemy’s weapons. On Tuesday, Iran’s state news agency IRNA announced that naval forces of the powerful Revolutionary Guard had seized a US submarine drone known as the Dive-LD. Iran has previously managed to reverse-engineer weapons offered to it by its allies or captured from its enemies.

US Central Command said the drone was an older model that had malfunctioned and “neither collected sensitive data nor carried any classified sonar or radar equipment.”

For Iran’s leaders, what they have called a US “economic war” has become a domestic security risk that has prompted them to take a more aggressive stance.

A rising sense of economic despair among Iranians could spark a new wave of antigovernment protests. Last December, a currency crisis triggered nationwide demonstrations, which security forces crushed with deadly force.

Iranian officials are anxious that Israel may exploit any discontent to support dissidents or an insurgency, said Hadi Borhani, a professor of Israeli and Middle East studies at the University of Tehran.

He pointed to recent statements by Israel’s defense minister, Israel Katz, and Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, who said this week that “there is still more to complete.”

US targets ‘refueling’ vessels off Ecuador coast

Resumes strikes against alleged drug trafficking

By Annie Correal and Eric Schmitt
NEW YORK TIMES

A year into its military boat strike campaign, the United States appears to be targeting a new type of vessel — large fishing boats off the coast of Ecuador that the Trump administration says provide fuel to smaller vessels carrying drugs.

On Tuesday night, the US military announced the sixth such operation in two weeks, posting a video that showed a helicopter hovering over the ocean and military troops boarding a large fish-

ing boat to remove the crew, followed by the boat exploding.

US Southern Command said the boat, like five other large vessels it destroyed off Ecuador's coast since Aug. 28, functioned as a “floating refueling station,” restocking the kind of fast boats that the US military has attacked in lethal boat strikes that have killed more than 220 people since they began a year ago.

The Trump administration has claimed, without providing evidence, that the boats are carrying drugs. Experts in laws governing the lethal use of force say the strikes are illegal because the US military is not permitted to target civilians who pose no threat of imminent violence, even if they are committing a crime.

The string of strikes on larger

vessels comes amid a resumption of strikes on smaller boats allegedly carrying drugs after a two-month lull. Secretary of State Marco Rubio is traveling to Ecuador on Wednesday as part of a three-country trip to South America, with security and military cooperation against drug-trafficking groups at the top of his agenda.

Ecuador's president, Daniel Noboa, who is expected to meet with Rubio, was the first leader in the region to enter into an agreement with the United States to allow joint military operations.

Officials have said the larger fishing vessels targeted in the last two weeks — some in coordination with Ecuadorian forces — were linked to the Los Choneros gang, which the United States has designated a foreign terror-

ist organization.

Current and former US military officials say that sinking the larger refueling boats is a more effective way of targeting the drug-smuggling infrastructure of criminal groups than blowing up smaller vessels.

Taking aim at the larger boats has the added advantage of not killing crew members. Lethal boat strikes have faced fierce criticism from Congress, international leaders, and rights groups.

In each case, US troops have boarded the boats and removed the crew members, whom US authorities have said are turned over to Ecuadorian authorities. Then, US troops attach explosives to the vessels and blow them up.

US Southern Command said in a statement that “these inter-

dictions cut off critical nodes in the narcotics logistics network” and advanced the administration's goals of applying “total systemic friction against narco-terrorists.” The military's other boat strike campaign, the statement said, “continued unchanged.”

Ecuador's government did not respond to a request for comment on the recent strikes.

The Trump administration's explanation for its military boat strikes has shifted over time.

US officials originally said the strikes were intended to target a Venezuelan gang in the months before the United States captured Venezuela's former president, Nicolás Maduro.

The administration later broadened its justification, explaining to Congress that Presi-

dent Donald Trump had determined the United States was under attack by trafficking groups and that all traffickers were therefore enemy combatants.

In recent months, the Trump administration has moved to further militarize the fight against traffickers both at sea and on land in Latin America, urging ideologically aligned leaders to allow joint operations with the United States and to aggressively deploy their own security forces.

Despite widespread questions about the strikes' legality, US officials appear unbowed. On Sept. 2, US Southern Command posted a message commemorating one year since the boat strike operation began and declaring, “The Western Hemisphere is no longer a safe haven for narco-terrorism.”



FRANCISCO SECO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Liudmyla Ryzhak (right) and Leonid Ryzhak got ready in their damaged apartment for their wedding in Kyiv early Tuesday.

Ukraine pair weds, gains ‘new life’ amid war

Home damaged hours before by Russian strike

By Hanna Arhirova and Vasilisa Stepanenko
ASSOCIATED PRESS

KYIV — On the eve of her wedding, Liudmyla Ryzhak pressed her delicately embroidered dress, laid out a full white tulle skirt and her soon-to-be husband's traditionally patterned shirt, then hung them on the bedroom door.

After repeated delays caused by the war with Russia, she was only hours away from marrying her partner, a 43-year-old Ukrainian soldier, in a ceremony in the capital.

But as the couple slept, a Russian strike hit a warehouse across the street from their building, sending a blast wave through the apartment and threatening to stop the wedding scheduled for Tuesday morning.

The pair were soon digging their wedding clothes out of the rubble. Ryzhak, 33, had to pull her skirt from beneath the debris, shaking off pieces of broken glass.

The strike came soon after US envoys visited Ukraine on Sunday, a trip that brought a lull in Russian attacks. The assaults

then resumed with drones and missiles. Explosions were heard in Kyiv for almost five hours overnight. Strikes continued during the day Tuesday.

Like many others in Kyiv, the couple decided the attacks would not derail their lives and forged ahead with the ceremony. It had taken a long time for her fiancé, Leonid Ryzhak, to make it back from the front lines in eastern Ukraine.

“If God gave me a continuation of life, then why should I put it off?” the bride said. “For someone, it ended. And who can guarantee this won't happen again tomorrow? That tomorrow won't come for us? At least for now, I have the right to be happy. Both him and me.”

Liudmyla and Leonid awoke from the blast, which blew out the apartment's windows and scattered its furniture. A burned curtain hung in shreds.

Their ears deafened by the explosion, the couple's only immediate thought was the risk of a second strike. They fled to a shelter with Liudmyla's 6-year-old daughter and two guinea pigs but without the cat, which had hidden in fright and could not be found.

They were lucky: By the time the second strike hit, they were already safe. The apartment was

rendered uninhabitable until repairs are made.

The two met three years ago through mutual friends, coming together as adults who weren't looking for anything serious. Both had children from previous marriages.

But the friendship deepened. She supported him through his deployments, and slowly the relationship grew into love. Leonid Ryzhak, who serves as part of a team that deploys bomber drones in the Pokrovsk area, arrived in Kyiv for a long-awaited vacation a week and a half earlier, just as near-constant air-raid alerts and daytime attacks began disrupting life in the capital.

For six days straight, the couple went to the registry office but could not submit their documents because of constant air-raid sirens.

When they finally succeeded, they were assigned Sept. 8. Nobody could have predicted that their apartment would be badly damaged on the same day.

When they stepped outside their apartment, the courtyard looked almost apocalyptic, with a column of black smoke rising behind a brightly colored children's playground. Neighbors clearing debris stopped to congratulate the couple.

The couple arrived at the reg-

istry office on time, at 10:40 a.m.

In place of black dress pants, Leonid wore army trousers — he couldn't dig his own out of the rubble. Liudmyla's white tulle overlay had tiny, barely visible holes that were torn as she pulled it out from the rubble.

Shortly after they arrived, a siren sounded: Another attack had begun, and the registry office closed for safety. The couple waited in the courtyard, unsure how long it would last.

Explosions echoed nearby as strikes hit surrounding districts and fires broke out. Almost three hours passed before the alert finally ended, and the couple hurried back inside.

Just before entering the hall for the ceremony, they paused, trading nervous jokes.

“I've never had such a spectacular day,” the bride said.

The ceremony went ahead, and moments later, the two were officially married.

“We're gaining a new life, because we survived,” Liudmyla said. “You could probably call [it] a new life because it could have ended today, and none of this would happen.”

In a different scenario, “I wouldn't be wearing this dress. Someone would be picking out something else for me instead, something darker.”

Bangladesh struggles to fight measles outbreak

1,000 dead as vaccination rate recently dropped

By Julhas Alam and Al Emrun Garjon
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DHAKA, Bangladesh — Eight-month-old Rojaton Jannat Ramisa is struggling to breathe in a hospital in Bangladesh's capital as her parents sit helplessly beside her. She's one of thousands of children sickened by a measles outbreak that's sweeping across the country and has killed hundreds of children following setbacks to the country's vaccine program.

Ramisa's mother Ranu Akhter traveled hundreds of miles after doctors in eastern Bangladesh referred her to a specialized child hospital in Dhaka to seek treatment for the life-threatening condition.

“Fourteen days ago, when we were at the district hospital, there were other children being treated alongside my daughter. I saw that those children also had red rashes on their bodies, sores in their mouths, and fevers,” Akhter said at Dhaka Shishu Hospital.

“It made me realize how widespread the measles outbreak is,” she said.

Every day, the death toll is rising.

Bangladesh has been racing to halt the outbreak's spread since March, when more than 100 children died in less than a month. By Tuesday, the death toll from suspected measles cases reached 999 since the start of

the year, according to the government's Directorate General of Health Services.

Since March, the country has recorded more than 166,000 suspected measles cases, including 19,835 laboratory-confirmed infections, according to the Ministry of Health.

The government launched an emergency vaccination drive in March together with the World Health Organization, the UN children's agency and the Gavi vaccine alliance. It began with a focus on children from 6 months to 5 years old and later expanded nationwide in phases.

Measles is a highly contagious airborne disease that causes fever, respiratory symptoms, and a characteristic rash. It can sometimes have severe or fatal complications, especially in young children, according to the WHO.

Two doses of a vaccine provide strong protection against measles, but the WHO says 95 percent of the population has to be vaccinated in order to stop the disease from spreading — which protects children like Ramisa who are too young to be vaccinated as well as immunocompromised people.

About 86 percent of children in Bangladesh got their recommended second dose of measles vaccine last year, according to an estimate by the World Health Organization and UNICEF. That's down from 93 percent in 2024. A few years ago, Bangladesh had measles largely under control, but in the last few years, disruptions to the vaccine program have left a growing number of children unvaccinated.



MAHMUD HOSSAIN OPU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Young patients and family members at an overcrowded hospital in Dhaka, Bangladesh, Tuesday.

Airlines scramble after UK air traffic control outage

By Danica Kirka
ASSOCIATED PRESS

LONDON — Airlines scrambled Wednesday to dig out of the backlog triggered by technical problems experienced by the United Kingdom's air traffic control system that has forced the cancellation of more than 2,000 flights.

Delays continued for a second day Wednesday, rippling across 15 UK airports and beyond as airlines and airports worked to clear a huge backlog of canceled and delayed flights. The problems stranded passengers for hours on airport runways and in terminals.

Flight delays were expected to continue through the day Wednesday as airlines rebook

stranded passengers and work to reposition aircraft left at the wrong airports by the cancellations.

NATS, formerly known as National Air Traffic Services, which operates the UK air traffic control system, attributed the problems to “an issue in our flight processing system.” The company said that it was supporting airlines and airports while they recover from the “ongoing disruption,” although the original technical issue was resolved Tuesday afternoon.

But airlines were furious, demanding that the head of NATS, Martin Rolfe, consider resigning after the second air traffic meltdown in three years.

UK Transport Secretary Hei-

di Alexander met with Rolfe on Wednesday and gave him one week to complete a full investigation into the incident to make sure lessons are learned. Prime Minister Andy Burnham's office said that Rolfe retains the confidence of the government.

The UK government owns 49 percent of NATS, making it the largest shareholder and giving it a veto over key decisions. Airlines, airports, investors, and employees own the remaining shares in the public-private partnership.

Rolfe on Wednesday apologized for the inconvenience caused by the outage, but said that the UK air traffic control system remains one of the safest and most efficient in the

world.

“Our job is also to make sure that people stay safe,” he told the BBC. “We never do this lightly. We only ever do it when there is an issue that cannot be resolved quickly, and we have to take action to make [sure] those who are flying, who are in the air at that time, are safe. And when we can restore these incredibly complex systems, we do so as quickly as we can.”

Meanwhile, passengers were left to fend for themselves.

Charlie Adlard, a 60-year-old cartoonist who worked on the “Walking Dead” comic book series, was traveling from his home in western England to a comic book convention in Palermo, Sicily, when his trip was up-

ended by the air traffic issues. After running into the chaos at Heathrow Airport in London, he tried and failed to reach his carrier, British Airways, by phone.

“Due to the lack of information, due to everything crashing now, due to the fact that apparently BA have now switched off their customer service phone number because there's so many calls, we're not really sure what to do,” Adlard said.

After losing a day of work, spending money on an airport hotel and paying for dinner and breakfast, he decided to turn around and go home.

“So yeah, I've lost quite a bit of money on this rather wasteful journey,” Adlard said.

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KEVIN DIETSCH/GETTY IMAGES

On Wednesday, attendees clapped at the 2026 Republican National Convention at the American Airlines Center in Dallas.

GOP begins ‘Trump-a-Palooza’ convention

Many expected to skip, citing other obligations

By Jill Colvin and Will Weissert
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DALLAS — Republicans opened their highly unusual midterm convention in Dallas on Wednesday afternoon, a “Trump-a-Palooza” that is putting the president at the center of this fall’s midterm elections — whether the candidates running like it or not.

Many party members, including those facing tight races, are skipping the two-day affair, citing conflicting obligations or balking at demands that they pony up for access. Others are hoping an appearance alongside President Trump will put them in the national spotlight as they

work to turn out his voters with-out him on the ballot.

The convention, which is part rally and part fund-raiser, comes as Republicans try to boost enthusiasm heading into the midterms’ final stretch despite Trump’s low approval ratings. Much of the programming will focus on Democrats, trying to cast them as extremists by highlighting the party’s insurgent left wing, while portraying Republicans as the party of “common sense.”

Coinciding with the gathering, Trump’s political operation, which has been sitting on hundreds of millions of dollars, began spending heavily through a new group, the No Going Back PAC Inc., The New York Times first reported Wednesday. The group has reserved \$47 million in six competitive Senate races and one competitive House race.

That’s in addition to the \$10 million that MAGA Inc., Trump’s super PAC, has spent on the Texas Senate race.

Normal political conventions are held every four years and serve a purpose beyond pomp and circumstance, with parties formally nominating their presidential picks. In 2024, Trump used the opportunity to announce JD Vance as his running mate.

The schedule this week released by organizers makes clear that the convention will be The Trump Show, through and through.

“It’s gonna be a Trump-a-Palooza,” RNC chairman Joe Gruters told Spectrum News.

Boarding Air Force One to fly to Dallas, Trump said: “We’re going to have a tremendous crowd tonight.”

But he also told reporters that oil prices — which have

surged because of the Iran war — likely won’t come down until after the midterms, a bit of economic forecasting that could darken his party’s fortunes.

“Right after the election, oil prices are going to be tumbling downward,” he promised.

Trump’s comments came as oil prices jumped more than 3 percent Wednesday, pushing international Brent crude past the \$100 threshold.

Trump speaks both nights, delivering a keynote address on Wednesday night and speaking again on Thursday, after Vance gives his own address.

“Look, he’s an entertainer, right? He obviously loves big, big events and his career has been built around that,” said Ray Washburne, cochair of the Dallas host committee, at an event hosted by Bloomberg News. “He’s always front and center.”

A new accuser alleges sex abuse by Chavez in ’70s

Lawsuit says affiliated groups were negligent

By Manny Fernandez and Sarah Hurtes
NEW YORK TIMES

A longtime volunteer with the United Farm Workers claims in a new lawsuit that Cesar Chavez, the civil rights leader, raped her one night in the 1970s at the union’s headquarters in central California.

The woman’s suit, filed last week in state court in California, accuses nonprofit groups affiliated with the Chavez family and the UFW of negligence, sexual harassment, and violations of state civil rights laws. It appears to be the first such suit of its kind since an investigation by The New York Times published in March found compelling evidence that Chavez had sexually abused, assaulted, and harassed underage girls and adult women as he built the most influential farmworkers union in the United States.

The suit illustrates the legal and financial risks faced by groups with ties to Chavez in the aftermath of the revelations, particularly as California has in recent years extended the statute of limitations for victims of sexual assault to file lawsuits to include assaults that occurred decades ago.

California allows victims to sue not only perpetrators but also institutions that knew or should have known about abuse. Other women, some of whom have made their accusations against Chavez public, say they are also considering legal action.

The Cesar Chavez Foundation, one of the nonprofits that was named in the lawsuit, said in a statement that it had only

recently become aware of it.

“We are reviewing with our legal counsel and will respond in a way that stays true to our mission and values,” the statement said.

The other nonprofit that was sued, the UFW Foundation, which is a separate organization from the farmworkers union, did not respond to requests for comment. A spokesperson for the UFW declined to comment.

In the lawsuit, which the woman filed anonymously as Jane Doe, she describes a previously unreported attack by Chavez in 1973. The woman, whose family lived and worked in Chavez’s compound for years, has spoken to the Times repeatedly over the past five years, and told her story on the condition that she not be named for fear of retaliation against her and her family.

She is the second woman to publicly accuse Chavez of raping them when they were adults. The other is Dolores Huerta, his UFW cofounder and one of the most prominent Latina activists in the country.

Two other women, Ana Murguia and Debra Rojas, said Chavez had molested and assaulted them when they were underage from around 1972 to 1977, starting at the ages of 12 and 13.

The accusations by Huerta and the others this year set off a national reckoning over the legacy of Chavez, who became one of the most significant Latino figures in American history and who died in 1993 at 66. California has renamed the state holiday known as Cesar Chavez Day to Farmworkers Day, as officials around the country removed Chavez’s name from schools and streets, and covered or took down murals and statues bearing his likeness from college campuses and local parks.

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The Boston Globe

Jackson counting on deep union roots in Maine

► **JACKSON**
Continued from Page A1

tions by big conglomerates that wanted to use cheaper Canadian labor over Maine workers — and then ran for office out of outrage. Along the way, he joined five unions; he currently is a dues-paying member of three, the biggest national unions representing engineers, machinists, and painters.

The organized labor movement, and its fundamental vision of working class solidarity overcoming the abuses and predations of entrenched power and capital, is inseparable from Jackson’s own deeply held vision. At its core, it fits on a bumper sticker: “We are not from the left. We are not from the right. We’re from the bottom, and we are rising,” he has said.

On Jackson’s car, a venerable Dodge minivan he drives himself on the campaign trail, he doesn’t have a sticker for his own campaign — just one that says “SOLIDARITY.”

Without the labor movement, he likely also wouldn’t be in the campaign right now. When Platner dropped out of the race in July, Jackson’s labor allies organized so effectively and quickly on his behalf that the nominating convention a few weeks later became a fait accompli.

To hear them tell it, going all-in for Jackson was not even a thought: he had done the same for them.

“For him, it’s not a transactional relationship,” Francis Eanes, the executive director of the Maine Labor Climate Council, said at a Lewiston brewery where supporters sang karaoke to Dolly Parton’s “9 to 5.” “He’ll leave the campaign trail and come to our organizing events. He’ll be the first one on the picket line, even at 5 a.m., before the camera people show up.”

It’s a conspicuous moment for a campaign like Jackson’s. Nationally, the labor movement is finding fresh blood and new champions to reverse decades of decline. This midterm election, which will be defined by voters’ suffering over rising costs, offers an especially favorable environ-



SOPHIE PARK/NEW YORK TIMES

Troy Jackson, shown at the Democratic convention in Bangor, has emphasized working-class voters on the campaign trail.

ment for organized labor’s pitch.

And Democrats have been anxious to find candidates who can reconnect with the working class — in Maine, some had believed they had one in Platner.

Jackson’s performance against Senator Susan Collins, then, could become a signal of just how potent a playbook of labor-centered, working class politics is for Democrats in this era.

The significance of the race is so obvious to the national labor movement that one of its highest-profile leaders, AFL-CIO president Liz Shuler, traveled to Maine to spend Labor Day campaigning with Jackson.

“Troy Jackson winning would prove our theory of the case that people want people in office who speak their language, who can actually make a positive change on the issues that matter to everyday working people,” Shuler said on the eve of Labor Day in Orono, where the

University of Maine graduate workers union gathered for a contra dance event to benefit Jackson.

Jackson’s diagnosis of Democrats’ recent woes with the working class is simple: “Overall, we quit talking about economics,” he said. He acknowledged that some voters fled the party in favor of the GOP over perceptions that Democrats had gone too far on social issues.

“I’m asked all the time about transgender people and stuff like that. I’m not going to demonize them. I’m not going to leave them behind,” said Jackson. “But we kind of quit talking about everyday working class issues, and that’s where the problem is.”

Before being term-limited out of his state Senate seat in far northern Maine, Jackson was winning a district that had long since broken for President Trump — something he attributes to his longstanding, con-

sistent emphasis on economic issues.

“Some people don’t believe the Democratic Party is fighting for working class people,” he said. “I don’t agree with that.”

In front of crowds, he is a halting orator who does not go in depth about other issues of national import — though at several campaign Q-and-A appearances he didn’t leave until every guest asked a question.

But Jackson’s Labor Day weekend swing through the state, packed almost exclusively with labor-oriented events, was a timely opportunity to play to strengths. On Saturday, he held a town hall in Jay, the site of a high-profile 1980s strike by the United Paperworkers union at the Androscoggin Mill. Some attendees at Jackson’s event were personally impacted by the episode.

At a South Portland coffee shop on Sunday morning, Jackson met with nurses, whose

cause — legislation to lower nurse-to-patient ratios in hospitals — he pushed as state Senate president.

Later, in Orono, Jackson spoke with members of UMaine’s graduate workers union, who credit his support in their nearly two-year battle with the university for a contract, which concluded successfully last year. “Now it’s our turn to show up for him,” said psychology doctorate student Aurora Green, the president of the union.

Many in the Maine union world shared similar stories about Jackson; over his long career in the state legislature, he was their most reliable ally.

“Troy was standing shoulder to shoulder with us well before the Senate or governor’s race,” said Amanda Gavin, a professor who was a leader of the drive to organize UMaine grad workers and faculty in 2022. “That’s what gives him street cred.”

An undercurrent to labor’s

support for Jackson is the belief that his position can’t be taken for granted. Collins, who has won major labor endorsements before, has a friendlier record toward organized labor than most Republicans: she had a 44 percent score from the AFL-CIO last year, compared to a 4 percent average from her GOP colleagues. But Collins is not a supporter of some of labor’s key legislative priorities, like the PRO Act, a sweeping bill meant to strengthen protections for collective organizing and bargaining.

The labor world is hardly a monolith, however. Bath Iron Works shipyard workers have expressed support for Collins in this campaign, but the local union representing them has not endorsed. The national organization backs Jackson.

The Collins campaign did not return a request for comment.

Democrats don’t hold unanimous positions on labor, either — another reason why unions are enthusiastically mobilizing for Jackson. Governor Janet Mills, who many once expected would be the party’s nominee to take on Collins, clashed often with labor interests, as well as Jackson himself, during her two terms as governor.

Still, while Jackson focuses on Collins, Platner’s shadow remains hard to shake. Speaking to crowds, Jackson almost always acknowledges the unusual, and for some people painful, circumstances around his rise to the Senate nomination.

Amid roiling debates within the party about what it means to have authentically working class candidates, there is a sense among some Democrats that Jackson — though less polished and dynamic as a candidate than Platner — is the real deal.

What Platner perhaps was pitching himself as, said Gavin, “that is who Troy really is.”

“He is the working class champion,” she said, “we needed all along.”

Sam Brodey can be reached at sam.brodey@globe.com. Follow him @sambrodey.

Mo. voting map back before high court

JEFFERSON CITY, Mo. — A battle over Missouri’s congressional districts vaulted back to the US Supreme Court on Wednesday, two months before a pivotal November election that will determine control of Congress and affect the fate of President Trump’s agenda.

A series of conflicting court rulings has left a scar on Missouri — and left voters befuddled and unsure which US House districts they will be voting in and which candidates will appear on their ballots.

A federal appeals court panel on Wednesday sided with Republicans, declining to halt a federal judge’s order favoring a new map backed by Trump. But that decision immediately was appealed to the Supreme Court, which just a day earlier had let stand a ruling by Missouri’s top court against the Trump-backed districts.

Time is rapidly expiring to figure it out. Federal law sets a Sept. 19 deadline to mail absentee ballots to overseas citizens and military voters.

Redistricting opponents collected hundreds of thousands of petition signatures seeking to force a statewide vote on the new districts. They submitted the signatures in December. But Republican Secretary of State Denny Hoskins waited until August — on the same day as Missouri’s primary — to reject the petition. Hoskins asserted that a referendum petition could not be used for congressional redistricting.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Trump gave cash gifts to White House aides

WASHINGTON — President Trump provided a “cash gift for the holidays” to three White House aides last year, handing out \$45,000 each to his executive assistant Natalie Harp and two other employees who work in the West Wing, according to financial disclosure forms.

The money raises questions



JACQUELYN MARTIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

FLIGHT DELAY — President Trump boarded Air Force One after an emergency inflatable slide deployed before he arrived at Joint Base Andrews, Md., on Wednesday. It was not immediately clear whether the slide was intentionally inflated during testing or whether an error caused it to inflate.

about whether the gifts violate the federal government’s policy against political appointees receiving bonuses.

Besides Harp, the money went to Margo Martin, his communications adviser; and Chamberlain Harris, the deputy director of Oval Office operations.

The president also gave \$20,000 to Walt Nauta, a longtime aide who was charged alongside him in the 2023 federal prosecution over mishandling classified documents at Mar-a-Lago. Prosecutors dropped the case against Nauta after Trump took back the presidency.

Government employees are generally prohibited from accepting outside salaries.

Last year, the Trump administration issued guidance about bonuses, instructing agencies to “reward bonuses to only the highest performers” among their workforces. But in that same guidance, the administration made it clear that no bonuses were to be awarded to political appointees.

A White House statement

posted on social media said Trump had a “long-standing practice of giving Christmas gifts to people in his orbit. The gifts at issue here have nothing to do with any of these individuals’ official government duties and, therefore, are entirely permissible under relevant legal and ethical standards.”

Kedric L. Payne, general counsel and senior director of ethics at Campaign Legal Center, pointed out that federal criminal law prohibits government employees from receiving any bonus or other compensation for their official work from a nongovernment source.

“These cash payments that the president describes as gifts appear to violate the spirit of the law at the very least,” Payne said.

NEW YORK TIMES

Poll: Americans more skeptical of government

WASHINGTON — Americans are more skeptical of government information than they were a few years ago, with majorities now saying they have lit-

tle or no trust in federal government information about elections and politics, foreign affairs, or the environment, a new poll finds.

The survey from The Associated Press-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research and USAFacts shows that while mistrust of government information has grown since 2024, it’s also higher than it was at the end of President Trump’s first term, underscoring how his recent attempts to dismantle parts of the federal bureaucracy may have affected public confidence in the executive branch.

Those suspicions extend to the results of the coming midterm elections. Only 34 percent of US adults trust government certifications of election results “a great deal” or “quite a bit,” which is down slightly from 40 percent in 2024. Certification is a typically routine process in which officials confirm the vote count, but it’s become politicized since Trump lost the 2020 presidential election.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Salvadorans keep protected status for now, officials say

Promise more information at ‘appropriate time’

By Jazmine Ulloa, Madeleine Ngo, and Annie Correal

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration said Wednesday that it would not move to cancel temporary humanitarian protections for more than 170,000 Salvadorans, for now, preserving their ability to live legally in the United States and shielding them from deportation.

Temporary protected status, or TPS, allows foreign nationals from troubled nations to live and work legally in the United States and was set to expire for El Salvador on Wednesday. But the Department of Homeland Security said in a statement that an announcement regarding the Salvadorans’ status would come “at the appropriate time” and that until then, “Salvadoran individuals present in the U.S. under TPS retain protection.”

The department did not provide more information on the timing of the announcement. The administration has at times waited several days after the program’s expiration to publicize its decision.

Massachusetts has some 7,300 people from El Salvador who are at risk of losing their immigration status and would either have to self-deport or risk arrest and deportation by the federal government — unless they have another legal pathway to stay in the US.

The government’s move stands in stark contrast to how the Trump administration has treated the roughly 350,000 Haitians whose protections ex-

pired in July. Hundreds have been deported in recent weeks, and federal officials have targeted Haitian communities in the United States with an aggressive electronic ankle monitoring campaign. Administration officials and Homeland Security’s social media accounts have churned out celebratory videos of Haitians being put on deportation flights.

The administration’s push to remove those Haitians comes even as the State Department warns travelers not to visit Haiti for any reason because of crime and other threats. The department’s travel advisory for El Salvador, meanwhile, suggests exercising normal precautions.

The president of El Salvador, Nayib Bukele, has positioned himself as a willing White House ally central to the Trump administration’s efforts to accelerate deportations. In spring 2025, he helped detain more than 200 migrants deported from the United States to his country in a maximum-security prison. Experts have told The New York Times that temporary protected status for Salvadorans earns Bukele political points at home, where remittances from US-based family members are critical to the economy.

Still, many Salvadorans say they no longer feel safe staying with expired documentation as Immigration and Customs Enforcement sweeps across the country continue to entangle immigrants with and without legal residency.

“For families from El Salvador, it is a very difficult moment,” said José Palma, a Salvadoran TPS holder and spokesperson for the National TPS Alliance, an organization focused on defending the program.

With enough drive, he’s making ends meet

►WICKED EXPENSIVE

Continued from Page A1

doors for people he sees running to catch the train.

“I know I’m helping everybody get to where they need to go,” he said.

The earnings: Last year, Conveniencia earned about **\$73,000**. Without a college degree or a professional passion, “I didn’t think I would be making this much,” he said. “I’m grateful to be in the position that I’m in.”

And he will soon get a raise. At the end of the month, he said, his roughly **\$36** hourly wage will grow to about **\$41**, a pay bump built into the MBTA’s union contract. Under the current bargaining agreement, he can expect to make about **\$49** an hour after he’s been with the T five years.

But those numbers are just on paper. Conveniencia’s bi-weekly paychecks currently come out to around **\$1,700** to **\$1,800**, depending on overtime, he said. Deductions for health insurance (about **\$230**), union dues (about **\$50**), and the MBTA retirement fund (about **\$300**) each cut into his take-home pay.

The steady pay, plus the promise of a pension, means Conveniencia is inclined to stay with the MBTA for the long haul. Plus, he knows the job has stability in a topsy-turvy labor market.

When it comes to the T, “I don’t think AI is going to take over,” he said.

The expenses: Conveniencia pays **\$1,500** a month in rent for an income-restricted studio apartment in Mission Hill, which he found through Metrolist, a city database. It’s a big discount, with the normal rent for such a unit topping \$3,000, he said. Utilities, meanwhile, are all on him. He tries to budget at least **\$300** a month for gas, electricity, internet, and water.

As for transportation, he sticks to riding the T — his badge gets him free rides — and the occasional Bluebike. Until late last year, he drove a Honda Civic, which cost **\$800** a month between the car payment and insurance, he said. But in November, he got into an accident, and decided to give it up.

About once a month, Conveniencia goes to Stop & Shop or Price Rite for a big grocery trip, and his last one cost about **\$200**, he said. On workdays, he tends to eat fruit or toast for breakfast, bring leftovers or fruit to work to avoid buying lunch, and turn to simple dinner recipes.

“My meals will pretty much



PHOTOS BY JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Chris Conveniencia leaned out to give directions to a passenger at Park Street. He said he’s happy at the T and particularly approves of the benefits. He also likes the stability. “I don’t think AI is going to take over,” he said.

always consist of rice, some type of meat, and beans,” he said.

One more regular expense? “I work in the public, and I just want to make sure I look my best at all times,” he said, so he spends **\$35** on a weekly barber-shop visit.

The debt: While Conveniencia now tries to keep his regular expenses to a minimum, he wasn’t always so prudent.

After getting his first credit card at 19, he began swiping with abandon, recalling dropping “like, **\$1,000** on hauls of trendy clothing, or high-end sneakers, his kryptonite. “When I do shop, I kind of go crazy,” he said.

Eventually, he said, he racked up close to **\$10,000** in credit card debt. “The bulk of it was really just pointless purchases,” he said, plus the ensuing interest and late fees. When his cards maxed out, he turned to the “buy now, pay later” service Klarna, which breaks up purchases into smaller installments. Earlier this year, for instance, he paid for an **\$860** laptop in four **\$215** chunks.

“Everything’s at your hands,” he said. “It’s hard to break out of the habit.”

But, finally, he did, once he realized he wanted to buy a



house one day, and with the milestone of his 25th birthday approaching.

He made it his mission to free himself of credit card debt by his March birthday, promising himself a trip to the Dominican Republic, where his family is from,

if he could do it. Once he no longer had his car to pay for, he began funneling around **\$1,500** a month to dig himself out of the financial hole, he said.

“I had to cut down on everything,” he said — and he means everything. “I was dating at the

time, and basically, I just had to say, ‘I can’t afford to be in a relationship right now,’” he said.

In the end, he pulled it off, and booked the Caribbean getaway — on a debit card.

Now that Conveniencia is back in the black, “I feel like a

weight’s been lifted off my shoulders,” he said. But the experience left its mark. He limits using credit cards and removed them from his phone’s Apple Pay — while still trying to improve his credit score — and resists Klarna.

“I kind of scared myself,” he said. “I’m still kind of recovering from that.”

The outlook: For Conveniencia, that recovery means unlearning the bad habits that he observed growing up, where “everybody around me maybe drives a really nice car, but might not have enough money to afford the really nice car,” he said.

Don’t get him wrong — he still splurges occasionally, such as on a **\$220** pair of Nike Jordan shoes or, yes, on a date, where he always expects to spend at least **\$100**. But these days, he tries to follow a simple maxim: “If you don’t have the money to do what you’re trying to do, just don’t do it,” he said.

Beyond that, he’s taking steps to improve his financial literacy, such as reading up on starting a Roth IRA account.

“I was living reactively,” he said. “Now I’m trying to live proactive, so I don’t have to react to my bad decisions.”

The goal: Like so many Boston residents, “my goal is to buy a home,” Conveniencia said. No one in his family owns their home here, he said, and he wants the security of knowing he won’t “get priced out of my city.”

He took one of Boston’s homebuyer classes, which qualifies him for financial assistance programs. “After a year of saving, I want to see how much I’ve saved and see where I can go from there,” he said.

He currently has about **\$2,500** in his savings account, he said, and he is currently trying to set aside **\$1,000** a month — money that once went toward paying off debt — with the hope of accumulating at least **\$12,000** by next September. “Is that possible? I’m not sure,” he said.

It’s something he feels good about working toward. The idea of taking out a mortgage? Not so much.

“I worked so hard this year to get rid of my debt, to now get into a debt of 30 years,” he said. “Granted, at the end of those 30 years, I’ll have something, but I’m like, ‘Man, does it ever end?’”

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Clancys’ separate civil suits alleging malpractice are pending

►CLANCY

Continued from Page A1

ers, including Dr. Jennifer Tufts, certified nurse practitioner Rebecca Jollotta, and their employers Aster Mental Health Inc. and South Shore Health System, exacerbated her struggles.

“Defendants’ negligent treatment of Lindsay, including their complete failure to recognize and address the radical erosion of her mental health, resulted in tragedy, namely, allegations that Lindsay took the lives of her children,” according to the complaint. “If Defendants had not acted negligently, and rather had provided adequate care, it is more likely than not that Patrick and Lindsay’s children would still be alive today.”

Separately, Lindsay Clancy’s suit seeks damages from the same providers, with the addition of McLean Hospital and Women & Infants Hospital of Rhode Island, where she was hospitalized in December 2022 and January 2023.

She alleges each failed to properly diagnose her bipolar disorder with postpartum onset and “instead subjected her to a disorganized, uncoordinated course of polypharmacy that exacerbated her condition and precipitated a severe psychotic break.”

The medical providers have filed for dismissal of all charges in Patrick Clancy’s suit and denied all charges in Lindsay Clancy’s suit.

The two suits seek damages for different alleged harms: Patrick Clancy is suing for his own losses and on behalf of his children’s estates, while Lindsay



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/POOL

Patrick Clancy is suing for his own losses and on behalf of his children’s estates. Lawyers said separate civil suits from the same events aren’t uncommon.

Clancy’s suit seeks damages for injuries and trauma she alleges she suffered as a result of her medical care. Lawyers said separate civil suits arising from the same underlying events are not uncommon.

No hearing has been scheduled in Lindsay Clancy’s civil case and won’t be until her criminal trial has concluded, said Leonard Kesten, a longtime Boston trial lawyer who focuses on civil litigation.

Kesten said it’s common for civil lawsuits and criminal trials to overlap and the only impact the mistrial will have is possibly delaying the civil suits.

“For example, in the Karen

Read case, the estate of John O’Keefe sued her, and that suit is active. But that suit was stayed until the criminal case was over, and now it’s proceeding,” he said.

Lindsay Clancy’s criminal case, which was brought by the state, ended in a mistrial Friday.

The question before the hung jury was whether Clancy, who admitted to strangling her children, should be held criminally responsible for her actions. She had pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder, asserting an insanity defense and saying she heard a man’s voice telling her to kill her children and take her own life on



GREG DERR/PATRIOT LEDGER/POOL

Lindsay Clancy seeks damages for injuries and trauma she alleges she suffered as a result of her medical care.

the night of Jan. 24, 2023.

Prosecutors have not announced whether they will try Clancy again, but the lawyers are due back in court Sept. 29, when a path forward could become clearer.

Her lead attorney in the malpractice case, Andrew Meyer Jr., said the mistrial does not affect their civil suit.

“When a mistrial occurs, it’s as if no trial ever happened. It’s nullified,” said Meyer, of Boston-based Lubin & Meyer. He said the two cases involve “very different tracks and parties”: the criminal case focused on Clancy’s mental state, while the malpractice suit concerns whether

her medical providers’ failures caused her harm.

“That’s a whole different issue because even if she was [criminally responsible], that wouldn’t negate any responsibility for putting her in that position,” Meyer said. “These are two very different tracks and parties.”

Meyer said that the malpractice case is in discovery and that testimony from medical providers in the criminal trial will add to it. “Many of them testified, and what they’ve said is going to be significant in our case,” he said.

Lindsay Clancy has three attorneys representing her in the

malpractice suit.

“Our case is going to continue on the same path whether or not the criminal case came to a resolution,” her other attorney, Rosemary C. Scapicchio, said.

Notably, the separate malpractice lawsuits have received a special assignment, meaning Judge Michael Doolin will oversee both cases. Kesten said the arrangement is not unusual, given that the lawsuits are based on the same claims.

“The special assignment just means they’re going to be seen by one judge, not necessarily together,” he said. “The question is: Are you going to consolidate any part of the case? That would also depend on whether the parties get along, and we won’t know what happens next until her criminal trial is through.”

It’s unclear how long it could take to set a hearing in Lindsay Clancy’s civil suit, Scapicchio said.

She intends to use all the deposition transcripts and is waiting for the court reporter to send copies.

“We really do believe that we would not be here today, she wouldn’t have to go through that trial, none of this would have happened if they had treated her properly,” Scapicchio said.

Observers said Patrick Clancy’s case is also not impacted by the mistrial. His attorneys did not respond to a request for comment.

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Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

EDITORIAL

In Connecticut, a test of whether we can have nice things

If you’ve ever ridden Amtrak from Boston to New York, you’ve surely noticed an anomaly between Providence and New Haven: It’s a beautiful stretch with shoreline views, but the track becomes slow and curvy.

A decade ago, the Federal Railroad Administration proposed a way to straighten out this part of the Northeast line to speed up service between Old Saybrook, Conn., and Kenyon, R.I., a roughly 50-mile stretch. Coastal communities and public officials in Connecticut went into a full-scale revolt, complaining that they were only consulted after the route had been decided. Democratic Senator Richard Blumenthal from Connecticut threatened to tie himself to the tracks if the project was approved.

The idea was scrapped.

The Northeast Corridor is an important economic asset for the entire region. It’s the closest thing America has to high-speed rail. If trains were faster and more frequent, they could take cars off highways and divert people off short-distance flights, relieving airport congestion and reducing greenhouse gas emissions. Yet efforts to improve the route have too often become case studies in our seeming inability to think big about the future and manage the inevitable trade-offs that major new infrastructure involves.

Amtrak is now taking another swing at improving service along the nation’s busiest passenger rail route, embarking on a two-year feasibility study that began in May. This time, the rail carrier is seeking robust public input, planning around 30 engagement opportunities before making any recommendations. Amtrak is touting the study as a “fresh approach” with no pre-conceived preferences.

All the parties involved should take a breath, let the process play out, and try to keep the greater good in mind.

For too long, even mere suggestions of altering this stretch

Improving rail, stations, and other infrastructure to enhance capacity can be designed to benefit both regional and local interests.

within Amtrak’s busiest corridor has been met with suspicion. Locals fear that the needs of passengers traveling between Boston and New York, who want faster trains, are being put before Connecticut residents, who want improvements to local service.

The editorial board asked: Why can’t we have both?

That’s the goal, said Joseph Barr, Amtrak’s senior director for state partnerships and development-east.

“We are here to accomplish something that we think will be beneficial to them [local communities], but also we’re going to listen to them to make sure we understand what beneficial to them means,” Barr said.

Improving rail, stations, and other infrastructure to enhance capacity can be designed to benefit both regional and local interests.

Upgrading Connecticut’s Amtrak line isn’t just a luxury for riders passing through — it may soon become a necessity. The existing tracks near the shoreline in Southeastern Connecticut have become increasingly exposed to severe coastal storms and flooding as climate change warms the planet and ocean levels rise.

Currently, traveling by rail between New Haven and Providence is about a 100-mile journey. The Acela’s high-speed service can cover that in 1 hour, 22 minutes if all runs smoothly.

As the crow flies, however, the distance is 87 miles. Building a straighter track might not seem like it would make much of a difference, but imagine a new Acela zipping along at its top speed, 160 miles per hour. Now — in theory — that stretch through Connecticut could be covered in 33 minutes.

A precisely drawn straight line isn’t realistic, though — that would require too many tunnels through hills, as well as navigating through existing communities, wildlife preserves, water bodies, and tribal lands. If a new track were to run parallel to Interstate 95 for 103 miles, that could shorten the trip to just under 40 minutes on high-speed rail. Regardless of the route chosen, trade-offs will need to be made to accommodate the greater good.

The cold reality is that there’s no way to build a new track without some people being impacted and communities being disrupted, Samuel Gold, executive director of the Lower Connecticut River Valley Council of Governments, told the editorial board. He said locals were “scared and upset” by the proposals force-fed to them last time. And that’s why Connecticut wants, and is getting, a seat at the table this time.

“Connecticut doesn’t want to take the burden of improvements without getting anything in return,” said Gold. “Our federal system provides for a little bit of horse trading in order to make things happen.”

It’s entirely reasonable for Connecticut residents to continue to demand that Amtrak invest more in their state, which it’s already doing. It’s also fair for local residents to be cautiously distrustful of the process and fight to minimize impacts to the environment and cultural relics, such as Old Lyme’s historic district.

But it’s also entirely reasonable for Amtrak, the national passenger railroad, to weigh the national good alongside neighbors’ concerns. Local residents need to accept the fact that this feasibility study was launched to help an entire region. Compromises must be made.

Amtrak is taking the right approach with a slow, deliberate process to come up with a plan to deliver the most benefits to the maximum number of people before embarking on what will be a massively expensive, transformative project. Any ideas that emerge from a feasibility study will be just that: ideas. Those would next go through all the channels, including a lengthy design and environmental review process, before any railroad tie is ever spiked into the ground.

Connecticut residents and officials may still be scarred by what happened a decade ago, but until the current process plays out, nobody should be threatening to tie themselves to the tracks.

Charlie Kirk’s legacy is taking root on college campuses

The day that Charlie Kirk was assassinated, Sept. 10, 2025, is seared into Diego Victoria’s memory. A senior at Yale University studying political science, Victoria recalled his peers celebrating the conservative activist and Turning Point founder’s death all week through memes, jokes with hundreds of upvotes on the campus social app, and comments heard in the dining halls and classrooms.

“That was honestly one of the hardest days of my college experience,” Victoria said. “Because so many of the views that Charlie Kirk had, I share them.”

It was out of that experience that Victoria decided to start a Turning Point USA chapter on Yale’s campus, which launched officially this month and has about 100 student members, according to Victoria.

Yale’s chapter is one of dozens across the country that have launched since Kirk’s death. Turning Point’s website claims to currently sponsor 1,500 college chapters, including at 69 campuses around New England. A CNN report found that the organization had grown by 64 percent over the past year.

Students I spoke to say they want to promote dialogue — especially about economics and foreign policy — expose students on liberal campuses to opposing viewpoints, and at the very least, not be condemned for having a different political opinion that puts them in the small but not insignificant minority.

In many cases, conservative student groups meet to discuss politics, the news, and — what nearly every student told me — to have a “safe space” to talk honestly about their beliefs. Most of them had good relationships with the Democratic clubs on campus but had experienced harassment from far-left groups and individuals, including having their posters covered up.

“Even though we get a lot of very derogatory comments and damn near threats, we don’t care at all because we know exactly why we’re doing this, and we have a lot of people on board,” Victoria said.

The social consequences are real: A 2026 University of California, Irvine study found that 47 percent of Democrats reported having experienced a political breakup — most of whom were the ones cutting off friends and family — compared to



TESS CROWLEY/THE DESERET NEWS VIA AP

Charlie Kirk handed out hats before speaking at Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah, Sept. 10, 2025.

just 29 percent of Republicans.

But the students are still showing up. The day Kirk was killed, the Tufts University Republicans club held its first general interest meeting for the fall semester, and about 15 students showed up, more than triple the amount of attendees from the previous semester. One of them was Mack Kozlowski, who now serves as the club’s president. Kozlowski said the group is anticipating 20 to 25 members this semester.

Late last September, Dartmouth College’s infant TPUSA club held its first event, cohosted by the Dartmouth Conservatives: a vigil for Kirk. Nearly 50 students showed up, standing in the rain with electronic candles covered by plastic cups.

Some schools in New England, like Dartmouth, have tried to bring greater ideological diversity to their campuses. Dartmouth Dialogue started in 2024 to encourage “active listening” and “empathy building” among students with different points of view.

Vittorio Bloyer, a junior at Dartmouth College and the president of TPUSA at Dartmouth, said that while it was a “big deal” for fellow conservative students to request approval for the club, he said he has mostly been respected by his peers on campus, aside from the occasional negative post online.

Tufts University’s Center for Expanding Viewpoints in Higher Education hosts public forums on a range of viewpoints on hot political and cultural topics.

These initiatives are necessary to

bridge divides and demonstrate dialogue, but also to stem extremism. If some students didn’t fear social repercussions, then more moderate students might join, as one Northeastern student told me. At the very least, students who want to feel represented on campus might be willing to turn to already established conservative clubs.

Many colleges are working to promote dialogue and Republican clubs are offering safe spaces for conservative students, but they need to ensure that it doesn’t come at the cost of harassment and online doxxing. Kirk’s inflammatory language and confrontational debate methods were controversial and provocative. His events also stirred up conversation and forced students to defend their ideas more articulately — and sometimes be persuaded to change their minds.

If schools want to eliminate polarization and extremism on both sides of the political aisle, they might start by countering echo chambers, advocating for free speech, and providing space for healthy and serious debate.

“America was a country founded on debate. ... It was founded on the idea that we could have these discussions and not kill one another,” Kozlowski said. “And now that’s falling apart. So a lot of us are like, ‘hey, we need to actually work to get this back.’”

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better. For instance, artificial intelligence is notorious for “hallucinating,” or generating false information. For instance, last year several newspapers published an AI-generated “summer reading list” with five real titles, e.g., Françoise Sagan’s “Bonjour Tristesse,” and 10 bogus ones. AI claimed, inter alia, that author Percival Everett wrote a book called “The Rainmakers” set in a “near-future American West where artificially induced rain has become a luxury commodity.”

I can hallucinate with the best of them. In a recurring reverie, I dream that an even-tempered governor from the Midwest, an Adlai Stevenson character perhaps, is running the country. In my fevered hallucination, America has respectful relations with other countries and judiciously resists the temptation to become embroiled in foreign wars. Significant portions of the defense budget are redirected to — and then I wake up.

Inevitably, I ran portions of this column through a humanizer. WriteHuman.ai agreed to rework 250 words for free. I submitted the prose, then clicked on the super-seductive prompt, “Write Human.”

The program devoted about 15 seconds to “crafting a human voice” and then spit out the “100% Human” version of my prose: “After a lot of pondering and introspection,” the artificially humanized Alex Beam now writes, “I believe I have answered the call for my place in the world of AI. I now have my title and role; I am a humanizer.”

Ugh. Don’t quit your day job, Mr. AI. Leave humanizing to us humans.

I’m a humanizer. Hire me.

By Alex Beam

Alex Beam is a contributing Globe Opinion writer. Follow him @im-alexbeamyrnot.

I have finally figured out where I fit into the brave new world of artificial intelligence. I can be a “humanizer.”

I learned only recently that “humanizer” is a new-ish job description heretofore reserved for “apps” (not appetizers; digital applications) and software programs. But who better to perform the important work of humanizing than humans!

“Humanizer” software aims to make the crapola prose that you ported into your term paper or newspaper column from AI programs such as ChatGPT or Gemini sound like a human actually wrote it. They also help avoid detection by the flotilla of AI-sniffing software, such as Turnitin or GPTZero. Like the fictional “Voight-Kampff test” used to expose non-human replicants in the movie “Blade Runner,” these botniks claim to infallibly detect machine-generated prose.

“I always use AI,” a Canadian high schooler with a 96.3 GPA told The New York Times. Then, I always run it through a humanizer and rearrange the wordings. I don’t

think teachers can tell.”

There are several free humanizer products available for use, such as Clever AI Humanizer, Quillbot, UnAImytext, and perhaps my favorite, WriteHuman.ai. There are also paid humanizers, which is of course what I intend to become.

When high school and college students start hiring me as their personal humanizer, they will never have to fear an AI bust. Because I am 100 percent, certifiably human. I have been doing this for years. I probably have a birth certificate, somewhere. I have a birthmark; I am plagued by self-doubt; prick me,

Sure, machine intelligence is notoriously glitchy, but I make super-human mistakes that AI can only dream of.

I bleed, to paraphrase a famous Shakespeare-ism. I have children (speaking of replicants), one endeavor where AI has yet to make its presence felt.

Sure, machine intelligence is notoriously glitchy, but I make super-human mistakes that AI can only dream of. I once misidentified, and then misspelled the name of, former baseball commissioner Fay Vincent. A Globe reader graciously forgave me, observing “that’s why pencils have erasers.” I was the source of the first-ever online correction in Slate magazine, a footnote since washed away by the digital sands of internet time.

To err is human — they can’t take that away from me.

I can do things AI can do, and

INBOX

Bar association’s own standards make strong case against retrying Clancy, Sanders cases

DA Cruz should abandon criminal prosecutions altogether

Plymouth District Attorney Timothy Cruz should end the criminal prosecutions of Lindsay Clancy and Latarsha Sanders altogether rather than downgrade the charges to second-degree murder (“If DA retries Lindsay Clancy and Latarsha Sanders cases, he should downgrade charges,” Editorial, Sept. 7). Another trial is not in the public interest. The American Bar Association’s national Prosecution Function Standards provide guidance. These standards are the product of an extensive, collaborative process involving prosecutors, defense attorneys, and judges and should guide prosecutors throughout the country.

In deciding whether to maintain criminal charges, the standards identify 16 factors prosecutors should consider, beginning with the strength of the case. In the Clancy case, the final jury vote was 11-1 for acquittal, and the holdout juror reportedly had some doubt. That is as close to an acquittal as a mistrial can get and sends a strong message to the DA that his case is weak.

The standards instruct prosecutors to consider the views and interests of the victim. Patrick Clancy, the primary living victim, has stated that a second trial would be “extraordinarily painful.”

The standards also instruct prosecutors to consider collateral consequences to third parties. In both the Clancy and Sanders cases, witnesses and court participants would have to revisit traumatic evidence.

The standards further recommend consideration of the public interest and limited prosecutorial resources. The public has an interest that Clancy and Sanders remain confined until they are no longer a danger to themselves or others. That goal can be served through civil commitment in a mental health facility rather than through long and expensive murder trials.

In the Clancy case, there has already been a long trial and lengthy jury deliberation. In the Sanders case, the defendant had spent nearly four years awaiting a trial that the highest appellate court in Massachusetts unanimously held was flawed because the original trial judge wrongly excluded crucial psychiatric records.

ABA standards send a clear message to Cruz: Abandon the criminal prosecutions of Lindsay Clancy and Latarsha Sanders. Justice will be served in both cases by the civil commitment process.

RANDY GIOIA
Newton

The writer is a criminal defense attorney.

Mass. needs a public guardian program, but with strong safeguards

The Globe is right: Massachusetts needs a publicly funded guardian program for adults (“Guardians speak for incapacitated adults who can’t,” Editorial, Aug. 31). No one should remain unnecessarily hospitalized because no qualified decision-maker is available, and the Commonwealth cannot continue relying on overworked volunteers. Public guardians should be trained, compensated, independently monitored, and assigned manageable caseloads.

However, support for public guardianship should not mean accepting default surrogacy without sufficient safeguards. Under the proposed law, the physician who determines that a patient lacks capacity could also select the surrogate. Meanwhile, the hospital has a financial and operational interest in completing the patient’s discharge. Even when everyone acts in good faith, that concentration of authority creates a conflict that legislation must address.

Capacity is not all or nothing. Dementia, disability, age, or difficulty communicating should never replace an individualized assessment. Before appointing a surrogate, providers should offer communication accommodations and supported decision-making. Patients should receive understandable notice, retain the right to object, and have access to independent review.

A surrogate must follow the patient’s known wishes and values, not simply approve the hospital’s preferred plan. Decisions involving institutional placement, restraint, or other serious restrictions deserve heightened scrutiny.

Massachusetts should establish a strong public guardian program while ensuring that surrogacy remains limited, independent, and accountable. Success should be measured not merely by faster discharges but also by whether people receive appropriate care in the least restrictive setting while retaining the greatest possible control over their lives.

Protection is necessary. Protection without voice becomes paternalism.

JAMES A. LOMASTRO
Conway

The writer spent 35 years as a health care administrator, with direct experience involving guardianship, hospital discharge planning, “stuck” patients, and the protection of people receiving services. He has also served as a temporary guardian.

Mass. antiabortion group would legislate medical decision-making

There are many kinds of decisions we make in life — moral ones, political ones, medical ones, to name a few. It’s probably best not to conflate or mistake them for each other.

In the article “Activists aim to suspend law easing abortion rules” (Metro, Sept. 5), Sam Miele, director of Massachusetts Family Action, talks about “the audacity of our governor” and “a political bet that she took too far.” I couldn’t disagree more. To say that medical decisions belong to doctors and their patients is not a political statement. It is what every patient of every doctor in any medical situation wants.

The “audacity” is in trying to legislate a medical decision: For any choice, fill in the box that applies. The problem, of course, is that many situations cannot be put into a neat box.

Miele and his group seem to feel that if a scenario involving late-term abortions has not already been foreseen and listed, the abortion is morally wrong and should be outlawed. Neither reality nor medicine works that way.

CHRISTINE M. NOLAN
Methuen

JOAN VENNOCHI

Minogue’s \$2 billion stunt obscured a serious question

Never mind. Republican gubernatorial candidate Mike Minogue said he was just joking when his campaign filed paperwork that said it planned to spend up to \$2 billion on the effort to defeat Governor Maura Healey.

If so, it was a bad joke, since it gave Democrats the chance to call out the campaign spending plan that Minogue said he was joking about as a “dangerous effort to bring MAGA politics to Massachusetts.”

But the issue Minogue tried to raise is a serious one that has something to do with Massachusetts politics, not MAGA politics. When the paperwork that the Minogue campaign filed with the Office of Campaign and Political Finance was first reported by the Boston Herald, Minogue said that he was trying to draw attention

If you have to explain a joke, it doesn’t work, and this one was even less effective because it played into the stereotype of a wealthy candidate — in this case, a wealthy Republican candidate — who is trying to buy an election.

to a \$2 billion contract for a new courthouse complex in Springfield, awarded in part to a firm whose principals included John Barros, the interim head of the Massachusetts Convention Center Authority, and Conan Harris, the husband of Democratic Representative Ayanna Pressley.

After questions arose about his involvement, Barros withdrew from the development team. Meanwhile, two developers who lost out on the contract sued the state, arguing that the decision process was “rife with conflicts of interest.” However, the office of Attorney General Andrea Campbell defended the contract award and a judge denied an injunction that would have stopped the project. The plaintiffs appealed and filed an amended complaint.

This contract award has the kind of cozy, insider look to it that raises legitimate concerns, and Minogue raised them.

But Minogue’s joke about spending \$2 billion on his campaign — to reflect the \$2 billion that taxpayers will spend on the courthouse — backfired. If you have to explain a joke, it doesn’t work, and this one was even less effective because it played into the stereotype of a wealthy candidate — in this case, a wealthy Republican candidate — who is trying to buy an election. While Massachusetts has elected wealthy Republicans like Bill Weld and Mitt Romney to the governor’s office, Minogue is an ultra-wealthy, pro-Trump Republican in a state that largely loathes Trump.

Minogue, an Army veteran who did not grow up rich, made his fortune when Abiomed, a medical device technology company he led for two decades, was sold for close to \$17 billion in 2022. In addition to homes that Minogue owns in South Hamilton and Gloucester, the Globe recently reported on a \$31 million property that he owns in Montana.

As Minogue tries to sell himself as the candidate who best understands the affordability crisis in Massachusetts, he has already poured more than \$15 million of his own money into his gubernatorial bid.

A Massachusetts Republican who knows Minogue well but did not want to be quoted by name, told me, “Most people look at Mike and see a rich white guy. I see someone who served his country and took on the powerful heart surgeon community because he had a much better way to deal with heart attacks.”

Through his television ads, Minogue has been trying to get out a version of that narrative of service and innovation. He has also tried to call out the Healey administration for what he casts as insider deals, like the Springfield courtroom contract.

But Democrats have been quick to make the campaign all about Minogue’s ties to Trump.

“To be clear, Trump is on the ballot,” Healey said after Minogue became her official opponent.

An ad paid for by the Democratic State Committee on behalf of Healey also calls him “MAGA Mike” and blasts him for contributing “more than \$1 million” to Trump, holding a fund-raiser for Vice President JD Vance, and supporting Trump policies on tariffs, immigration, and abortion. It ends with a clip of Minogue saying “I support President Trump” — not exactly a winning campaign slogan in blue Massachusetts.

Healey has stood behind the Springfield courthouse award, calling the court facility “a sick building” and saying the city of Springfield deserves a new one. She defended the selection process, saying the ultimate choice was “the lowest-cost bid through a competitive bid process.” According to WBUR, procurement records showed the selection committee concluded that competing proposals were feasible but carried higher projected costs.

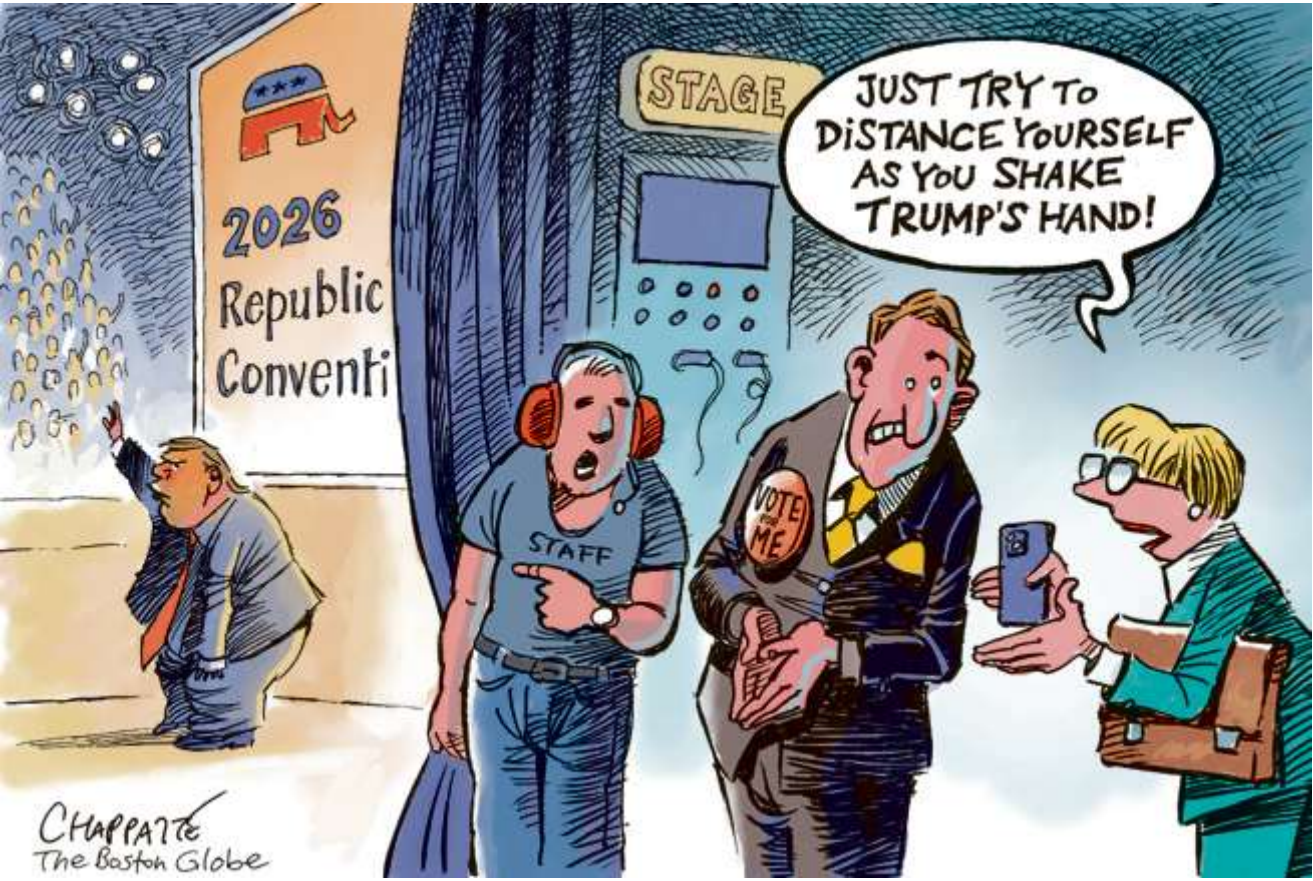
However, as reported by the Herald, one of the losing bidders, who had a representative from Opal Real Estate Group speaking for them at a recent Springfield City Council committee hearing, denied that the winning bid was the cheapest proposal.

“The narrative that the selected proposal is the cheapest by \$300 million is a false narrative used to defend selecting a proposal that is not the cheapest nor best value and has too many hidden costs to taxpayers,” Frank Fitzgerald, Opal vice president, told councilors.

If that turns out to be true, the ultimate joke will be on the taxpayers.

Joan Vennoch*i* is a *Globe* columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennoch@globe.com. Follow her @[joan_vennoch](https://twitter.com/joan_vennoch).

PATRICK CHAPPATTE



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CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Above, recount workers sorted ballots before beginning the recount in the state Senate race between incumbent Will Brownsberger and challenger Daniel Lander at Boston City Hall on Wednesday, as election staff began the same process at Belmont Town Hall (right). The recount is set to continue Thursday in the rest of the Suffolk and Middlesex district. **B4**



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Surprising shake-up in R.I. primaries

Governor McKee and Mayor Smiley projected to lose

By Edward Fitzpatrick and Steph Machado
GLOBE STAFF
and Dan McGowan
GLOBE COLUMNIST

PROVIDENCE — In an unprecedented upending of Rhode Island’s political establishment and a massive rebuke that could signal a significant shift in the state’s political landscape, Governor Dan McKee and Mayor Brett Smiley each were projected to lose their respective primaries on Wednesday, according to the Associated Press.

Lieutenant Governor Sabina Matos was projected to win her five-way primary, despite the state party declining to endorse her for reelection.

Steve Frias, an attorney, former Republican National committeeman, and local historian, said there have been periods in Rhode Island history when incumbents were swept from office in general elections, but it has never happened in a primary.

There was no organized effort to sweep incumbents from office — the dynamics of the races had little in common. McKee was projected to lose to former CVS executive Helena Foulkes, who lost to McKee by 3 percentage points in 2022. Both are considered moderate democrats. In the Providence mayoral race, the incumbent mayor faced a challenge from Democratic Socialist state Representative David Morales — echoing a reckoning faced by other moderate Democrats around the country.

Foulkes addressed supporters at the Track 15 Food Hall in Providence around 9:15 p.m., promising to be a “governor for everyone.”

“We can create a Rhode Island that our children and grandchildren deserve, where a family can afford a home in the community they grew up in, where there are great-paying jobs that let people build a great life here,” Foulkes said.

The vibe was muted at McKee’s watch party at Maria’s Cucina on Broadway. Small crowds circulated through the rooms in the ornate build-
RHODE ISLAND, Page B4

Trial set to start in 2023 Vermont shootings

3 Palestinian students hit after Hamas attack

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

BURLINGTON, Vt. — Days after Thanksgiving in 2023, three young Palestinian men on break from college were strolling down the street here when a man on a porch pulled out a gun and, without a word, fired at them four times. All three were injured — one paralyzed from the chest down.

The shooting captured international attention. It came seven weeks after Hamas

militants had launched a surprise attack on Israeli civilians and soldiers, and as Israel was engaged in a deadly counterattack on the Gaza Strip, inflaming tensions around the world and in this liberal enclave.

The three victims in Burlington had been speaking a mix of English and Arabic at the time of the shooting. Two of them were wearing black-and-white keffiyehs, a traditional Palestinian scarf.

Merrick Garland, then serving as US attorney general, suggested days later that the shooting could be a hate crime tied to the war in the Middle East, saying there had been “a sharp rise in the volume and fre-

quency of threats against Jewish, Muslim, and Arab communities” in recent weeks.

“There is understandable fear in communities across the country,” he said.

Nearly three years later, the man charged in the shootings, Burlington resident Jason Eaton, 51, is set to stand trial on three counts of attempted second-degree murder. Each count carries a potential life sentence. Jury selection begins Thursday, and the trial is scheduled to begin next week.

Eaton’s lawyers plan to argue that he is not guilty by reason of insanity.

Eaton has not contested that he pulled
EATON, Page B4



Jason Eaton of Burlington is charged in the attacks.

INSIDE

Springfield schools closed

Springfield schools will remain closed through Friday as it grapples with a “cyber incident” that has disrupted essential systems the school district relies on, officials said. The district announced the extended closure Wednesday, after schools were already shuttered Tuesday and Wednesday due to the incident. **B3**

Wellesley tuition

Wellesley College announced Wednesday that it will offer free tuition for students whose families make \$200,000 or less. **B3**

YOLANDA CELLUCCI 1934-2026

Fashion icon whose shop pampered brides

By Bryan Marquard
GLOBE STAFF

Years before she was overseeing dozens of bridal appointments every weekend at her Waltham emporium, Yolanda Cellucci got her start in fashion focusing on a single important event: her prom.

A friend from an affluent family “bought this fabulous dress, and I couldn’t come anywhere near it,” she recalled in a 2010 interview with The Boston Globe.

“My mom said, ‘Why don’t you make one?’ I made it, and amazingly enough, I won queen of the prom,” she said. “Because it was over the top and different, it made a mark. I realized even then that it wasn’t the amount of money you spend, but how you put it together. I wanted to be sparkly and special, and it worked.”

Dressed in her trademark white outfits, she made her mark in Greater Boston’s fashion world for decades, turning
CELLUCCI, Page B5



WENDY MAEDA/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Mrs. Cellucci examined gowns in her Waltham store. The shop’s slogan, announced on the side of the building, was “Where beautiful lifestyles begin.”

That fish photo could just be the death of it

Scientists advocate 30-second rule to save striped bass

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

As the weather cools and the days grow shorter, a story is just beginning off our coast, what fishermen call “the fall run.” That’s when striped bass, easily the most popular saltwater species targeted by New England anglers, begin gorging themselves in preparation for their annual southern migration to the mid-Atlantic.

More than 7 million anglers fish for striped bass from Maine to North Carolina, according to the Congressional Sportsmen’s Foundation, and more than 90 percent of the fish they catch will be released. So Andy and Sascha Clark Danylchuk want all fishermen to have a number in their head: 30. That’s the number of seconds you can keep a striper out of the water to give it the best chance of survival.

It’s not a lot of time. It’s less than it took the average person to read this far.

The married couple are both fisheries scientists who met while fishing. And among the many things they share is a belief that most anglers want to do the right thing for the fish they are so passionate about. So Andy Danylchuk, a professor and concentra-
STRIPERS, Page B5



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

ON DISPLAY —A painter was framed in an office building window at Congress and Water streets on Tuesday.

Racial bullying alleged at Cape Cod school

By Travis Andersen

GLOBE STAFF

A Black teenager’s family is suing the Nauset Regional School District for alleged racial bullying that drove the youth to attempt suicide in 2024, according to his lawyers and court filings.

Lawyers for Civil Rights, a nonprofit representing the family, said in a statement that the former student at Nauset Regional Middle School, identified in court papers only as A.W., endured a “harrowing ordeal” after enrolling there for sixth grade during the 2021-2022 school year.

School officials knew the student was subjected to extreme bullying and bigotry, including being called an anti-Black slur and a “slave monkey,” being physically assaulted, and taunted with whipping gestures, the legal group said.

But instead of acting to protect the youth, officials minimized the harassment, questioned the student’s credibility, and “punished” him by removing him from classes, although a behavioral assessment concluding his peers were the source of the problem, the group said.

The school district’s superintendent, Glenn Brand, did not respond directly to the allegations, citing confidentiality laws.

“The Nauset Public Schools strive to foster an inclusive environment for all students and are committed to maintaining a school setting that is free from all forms of harassment and discrimination,” Brand said. “While the District takes this matter very seriously, student confidentiality laws prevent me from commenting on specific student matters.”

The civil complaint said tragedy was averted in March 2024,

when the 14-year-old swallowed 30 pills trying to kill himself, later telling hospital staff he was “100 percent” motivated by the relentless bullying, the group said.

The school district didn’t immediately respond to a request for comment Wednesday morning. The school system draws students from Brewster, Eastham, Orleans, and Wellfleet.

The civil complaint, filed Tuesday in US District Court in Boston, seeks unspecified financial damages.

“No parent should have to watch their child go through what my son went through,” plaintiff Damion Walker, the student’s father, said in the statement from Lawyers for Civil Rights. “When we send our kids to school, we should have confidence they are being cared for. But my son nearly died because of Nauset’s failure to protect him

from extreme racism, and they must be held accountable.”

Walker’s words were echoed by his attorney, Brooke Simone.

“Students are walking the same halls where A.W. was tormented, and Nauset still hasn’t fixed what enabled that injustice to happen,” she said. “This case isn’t about one bad year or about a few bad bullies. It’s about a district that receives reports of Black students being harassed, and then looks the other way.”

Simone said the plaintiffs “filed this lawsuit on the first day of school because families deserve to know their kids will be safe as the year starts. No other child should be pushed to the edge. Nauset needs to be held accountable and fundamentally change how it responds to racial harassment.”

Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

Mass. man sentenced to 7 years in prison for bank robberies

By Bryan Hecht

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A 44-year-old Chicopee man was sentenced to seven and a half years in prison in federal court in Connecticut Tuesday for committing a string of 14 bank robberies across New England in 2021 and 2022, federal prosecutors said.

Taylor Dziczek, dubbed the “Route 91 Bandit,” by FBI officials in a social media post, stole \$137,388 in less than a year from various banks and credit unions across Connecticut, Massachusetts, Vermont, and New Hampshire, Connecticutt US Attorney David X. Sullivan announced.

He was sentenced by Judge Sarala V. Nagala in Hartford federal court, and ordered to pay \$82,567 in restitution, federal authorities said.

While most robberies took place in Connecticut, Dziczek’s largest heist came in June 2022, when he robbed a TD Bank in Nashua, N.H., of \$53,120 at gunpoint, court documents show.

In that robbery, Dziczek hopped the bank counter and entered the vault, pointing a pistol at a worker who he’d instructed to retrieve money from the back, FBI agent Daniel Spera detailed in an affidavit filed in the case. All his other thefts were around \$11,000 or less, records show.

Dziczek typically drove a gray Nissan sedan with its license plates removed to the banks, prosecutors said, and would turn off his cellphone before entering the buildings dressed in a hooded sweatshirt with a surgical mask and baseball cap obscuring his identity.

He then typically passed tellers a handwritten note demanding large cash bills, claiming to be armed. In certain cases, Dziczek produced a gun that he brandished and used to threaten employees, prosecutors detailed in court case filings.

Investigators were able to tie the robbery spree to Dziczek after identifying him as the suspect in a robbery at Peoples United Bank in Plainville, Conn., in May 2022, officials said.

During that robbery, Dziczek reportedly pulled a firearm on bank tellers, slapping the counter and demanding they give him money after he was initially told a teller had no money to give him, prosecutors said.

After telling the employees, “Don’t be a hero,” Dziczek was handed cash which he thumbed

through to remove GPS tracking devices, before leaving the bank. Plainville police detectives later confiscated the trackers and sent them away for DNA testing, authorities said.

Later that October, Boston FBI agents followed Dziczek to the MGM Casino in Springfield and observed him drinking an energy drink through a straw, which he discarded, and agents recovered it. A DNA sample from the straw was later matched with DNA found on the Plainville bank trackers, prosecutors said.

Dziczek was arrested in December 2022 and pleaded guilty to three counts of bank robbery in September 2025, prosecutors said.

Bryan Hecht can be reached at bryan.hecht@globe.com.

Suspended officer’s expected guilty plea falls through in illegal club case

By Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

A suspended Boston police officer accused of helping run an illegal nightclub in a Jamaica Plain basement did not enter an expected guilty plea Wednesday, as prosecutors and his defense attorney remained sharply divided over whether he should serve prison time.

Richard McDermott, 38, appeared in Suffolk Superior Court for a change-of-plea hearing, but the proceeding ended without a plea after prosecutors sought a three- to five-year prison sentence, while McDermott’s attorney sought probation without time behind bars.

“That’s too far apart,” Judge Joshua Wall said during Wednesday’s hearing.

The dispute followed a previous plea discussion before retired Superior Court Judge Mary Ames, who had indicated she would sentence McDermott to three years of probation, prosecutors said.

McDermott did not accept the deal at the time while he worked through issues involving his employment and the retirement board, according to his attorney, John Seed.

Seed said in court his client is ready to accept the previous agreement, but Ames retired without imposing the sentence.

Wall said he is not bound by the previous discussions and told the two sides the proposed sentences were too far apart for effective negotiations.

He advised prosecutors and McDermott’s defense that if they want to resolve the case with a plea, they should try to reach a joint sentencing recommendation.

“If you don’t have a joint recommendation, prepare for trial,” Wall said.

A trial date is currently scheduled for Sept. 28. The two sides are due back in court on Monday for a status conference.

“We just came forward to try to resolve the case today, and that didn’t happen,” Seed told reporters outside the courtroom. “We do have a trial date for the end of the month, but we’re still working on that.”

McDermott was indicted in 2024 on charges of witness intimidation, seeking criminal record information under false pretenses, and maintaining a gambling nuisance.

His certification to serve as a police officer remains suspended with the state’s oversight board, the Peace Officer Standards and Training Commission. McDermott also remains suspended without pay from the Boston Police Department, according to Sergeant Detective John Boyle, a department spokesperson.

Prosecutors alleged McDermott and Luigi D’Addieco, a suspended campus police officer for the Boston Public Health Commission, operated the unlicensed nightclub at 360B Centre St., where they offered liquor bottle service, hookahs, and a DJ booth.

The operation caught the attention of law enforcement after a 4:30 a.m. shooting at the club in 2021, according to prosecutors. Evan Velez, of Dorchester, allegedly shot at a bouncer several times during a dispute with the club’s promoter.

Police who responded to the shooting recognized McDermott, who was allegedly armed with a gun and among the last people to leave. McDermott allegedly told officers he did not know what was happening and had merely been attending his brother-in-law’s party.

Prosecutors said security video contradicted McDermott’s account, showing him looking out through the club’s front door and stepping over blood and broken glass before police arrived.

Prosecutors also alleged that McDermott later used a police database without authorization to search for information about the shooting and witnesses.

McDermott and D’Addieco had originally rented the basement to run a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning company, according to court records. Prosecutors alleged that during the pandemic they converted it into a nightclub where patrons could buy full bottles of liquor for more than \$100.

D’Addieco has pleaded not guilty to charges of withholding evidence from a criminal proceeding and maintaining a gambling nuisance. He is due to appear in court Sept. 21 for a pretrial conference, court records show.

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The Boston Globe

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Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

Lottery

WEDNESDAY MIDDAY 7235

Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)

EXACT ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$4,765
First or last 3	\$667
Any 2 digits	\$57
Any 1 digit	\$6
ANY ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$199
First 3	\$111
Last 3	\$111

WEDNESDAY NIGHT 4592

Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)

EXACT ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$4,101
First or last 3	\$574
Any 2 digits	\$49
Any 1 digit	\$5
ANY ORDER	
All 4 digits	\$171
First 3	\$96
Last 3	\$96

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE

Sept. 8 14-19-36-41-42
Millionaire Ball 2

Jackpot: \$1 million per year; no winners

MASS CASH

Sept. 9 11-22-25-28-30
Jackpot: \$100,000; 12 winners

MEGABUCKS

Sept. 9 11-23-25-33-35-39
Jackpot: \$; 1 winners

MEGA MILLIONS

Sept. 8 17-30-43-58-66
Megaball 20

Jackpot: \$193 million; no winners

PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Tuesday	9416	2494
Monday	6010	7039
Sunday	5484	3876
Saturday	9129	5562
Friday	0034	7110

WEDNESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND

Maine, N.H., Vermont
Day: 3-digit 254 4-digit 8062
Eve: 3-digit 035 4-digit 9929

Wed. Tri-State Megabucks

12-14-19-20-25-5
Rhode Island 5978

This day in history

Today is Thursday, Sept. 10, the 253rd day of 2025. There are 112 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Scientist-author Jared Diamond is 89. Singer José Feliciano is 81. Former Canadian first lady Margaret Trudeau is 78. Rock musician Joe Perry (Aerosmith) is 76. Actor Amy Irving is 73. Actor-director Clark Johnson is 72. Actor Kate Burton is 69. Film director Chris Columbus is 68. Actor Colin Firth is 66. Cartoonist Alison Bechdel is 66. Baseball Hall of Famer Randy Johnson is 63. Actor Raymond Cruz is 62. Rapper Big Daddy Kane is 58. Film director Guy Ritchie is 58. Ballerina Misty Copeland is 44. Former MLB All-Star Joey Votto is 43. Actor Gabriel Bateman is 22.

►In 1608, John Smith was elected president of the Jame-

stown colony council in Virginia.

►In 1846, Elias Howe received a patent for his sewing machine.

►In 1960, running barefoot, Abebe Bikila of Ethiopia won the Olympic marathon in Rome, becoming the first Black African to win Olympic gold. Also on this date, Hurricane Donna, a dangerous Category 4 storm blamed for 364 deaths, struck the Florida Keys.

►In 1963, 20 Black students entered Alabama public schools following a standoff between federal authorities and Alabama Governor George C. Wallace.

►In 1979, four Puerto Rican nationalists imprisoned for a 1954 attack on the US House of Representatives and a 1950 attempted killing of President Harry S. Truman were freed

from prison after being granted clemency by President Jimmy Carter.

►In 1987, Pope John Paul II arrived in Miami, where he was welcomed by President Ronald Reagan and first lady Nancy Reagan as he began a 10-day tour of the United States.

►In 1991, the Senate Judiciary Committee opened hearings on the nomination of Clarence Thomas to the US Supreme Court. The proceedings would become a watershed moment in the discussion of sexual harassment when Anita Hill, a law professor who had previously worked under Thomas, came forward with allegations against him.

►In 2005, teams of forensic workers and cadaver dogs fanned out across New Orleans

to collect the corpses left behind by Hurricane Katrina.

►In 2008, the Large Hadron Collider at the European Organization for Nuclear Research (CERN) was powered up for the first time, successfully firing the first beam of protons through its 17-mile underground ring tunnel.

►In 2022, King Charles III was officially proclaimed Britain’s monarch in a pomp-filled ceremony two days after the death of his mother, Queen Elizabeth II.

►In 2025, conservative activist Charlie Kirk, a close ally of President Donald Trump who had an influential role in rallying young Republican voters, was shot and killed at an outdoor speaking engagement at a Utah university.

Wellesley launches free tuition program

First women’s college to do so

By Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Wellesley College announced Wednesday that it will offer free tuition for students whose families make \$200,000 or less, joining a small but increasing number of private Massachusetts colleges covering tuition for students whose families earn six figures.

The free tuition program, called the Wellesley Tuition Promise, will automatically go into effect in fall 2027 and apply to new first-year, transfer, and returning students. Wellesley, a liberal arts school whose student body totals around 2,400, will be the first women’s college in the nation to make the pledge at the \$200,000 threshold.

Wellesley president Paula Johnson said the college’s leadership arrived at the number after asking themselves how to economically assist as many families as possible.

“Wellesley was founded a little over 150 years ago to educate young women from varied socioeconomic backgrounds,” said Johnson in an exclusive interview with the Globe.

“That mission is part of our founding. It’s part of who we have always been, and we feel very strongly that it is part of who we are today, and we want to expand that with this program today.”

Wellesley joins Harvard, MIT, and Boston University, which also recently announced they would offer free tuition for students with a total family income of \$200,000 or less.

The schools, whose estimated tuition exceeds \$60,000 for the 2026-27 school year before financial aid, made these changes amid intense criticism of the rising cost of higher education and a higher cost of living for American families.

Wellesley students’ tuition for the 2026-27 school year is \$72,570 before financial aid, according to the school’s website.

Once other expenses are included — direct costs such as housing and meals, as well as indirect costs like books and transportation — the total price of attendance for students without aid rises to up to \$103,037, making Wellesley one of the most expensive universities in the state, the Globe has reported.

The Wellesley Tuition Promise only covers tuition, but students apply annually for additional financial aid for most other costs.

Eligible students in the pilot year will likely pay a total of between \$0 and \$26,000 for boarding, meals, and other fees, the college said.

Peaches Valdes, Wellesley dean of admission and financial aid, said that the specific cost of those fees depends on the need expressed in individual students’ financial aid applications.

“We’ve heard some of the criticism around what our expenses are. It’s really expensive to provide what we provide, and we are giving incredibly generous financial aid to students to make our education accessible to as many students as possible,” Johnson said.

Wellesley’s program is limited to domestic students. Valdes explained that international students, who make up roughly 13 percent of the student body, will still receive need-based financial aid, and that Wellesley is just as committed to meeting the needs of international students as they are to domestic students.

“Our students may be coming from all different countries; they may have all different types of need, but for us, we are still committed to meeting their need 100 percent,” Valdes said.

“We need to double down on our mission because it is more important today than ever,” Johnson said.

Chloe Craft can be reached at chloe.craft@globe.com.



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

TUNING UP — Linsy Clark checked her guitar and amp as she prepared to busk in the Public Garden on Tuesday.

Springfield schools remain closed after ‘cyber incident’

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

Springfield schools will remain closed through Friday as one of the state’s largest public school systems grapples with a “cyber incident” that has disrupted essential systems the school district relies on, officials said.

The district announced the extended closure Wednesday, after schools were already shuttered Tuesday and Wednesday due to the incident.

“While the district continues to address the cyber incident, schools will remain closed for students Thursday and Friday, with students returning to school Monday, September 14th,” the district said in a statement on social media.

The sudden closing comes just two weeks into the new school year. Springfield schools opened on Aug. 24, according to the district’s calendar.

The school district first announced on the Labor Day holiday that schools would close Tuesday after a cyber incident interrupted some systems needed for school operations. Officials extended the closure through Wednesday and described the situation as an “ongoing severe cyber incident.”

The district has not publicly identified the nature of the cyber incident or offered details about which systems have been affected. Superintendent Sonia Dinnall said Monday that the “exact scope and size of the breach” was unknown.

School district staff were directed to stay off the Springfield Public Schools network systems, and students with laptops issued by the district were told to do the same.

“The decision to close schools is not made lightly,” Dinnall said Monday. “The most important consideration will always be the health and safety of those inside our school buildings. We simply are not willing to risk any lapse in that.”

Officials said the closure would give the district time to investigate the incident and develop backup plans for technology tools that could remain unavailable, including systems used for tracking attendance.

The district’s Central Office remained open after the initial closure, though officials warned some services, including phone lines, could be affected.

Springfield Public Schools includes more than 70 schools and serves roughly 26,000 students.

The disruption in Springfield comes as officials in Everett are investigating a separate cybersecurity incident that was discovered Sunday night and affected the city’s “internal network and technology systems,” according to Everett officials.

Everett City Hall was initially closed to the public Tuesday as cybersecurity professionals worked to restore the affected systems, but city officials expanded the closure through Thursday as the work continued.

While the city hall is closed, Everett officials said residents can still conduct city business at the Connolly Center, located at 90 Chelsea St., for services involving these departments: treasurer/collector, assessor, city clerk, engineering, auditing, procurement, inspectional services, housing assistance, and parking.

Officials have not said whether the Springfield and Everett incidents are related.

Nick Stoico can be reached at nick.stoico@globe.com.

Alleged Memorial Drive shooter to be arraigned

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

The 46-year-old man accused of randomly firing an assault rifle at terrified motorists on Memorial Drive in Cambridge has been indicted on 43 counts stemming from the case, according to court records.

Tyler E. Brown IV is scheduled to face arraignment in Middlesex Superior Court on Thursday at 11:30 a.m., records show.

He has been held without bail since his arrest in May and district court arraignment on eight gun-related counts in the shooting, which wounded two people.

The Aug. 25 indictment moves the high-profile case to Middlesex Superior Court, where Brown will enter a plea Thursday to an array of charges, including six counts of armed assault to murder, a sole count of assault and battery causing serious bodily injury, two counts of assault and battery with a firearm, and four counts of attempted assault and battery with a firearm.

The shooting unfolded around lunchtime on May 11, not long after a Massachusetts parole officer called 911 to report that Brown was suicidal and armed with an assault rifle. The officer said Brown had a long criminal record, including a 2020 shootout with Boston police in the South End, and a history of crack cocaine use and mental health problems; he had recently been discharged from a psychiatric hospital.

Middlesex Assistant District Attorney Nicole L. Allain asked the court to hold Brown without bail under the state’s dangerousness law, noting that his criminal history dates back decades. Brown was arrested as a teenager in 1994 in Michigan and charged with armed robbery. His other convictions include drug and gun offenses in Massachusetts and New Hampshire.

At his arraignment, Allain summarized Brown’s alleged actions, including three phone calls with the parole officer during which he repeatedly said he wanted to end his life and talked about crimes he committed but was not prosecuted for.

“These people are going to pay,” she quoted Brown as telling his parole officer not long before the shooting rampage. “I’m not going back to prison.”

In their final conversation, Brown displayed the gun during a FaceTime conversation, standing in a kitchen the officer didn’t recognize, Allain said.

The officer called 911 and requested a well-being check on Brown at his home in Dorchester, but he wasn’t there when police arrived. Police pinged his phone and tracked him to Cambridge.

Less than two hours after the 911 call, Brown allegedly began randomly shooting while walking down Memorial Drive. Motorists ran for cover, some hiding under their cars.

Brown was taken into custody after a state trooper and a Marine veteran returned fire.

Allain said two bullet holes were found in the driver’s side door of the Marine’s car. At least 70 spent shell casings were recovered, she said.

Allain said one victim was shot four times in one leg and the second was shot in the back of the head.

The shooting victims have been identified by family members as Casimir Bangoura, a Cambridge resident who was driving to the car wash, and another man whose first name is Felix, a father of eight. The family declined to provide his last name but said he was an MBTA Ride driver who drove himself to the hospital.

Brown was on parole for a shooting involving four Boston police officers in the South End in 2020, a case that has raised questions about the relatively lenient sentence he received after a judge was persuaded by his intellectual gifts and his commitment to keeping his life on track.

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Recount begins in contested Boston-area Senate race

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

A recount to determine the outcome of the race for a Boston-area state Senate seat began Wednesday, but the slim margin separating incumbent Senator William N. Brownsberger and first-time candidate Daniel Lander remained the same.

Boston election officials finished recounting ballots Wednesday evening, with each candidate gaining and losing four votes.

That left Brownsberger, a top Senate Democrat, holding a 34-vote lead over Lander, a former senior aide to Mayor Michelle Wu.

The recount is set to continue Thursday in the rest of the Suffolk and Middlesex district — which includes part of Cambridge, Watertown, and Belmont.

The race has remained too close to call since the Sept. 1 primary. The narrow margin separating the two candidates fluctuated from dozens to, at one point, a mere three votes as local election officials updated their unofficial vote tallies.

Both Lander and Brownsberger formally requested a recount at the end of last week.

The secretary of state's office allows candidates to request a districtwide recount if the margin is less than 0.5 percent of the total votes cast in the race — a threshold that would amount to about 120 votes in the Brownsberger vs. Lander race.

Local officials must submit the recounted and recertified vote totals to the state by 5 p.m. on Friday.

The second floor of Boston's City Hall was buzzing with activity from 8:30 a.m. until past 6 p.m. Wednesday, as an army of election staff and recount



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

State Senate race recount workers were sworn in before the review on Wednesday at Boston City Hall.

workers meticulously checked and tallied ballots. They did the work under the watchful eyes of dozens of volunteers from both campaigns, the candidates themselves, attorneys, and state election officials.

By Wednesday evening, Brownsberger and Lander were still neck and neck — Brownsberger with 12,287 votes and Lander with 12,253, according to unofficial vote totals in Belmont, Cambridge, and Watertown, and the recounted and re-certified tally from Boston.

The recount is an outlier in a state primary where most incumbent lawmakers easily held on to their seats. Should Lander pull off an upset, it would be in no small part due to the in-

fluence of Wu, who endorsed her former aide in his bid to unseat the third-ranking Democrat in the state Senate.

Wu's move to formally back a political newcomer over a two-decade veteran of Beacon Hill put a spotlight on the race as a test of Wu's influence outside City Hall.

Wu publicly clashed with Brownsberger and state Senator Nick Collins of South Boston several times in recent years after they played key roles in blocking her request to temporarily adjust how the city taxes commercial and residential properties to ease coming tax spikes for homeowners. Wu also endorsed first-time candidate Latoya Gayle, an educa-

tion advocate, who lost by about 10 percentage points to Collins last week.

Many political observers saw Wu's endorsements of Lander and Gayle as attempts to oust two of her top adversaries in the state Legislature. Others argued that the tight margin in the Brownsberger vs. Lander contest reflects some voters' growing impatience with the establishment and slow-moving bureaucracy of Beacon Hill, where state lawmakers have extensive control over municipal policies such as the ability to implement new taxes, raise existing taxes, or distribute new liquor licenses.

Brownsberger declined to

speak to the Globe Wednesday, citing the ongoing recount process. But at least 10 sitting state Senators, who were among the Brownsberger volunteers, said they wanted to make sure their colleague knew he has the backing of his peers.

"I'm here today because we can't afford to lose Will Brownsberger in the state Senate," said state Senator Sal DiDomenico of Everett. "He's a leader that we all turn to. I look at Will in a lot of ways, on a lot of issues. ... It's important for us to make sure that we keep the good guys in the Senate."

Lander's campaign and supporters, though, argued that the razor-thin margin should serve as a warning to all incum-

bents.

"I know nobody on that side of the room expected it" to be this close, Lander told the Globe in an interview Wednesday. "It is clear that they gotta start to do real work to make sure that people can stay in the state. ... People just know this is a wealthy place that believes in public good, and we should have a Statehouse that actually wants to deal with urgency."

Throughout his campaign, Lander sought to tap into Democratic voters' growing appetite for more progressive leadership, and accused the notoriously opaque, hierarchical state Legislature of failing to urgently address challenges like the rising cost of living. Brownsberger defended his extensive record in office, pointing to his work on police and criminal justice reform and investments in affordable housing.

Lander narrowly won Cambridge and Watertown, by margins of 248 votes and 157 votes, respectively.

He also claimed Boston, where he lives in the Fenway, earning 1,762 more votes than Brownsberger.

But Brownsberger closed that gap by pulling ahead in Belmont, where he lives, earning 2,201 more votes than Lander.

The Lander campaign also requested to review additional election materials in the coming days, including signatures on mail-in ballot envelopes and applications. That process is separate from the completed recount and will not likely result in a change in vote totals, according to the secretary of state's office.

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Gov. McKee, Mayor Smiley projected to lose in R.I. primary

►RHODE ISLAND
Continued from Page B1

ing, which more than 40 years ago was lodged in Providence history as the funeral home that held services for New England organized crime boss Raymond L.S. Patriarca.

A few minutes before 9, McKee came down the stairs to cheers, applause, and tears from supporters. He greeted people with hugs and handshakes, his shoulders bowed, and said that he'd called Foulkes to congratulate her on her victory and promised a smooth transition.

He thanked his wife, Susan, who stood at his side. "It's been a journey, and she's been a great partner," he said.

He thanked those who'd worked with him during his time in office.

"I'm so proud to be part of an effort that has always brought good things to the people we serve as governor. I'm so proud to be able to have worked with the team I've worked with during the last 5½ years as governor. There've been difficult issues and we've

addressed them."

McKee was hobbled by the abrupt closure in December 2023 of the westbound side of the Washington Bridge — a crucial highway connecting Providence with the East Bay, Southeastern Massachusetts, and Cape Cod. His administration's handling of the closure, demolition, and ongoing reconstruction left voters frustrated and created an opportunity for Foulkes to repeatedly attack.

Though McKee's campaign hammered Foulkes about her role as a CVS executive in the opioid crisis, Foulkes held a double-digit lead in polling for months, and the state Democratic Party declined to endorse the incumbent governor, something it had never before done.

The state party also declined to endorse Matos for reelection, and she has been outraised this year by three primary challengers: Newport Councilman Xay Khamsyvoravong, Providence Councilwoman Sue AnderBois, and former state senator Cynthia Coyne. A fourth Democrat, Ross McCurdy, was also running.

Matos, who won her primary, was handpicked by McKee to be his successor as lieutenant governor when he was elevated to governor in 2021, and the two won their 2022 election promising to work as a team. That hasn't quite panned out, and they grew apart after Matos ran an unsuccessful cam-

pany for Congress in 2023.

In Providence, more than 100 of the mayor's supporters watched in shock as Democratic Socialist state Representative David Morales was projected to win the primary for mayor. The crowd of mostly city employees, lobbyists, and leaders slowly sipped beers at Narragansett Brewery in the city's Fox Point neighborhood as they digested the political earthquake that hit Rhode Island's capital city.

Smiley, 47, first ran for may-

or 12 years ago as a progressive, but shed that label entirely after winning the office in 2022 with 42 percent of the vote in a three-way primary. He's been a steady — if unmemorable — leader of the city, and ran a campaign almost exclusively focused on public safety, touting a reduction in crime and dis-

ruption from ATVs while painting his challenger as both unqualified to run the city and as hostile toward the Police Department.

At 27, Morales is the youngest candidate for major office in Rhode Island, but he has demonstrated a knack for connecting with Providence voters, particularly with his relentless optimism about the city and its working-class residents.

Morales was outspent 5-to-1 by Smiley, whose campaign spent more than \$2 million in

2026. Morales captured voters through grass-roots campaigning, constant social media videos, and digital advertising, rather than traditional TV ads.

Morales's top campaign promise was to implement limits on annual rent increases, appealing to frustrated renters being continually squeezed by the city's hot rental market. Smiley vetoed legislation to do so earlier this year, and the Providence City Council failed to drum up enough votes to override the veto.

In another significant primary race, former Cannabis Control Commission chairwoman Kim Ahern was projected to beat former prosecutor Keith Hoffmann, state Representative Joseph J. Solomon Jr., and state Representative Jason Knight in the race to succeed term-limited Attorney General Peter F. Neronha.

Ahern faced scrutiny for her work as Rhode Island's first chair of the CCC, which has yet to license any of the 24 new retail stores envisioned in the 2022 law that legalized recreational marijuana in the state.

The slow, messy rollout prompted outrage from potential business owners, lawmakers, Ahern's opponents, and even criticism from a federal judge. But Ahern, 42, defended her tenure as chair during a time when it seemed everyone wanted to get a piece of Rhode Island's brand-new legal cannabis industry.

The winner of the Democratic primary for attorney general faces Republican Alan Gordon in the Nov. 3 general election. Gordon, a West Greenwich resident who was not endorsed by the state Republican Party, ran for attorney general as the Compassion Party candidate in 2018, when Neronha received 80 percent of the vote to his 19 percent.

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Vt. man to stand trial next week in '23 Burlington shootings

►EATON
Continued from Page B1

the trigger. According to authorities, when they knocked on his door the day after the shooting, he said something to the effect of, "I've been waiting for you." Court records show that law enforcement found several firearms in his apartment, as well as ammunition that matched casings found at the scene.

The victims were all 20-year-old college students at the time of the shooting: Hisham Awartani at Brown University, Kinan Abdalhamid at Haverford College, and Tahseen Ali Ahmed at Trinity College.

They'd met as students at Ramallah Friends School, a Quaker institution in the West Bank, though Awartani and Abdalhamid were dual citizens born in the US. They had decided to spend the Thanksgiving holiday at Awartani's grandmother's house in Burlington, in part because their families worried that

it would be too dangerous to return to the West Bank.

Despite the political backdrop of the alleged crime, it's not clear how much the identity of the victims or the ideology of the defendant will factor into the prosecution's case. In the immediate aftermath of the shooting, the victims' family members said they believed the students had been targeted due to their appearance and language, and law enforcement officials said they were scouring evidence for signs of a potential hate crime.

"In this charged moment, no one can look at this incident and not suspect that it may have been a hate-motivated crime," Jon Murad, then Burlington's police chief, said the day after the shooting.

But a year later, Chittenden County State's Attorney Sarah George said authorities had not found sufficient evidence to charge Eaton with a hate crime enhancement. (In Vermont, there is no standalone hate

crime charge. Rather, an enhancement can be added to another charge, potentially increasing the penalties.)

In the meantime, a somewhat muddled picture of Eaton's background had emerged. An investigation by the local newspaper Seven Days found that Eaton had written a variety of confusing and contradictory posts online, some of which appeared to express sympathy for Palestinians and even Hamas.

The story characterized him as a peripatetic man who had repeatedly interacted with law enforcement but had not previously been arrested. Two former romantic partners had expressed concern about his behavior to police, and one had obtained a protection order. Those who knew him did not describe him as racist, xenophobic, or Islamophobic, but rather as someone who appeared to have mental health challenges.

Eaton's subsequent court statements, however, raised the

issue anew. At a May 2025 hearing, he claimed without evidence that he had been following orders from the Central Intelligence Agency and Mossad, the Israeli intelligence agency, and that the victims were associated with Hamas.

Those remarks, George said in court, provided "greater context than we've had for a possible hate crime enhancement." She did not follow through on the threat. George declined requests for an interview.

The trial has been repeatedly delayed as Eaton has shifted his legal strategy. He has attempted to replace his public defenders, criticizing their approach and methods, and he unsuccessfully sought to move his case to federal court so that he could mount a "public authority defense." That would allow him to pursue his claims that the CIA had instructed him to carry out the shootings via Bluetooth and FM radio.

After the court found Eaton competent to stand trial for a

third time in April, he changed course and agreed to pursue an insanity defense, though the deadline for such a decision had passed. George objected, arguing that a further delay could result in the victims being unable to testify in person, but Chittenden Superior Judge John Pacht granted the request.

George said at the time that all three had planned to return home to the West Bank this summer and might not be able to return. The court took the unusual step of recording preservation testimony in June to be played at the trial in the event that the victims could not attend.

Margaret Jansch, one of Eaton's attorneys, said her defense would largely focus on her client's mental health. Eaton's expert witness, Dr. Fabien Saleh, previously testified that he was "a psychotic individual with untreated delusions." A forensic psychiatrist hired by the state, Dr. Keelin Garvey, disagreed, saying he had narcissistic per-

sonality disorder and ADHD.

One expert witness expected to testify for the prosecution is Dr. Jhiliam Biswas, a forensic psychiatrist at Brigham and Women's Hospital in Boston, who also recently testified in the Lindsay Clancy trial. Biswas evaluated Clancy two days after she killed her three children.

Though the jury in that case appeared close to acquitting Clancy by reason of insanity before a mistrial was declared last week, such defenses are rarely successful in Vermont, according to David Sleight, a veteran defense attorney. In his more than four decades practicing in the state, he cannot recall a single acquittal by reason of insanity.

"I think jurors are hostile to the notion that somebody can evade criminal responsibility by claiming they suffer from some mental disease or defect," he said.

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Yolanda Cellucci, fashion icon whose shop pampered brides

►CELLUCCI
Continued from Page B1

her longtime Waltham business into a destination for brides.

Mrs. Cellucci, who at 91 was immersed in preparing for next Thursday's fund-raiser to honor her daughter Linda, died in her sleep Monday in her Watertown home, said her other daughter, Sondra Celli.

For years, Mrs. Cellucci's business was known simply as Yolanda's and announced its slogan on the side of the building: "Where beautiful lifestyles begin."

As a working mother of two young girls, Mrs. Cellucci launched her fashion empire decades ago, selling wigs she displayed on bedroom shelving in the family's fourth-floor walkup apartment in Waltham.

Once she and her husband, Daniel, a plumbing contractor, could afford the \$500 rent, an extravagant amount in the 1960s, Mrs. Cellucci opened a Belmont shop with a handful of dresses, about as many wigs, two booths for beauticians, and a few pieces of exercise equipment for women.

Moving later to Waltham, Yolanda's expanded to include a full beauty salon, spa, and event center. As it absorbed abutting property the business grew to about 60 employees.

"When they ran out of space, my father went in and built a balcony so they could put in more people," Sondra said. "The bridal book would have 50 or 60 appointments every Saturday. It was crazy."

For years Mrs. Cellucci kept a piano in her business, and a tuxedo-clad pianist played what she called "semiclassical music" throughout the day and into the evening.

"I've given a lot of attention to the atmosphere here, so that when a lady hits the foyer, she's immediately in an environment



JOHN BLANDING/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2001

Mrs. Cellucci in the bedroom of her Lincoln home decorated in her signature color: white.

that is relaxed, lovely, and a little different from her regular world," she told the Globe in 1984. "I call it 'the Yolanda experience.'"

Stepping into Yolanda's was akin to "a fantasy world for most women," she added. "It's a feeling of fairyland, luxury, pampering, and glamour."

Renowned for the personal attention she paid to each customer, Mrs. Cellucci kept expanding Yolanda's until she closed it in 2009.

The business, which grew to generate millions in annual sales, had added in its final years shopping and service op-

portunities such as tuxedos and limousines, photography and flowers, cakes and invitations, gown cleaning and restoration.

"She was the ultimate brand," Jay Calderin, founder and executive director of Boston Fashion Week, told the Globe just before she closed the business. "When you saw her — in her usual head-to-toe white ensemble — it was clear everything she and her company stood for. It was all about glamour."

Mrs. Cellucci also helped inspire and guide the careers of others in her field.

"Yolanda was the definition

of a legend," fashion designer David Josef posted on Instagram after she died. "She was my love, my mentor, my friend! There would never have been David Josef without Yolanda Cellucci."

The youngest of three siblings, Yolanda Marie DiDuca was born on Nov. 16, 1934, a daughter of Mary Patuto DiDuca and Ralph DiDuca, who drove a truck for Hood Rubber Co. of Watertown until it closed, and then was a gardener.

"When I was very young, we were very poor," Mrs. Cellucci told the Globe.

After high school, she took a

job at Hood Rubber, where she was working as a secretary when she met a colleague's brother, Daniel Blaise Cellucci.

They married in 1956 and soon after he started Dan-Cel, a plumbing and heating business that grew into a mechanical engineering company. He sold his business only a few years before dying of cancer at 86, in 2021.

Mrs. Cellucci remained devoted to her husband to the end. "My mom sat by his bed every day for 13 hours a day for the last six weeks," Sondra said for his obituary.

Their two daughters followed Mrs. Cellucci into fashion. Sondra is a fashion designer. Linda Cole Petrosian, who died of cancer in 2018, was an accomplished model.

To honor her daughter's memory, Mrs. Cellucci helped found the Our Girl Linda Foundation, a nonprofit that raises money for cancer research and patient care, later that year.

Mrs. Cellucci had started her wig business when her daughters were in their first years of elementary school.

"She used to drive to us to school in red hair and pick us up with blonde hair," Sondra recalled, laughing.

At one point, the girls asked their mother if she could dress a little more like other moms — something less flashy than a gold raincoat. "She went out and bought a beige raincoat to make us happy," Sondra said. "Looking back now, she was different and extraordinary."

Mrs. Cellucci eventually expanded to what she called "the total-woman concept" for her business. "Women loved the transformation when they put on a wig, but I felt that was not enough," she said in 1984.

Though she had a careful eye for evolving fashion trends and traveled to New York City to choose wares for her business, her personal taste ran to eye-

catching flourishes.

"I like the glitter, I have to admit," she said. "Sequins and glitter are my kind of thing."

In addition to her daughter, Mrs. Cellucci leaves three grandchildren and four great-grandchildren.

Friends will begin gathering for a wake at 8:30 a.m. Saturday in Joyce Funeral Home in Waltham. A funeral Mass will be said at noon in Our Lady Comforter of the Afflicted Church in Waltham. Burial will be private.

To her career and her philanthropy, Mrs. Cellucci brought an untiring work ethic.

"She used to say, 'Do something you love and the money will come. You have to work anyway, so you might as well do something you love,'" Sondra recalled.

Yet, she said, Mrs. Cellucci was equally devoted to the lives of her daughters and grandchildren, pausing in meetings to take all their calls and attending every school event.

"I don't know how she did what she did," Sondra said. "And her grandchildren were everything. She would tell people, 'The kids called, I have to go here, I have to go there.'"

To honor the memory of her daughter Linda, who died at 57, Mrs. Cellucci was still putting in hours of preparation for the annual fund-raiser, which will be held at 6:30 p.m. on Sept. 17 at American Legion Post 440 in Newton.

Her work didn't end when each year's event was over.

"She was 91 and still did all the paperwork for it," Sondra said. "And she handwrote 600 thank-you notes every year. I said, 'Mom, we can make postcards,' and she said, 'No, that's not right. They made a donation.'"

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Two scientists advocate 30-second rule to help save the life of striped bass

►STRIPERS
Continued from Page B1

tion director of the marine sciences program at the University of Massachusetts Amherst, and Sascha Clark Danylchuk, the executive director of the nonprofit Keep Fish Wet, have been on a science-backed mission to help anglers who want to do the right thing understand what, exactly, that means.

In the case of striped bass, whose population has been in flux for decades, that means understanding best practices for catch-and-release fishing. Strict regulations for recreational fishing, which went into effect in 2023 along the entire Atlantic Coast, only allow stripers of 28 to 31 inches to be kept for the dinner plate. That, plus a growing conservat

ion ethic, means that recreational anglers released alive an estimated 11.6 million fish in 2025, according to the Atlantic States Marine Fisheries Commission.

But not all those released fish survive. The commission estimates that 9 percent of stripers that are released will die from the experience. In 2025, that added up to about 1 million dead fish.

There is no question, the Danylchuks say, that the biggest killers of stripers are not the "meat" fishermen or the commercial anglers, but those that throw them back.

"So if we can improve that survival number by even a tiny percent, that will have an enormous positive impact on the fishery," Sascha Clark Danylchuk said in an interview.

Last year, the Danylchuks and a group of scientists published the results of a study of 521 striped bass that were caught and released, measuring many variables such as fight time, type of hook used, length of exposure to air, and water temperature. They tested the reflexes of each fish at release, and some were fitted with accelerometers to remotely monitor their recovery.

The results, they say, were clear. Exposure to air has the biggest impact on the outcome. The longer a striper is out of the water, the more impaired it is



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

A striped bass was tossed back into the water during a fishing outing off Nantucket.

on release. The fish that did the best never left the water at all. Hence the name of the nonprofit, Keep Fish Wet.

There is one obvious problem with this. "Everybody wants a photo holding their fish," said Peter Fallon, who has been a striper guide on Cape Cod and in Maine for decades and transitioned to catch-and-release only in the early 2010s as concern about the fishery grew.

"By the time you get the hook out, hand it to the angler, get their nephew in the photo, move the boat so that the sun isn't behind them, the fish is in trouble," said Fallon, who has worked with the Danylchuks and now tries to discourage clients from taking photos. When they insist, he makes sure everything is ready "and the person taking the photo's finger isn't too wet to take it" before he removes the striper from the water. Then he starts a kitchen timer so everyone knows the clock is ticking.

But keeping fish wet is not an easy sell. For many recreational anglers, holding the fish is central to the experience.

But the Danylchuks message is getting out there, and inspired change at the Cheeky Schoolie Tournament, which takes place each May on Cape Cod and is the world's largest fly-fishing tournament.

It's a catch-and-release tournament, but previously anglers took their stripers out of the water and photographed them in front of a ruler. Now they are required to do all that in the water.

"Education helps, but when influential anglers or organizations get involved, that's what really helps get everyone on-board," said Jeffrey Buckel, a professor at the Center for Marine Sciences and Technology at North Carolina State University, who has studied fish release practices but was not involved in the striped bass research.

And while other factors influence post-release mortality — water temperatures over 63 degrees, long fight times, barbed hooks, and treble hooks are all negatives, and bigger fish seem to suffer the most — the Danylchuks believe the low-hanging fruit is to minimize or eliminate the time the fish is out of the water.

When stripers pass 120 seconds out of the water, half showed signs of severe impairment in the study.

What they don't want is for people to stop fishing.

The Danylchuks believe that anglers develop a deep connection to the outdoors and then become advocates for its conservation.

"Anglers who are really passionate about being out there, catching fish, are also the ones more likely to stand up and say something is wrong," Andy Danylchuk said. "Without anglers, I think there'd just be way less people speaking up for our lakes, rivers, and oceans."

But maybe take that photo of the fish in the water.

Billy Baker can be reached at billy.baker@globe.com. Follow him on Instagram @billy_baker.



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MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by John W. Fleming and Thomas K. Fleming, II to Fleet National Bank, dated January 27, 1992 and recorded in Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 7925, Page 33 (the "Mortgage"), as affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated February 2, 1994, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 8785, Page 281, and further affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated January 1, 2014, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 20150, Page 160, and further affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated March 16, 2023, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 24978, Page 7 of which mortgage US Bank Trust National Association, Not a Its Individual Capacity But Solely As Owner Trustee For VR- MTG Asset Trust is the present holder by Assignment from Fleet National Bank to Fleet Real Estate Funding Corp. dated March 1, 1994 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 8792, Page 324, and Assignment from Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation, as receiver of Washington Mutual Bank f/k/a Washington Mutual Home Loans, Inc. successor by merger to Fleet Mortgage Corp f/k/a Fleet Real Estate Funding Corp. to JPMorgan Chase Bank, National Association dated February 13, 2013 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 19691, Page 26, and Assignment from JPMorgan Chase Bank, National Association to Bayview Loan Servicing, LLC dated January 16, 2017 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 21530, Page 89, and Assignment from Community Loan Servicing, LLC f/k/a Bayview Loan Servicing, LLC to Nationstar Mortgage LLC dated July 18, 2022 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 24644, Page 83, and Assignment from Nationstar Mortgage LLC to US Bank Trust National Association, Not in Its Individual Capacity But Solely As Owner Trustee For VRMTG Asset Trust dated March 1, 2023 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 24954, Page 577, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 76 Nonotuck Street, Holyoke, MA 01040 will be sold at a Public Auction at 3:00 PM on September 24, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

Commencing on the Easterly side of Nonotuck Street, two hundred and seventy-six (276) feet northerly from the intersection of the Easterly side of Nonotuck Street with the Northerly side of Fairfield Avenue; thence running

NORTHERLY on said Nonotuck Street, fifty-six (56) feet; thence

EASTERLY and at a right angle to said Nonotuck Street, one hundred forty-seven and 11/100 (147.11) feet; thence

SOUTHERLY and parallel with said Nonotuck Street, fifty-six (56) feet; thence

WESTERLY in a straight line to the place of beginning.

Subject to restrictions, reservations and easements of record, if now in force and applicable.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Hampden County Registry of Deeds in Book 7925, Page 31.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of \$5,000.00 as a deposit must be received at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designees) are exempt from this requirement; high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 (Fleming, Estate of John W. and Thomas K. Fleming II, 24-045052

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

US Bank Trust National Association, Not in Its Individual Capacity But Solely As Owner Trustee For VRMTG Asset Trust Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street Suite 3102, Lowell, MA 01851 (978) 256-1500 (Fleming, Estate of John W. and Thomas K. Fleming II, 24-045052

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The Boston Globe

LEGAL NOTICES

Watertown Zoning Board Public Hearing: **Wednesday, September 23, 2026**, with a meeting starting at 7:00 pm in Community Meeting Room 2E, Parker Building, 124 Watertown St., MA in-person with remote access link on the agenda 48 hours prior to the meeting.

48-50 California St – Ramol Partners LLC requests a Special Permit Finding under §4.06(a) Alteration of Non-Conforming Structures to allow modifications to 2.5 story structure within side setback and a Special Permit under §5.05(1) Notes to Table of Dimensional Regulations to allow increase in FAR above 0.50. Located in the T (Two-Family) Zoning District. **PZ-26-13**.

LivingArts

Native American artist
Sky Hopinka awarded
prestigious Rappaport Prize



NEW BALANCE
Emmy-winning actress Ayo Edebiri.

Ayo Edebiri
brings Boston
vibes as
New Balance
ambassador

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

New Balance is teaming up with a hometown star for its latest campaign.

The company, headquartered in Boston, revealed Wednesday that it has signed Ayo Edebiri as its new ambassador. According to a press release, the Dorchester native and Emmy-winning star joins the popular footwear brand to “co-author a global story inspired by the city that shaped them both.”

“She is a singular talent with a distinctive point of view and an unwavering sense of self,” said Chris Davis, brand president and chief marketing officer at New Balance, in a press release statement. “Across entertainment, fashion, and culture, Ayo has built her career by forging her own path, bringing authenticity, creativity, and intelligence to everything she does. She shapes culture rather than follows it, and that independent spirit is deeply aligned with New Balance.”

Rocking New Balance 574 shoes, Edebiri’s New Balance campaign highlights the actress and the company’s mutual Boston roots. The press release noted that the campaign features photographs from Tyler Mitchell and styled by Danielle Goldberg that “celebrate a city, a storyteller, and a brand that have each built their identities by doing things their own way.” The release also noted that Edebiri will show up in “future brand campaigns and storytelling initiatives” and will work with New Balance “on creative projects and cultural moments.”

“I’m always thinking about the stories we tell,” Edebiri said in a press release statement. “Growing up in Boston, New Balance was simply part of the city’s story, so coming together feels incredibly natural. Something I admire about New Balance is that they can tell so many different stories and explore so many different styles, while always staying true to who they are at the core. I’m excited to see what stories we’ll tell together.”

Matt Juul can be reached at
matthew.juul@globe.com.

By Murray Whyte
GLOBE STAFF

Sky Hopinka, whose work in video, photography, and poetry explores his relationship to landscape as a Native American artist, is the 2026 winner of the Rappaport Prize, given annually by the de Cordova Sculpture Park and Museum in Lincoln.

Hopinka was named the 27th winner of the prize Wednesday, the Trustees of Reservations, which owns the de Cordova, said. The prize, which comes with a \$50,000 cash award, is given each year to an artist with strong ties to New England. A registered member of the Ho-Chunk Nation/Pechanga Band of Luiseño Indians in Washington state, he’s currently an assistant professor of art, film, and media studies at Harvard University.

Hopinka, 42, is among the more established artists in the prize’s recent history. Right now, “Sky Hopinka: Kicking the Clouds,” a mid-career survey of his work, is on view at the National Gallery of Art in Washington, D.C.; at the Institute of Contemporary Art Boston, Hopinka was featured in the recent “An Indigenous Present,” a showcase of Indigenous contemporary art that closed last spring (the exhibition included a body of work of his photographic pieces, and a major film work).

Even so, Hopinka said, the Rappaport distinction is significant. “It really does feel validating,” he said in a recent phone interview. “Things are always changing and evolving, and one’s career is, too. For me, it’s really a sense of encouragement to keep going.”

He was speaking in a phone interview from Santa Fe, N.M., where he was taking part in a panel discussion with fellow MacArthur genius grant recipients Sterlin Harjo and Dyani White Hawk on the “Red Power” movement of the 1960s and ’70s, when Indigenous artists adopted an activist stance in advancing their culture amid institutional resistance.

His work is deep and reflective, and often a personal rumination on loss that spans ages. “Kicking the Clouds,” the title work of the National Gallery exhibition, is a 15-minute film he made on hearing a 50-year-old recording of his grandmother learning the Pechanga language from her mother. The recording inspired the artist to interview his own mother to piece together the Indigenous experi-



TRUSTEES OF RESERVATIONS AND GREEN GALLERY



SKY HOPINKA AND BROADWAY GALLERY, NEW YORK



THE GREEN GALLERY, MILWAUKEE

Sky Hopinka (top) is an assistant professor of art, film, and media studies at Harvard University. His works include the 2021 video “Mnemonics of Shape and Reason” (a still from which is above) and “This is a mnemonic for Truman Lowe” (left), from the 2019 series “The Land Describes Itself.”

ence across generations. The conversation unfurls alongside loose, informal footage of Native Americans practicing traditional artwork like beading, and alongside long contemplative shots of the Northwest coast where Hopinka grew up.

Hopinka’s work shifts from atmospheric and conceptual to almost straight documentary. One of his most recent films, “Powwow People,” from 2025, follows four figures through a single day of a contemporary gathering celebrating Indigenous culture. His photo pieces, meanwhile, are often deeply ruminative, oblique and evocative.

His 2019 series, “The Land Describes Itself,” seen at the ICA earlier this year, overlays locations and perspectives in a disorienting medley of images, at once beautiful and dislocating. “Red Metal Dust,” made for the Barnes Foundation in Philadelphia on the occasion of the 250th anniversary of the founding of the United States this year, is a monumental series of 11 abstracted landscape photographs taken across the country and printed on copper plates, which oxidize and change over time. Copper is a significant material in Indigenous cosmology; in some Ho-Chunk stories, copper is seen as a living thing.

His video work can be just as poetically oblique. In “Mnemonics of Shape and Reason,” a 2021 video piece included in “An Indigenous Present,” landscape fractures and fades in slow-moving, irreconcilable visual chaos; it serves as poetic commentary on the devastation wrought on the land, and the soul, by colonial incursion.

Hopinka is just beginning a sabbatical year from Harvard, which will allow him valuable time for research and exploration, and the opportunity to see where that might take his work next. “It’s really about, ‘What sort of lines do I want to chase creatively or conceptually, and what sort of space do I have to do that?’” he said. “You always need to be challenged, and to challenge yourself.”

Sky Hopinka, 2026 Rappaport Prize winner, will give a public talk at 6 p.m. on Oct. 8 at the de Cordova Museum, 51 Sandy Pond Road, Lincoln. 781-259-3606, <https://thetrustees.org/program/decordova-exhibitions>

Murray Whyte can be reached at murray.whyte@globe.com. Follow him @TheMurrayWhyte.

NAMES

Jordon Hudson notably
silent — and absent — as
Bill Belichick deals with
UNC football turmoil

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

For now, Bill Belichick isn’t commenting on the off-the-field issues roiling the University of North Carolina football program. Neither, uncharacteristically, is his girlfriend Jordon Hudson.

While it’s no surprise that the famously brusque Belichick is keeping quiet about the sudden resignation of the UNC team’s general manager and the indefinite medical leave of the Tar Heels defensive coordinator — the coach’s son, Steve Belichick — Hudson’s silence has been notable.

Since she and Belichick went Instagram official with their May-December relationship two years ago, Hudson, a one-time collegiate cheerleader, has been the coach’s fiercest defender. She has used social media to troll his (and their) critics, including threatening to sue podcaster Pablo Torre, and been by Belichick’s side at most social events and on the field at UNC practices and

games during the coach’s first season.

Lately, though, Hudson has been conspicuous by her absence. She was not spotted by fans or photographers at UNC’s season opener, a 15-10 win in Ireland on Aug. 29, and her most recent Instagram post with Belichick was in May. (The photo of Hudson and Belichick walking hand-in-hand on the track at the Kentucky Derby was captioned: “Not the first time we’ve trudged through the mud together.”)

Is it possible the pair’s improbable romance is over? The relationship has already lasted longer than many observers expected. At 25, Hudson is almost a half-century younger than the 74-year-old Belichick, whose three children from his first marriage are all more than a decade older than his girlfriend. Attempts to reach Hudson and Belichick were unsuccessful this week.

Hudson is seemingly MIA at a challenging time for Belichick. His hand-picked general manager at UNC, Michael Lombardi, was placed on paid ad-



CHRIS SEWARD/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ministrative leave in late July and then resigned when the university announced it intended to investigate the allegations that prompted his leave. Meanwhile, after Belichick’s son was placed on medical leave in early August, a North Carolina TV station reported that lawyers hired by the school to investigate the football program were questioning people about whether the younger Belichick used drugs while on the job or provided drugs to Tar Heels players.

At a press conference Monday, Belichick, whose \$10 million annual salary makes him the highest-paid public employee in North Carolina history, declined to answer questions about the school’s scrutiny of the football program. “In the end, we want to run the

program in the very best way,” he said. “If there’s things we need to do to correct it, we’ll obviously do them.”

A year ago, when Belichick appeared on “CBS Sunday Morning” to promote his book, “The Art of Winning: Lessons From My Life in Football,” Hudson, who was just off camera, interrupted the interview after Belichick was asked how he and Hudson had met.

“We’re not talking about this,” she said curtly.

Monday, Belichick had to parry with reporters himself; Hudson was nowhere to be seen.

While it’s not clear exactly when, or how, Belichick and Hudson first met, they had been inseparable until recently. Hudson grew up in a small fishing

Bill Belichick and Jordon Hudson on the sidelines before a game in Chapel Hill, N.C., last year.

village in Downeast Maine and attended Bridgewater State College, where she was a cheerleader. She didn’t graduate, but did receive a cosmetology certificate from the New England Hair Academy in Malden. For the past two years, she has not only been Belichick’s ubiquitous confidante but also his de facto publicist and business agent.

According to records in the secretary of state’s office, Hudson has created more than a half-dozen limited liability companies — Chapel Bill, Coach Show, All BB Team, Trouble Cub Enterprises, Roosevelt Glam, and Gingerbread Apartments — and purchased several residential properties in Dorchester, Roxbury, and a two-bedroom house in Harwich.

Hudson seemed to relish people’s disapproval of her relationship with Belichick, even filing a trademark application for the term “gold digger” to be used for jewelry and key chains. Likewise, Belichick has been unstinting in his public support for Hudson. A year ago, the legendary coach spent the better part of a weekend in a Holiday Inn ballroom in Portland watching his girlfriend compete in the Miss Maine USA pageant. (She finished third.)

Hudson once described Belichick as her “twin flame,” but it could be that the fire is out now.

Mark Shanahan can be reached at mark.shanahan@globe.com.

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Women's basketball: World Cup, US-Hungary, 5:30 a.m., truTV
Tennis: US Open, 7 p.m., ESPN
Baseball: Rockies-Yankees, 7:05 p.m., MLB
NFL: 49ers-Rams, 8:35 p.m., Netflix
Listings, C9

Sports

THE BOSTON GLOBE THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 10, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS



NFL WEEK 1
SEAHAWKS 13, PATRIOTS 10



Throwaway game



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Patriots' Drake Maye has nowhere to go as the Seahawks' DeMarcus Lawrence (left) and Byron Murphy close in during the fourth quarter.

BEN VOLIN

ON FOOTBALL

Loss in rematch got ugly real fast

SEATTLE — Instant analysis from the Patriots' 13-10 loss to the Seahawks:
■ What's worse, a blowout or a second-half meltdown?
February's loss to the Seahawks in the Super Bowl was a blowout — a 29-13 defeat in which the Patriots never really had a chance. Wednesday's loss in the rematch was ugly because of how quickly it all fell apart. Drake Maye threw three interceptions in the fourth quarter, including an ill-advised heave in the red zone with just 21 seconds left that was picked off by Josh Jobe, and star receiver A.J. Brown left with an ankle injury as the Patriots blew a 10-point lead and suffered another tough defeat at the hands of the Seahawks.
“Just stopped being patient and made decisions that ended up costing us the game,” Maye said. “It’s just unacceptable.e. That

ON FOOTBALL, Page C5

Patriots absorbed a hit with Brown's right ankle injury

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

SEATTLE — As if Wednesday night couldn't get any worse for the Patriots, who blew a 10-point lead against a team playing with its backup quarterback, the team also lost star receiver A.J. Brown to an ankle injury.
Brown, the Patriots' big-ticket trade acquisition that cost two draft picks, exited in the third quarter of a 13-10 season-opening loss against the Seahawks in Lumen Field. Brown was the second key offensive player to depart the game after the Seahawks lost quarterback Sam Darnold to a right hip injury after he was sacked on the team's first possession with 11:42 left in the first quarter.
On a third-down play at the beginning of the second half, quarterback Drake Maye's throw intended for Brown fell incomplete. Brown remained on the ground, grimacing and holding his right ankle. Replay showed

PATRIOTS, Page C5

The Patriots began the season after their latest Super Bowl appearance with a disastrous end right from the region's darkest sporting days. **Shaughnessy, A1**

TARA SULLIVAN

Commissioner search critical for WNBA



The WNBA needed a leadership change. In the wake of commissioner Cathy Engelbert's announced departure, it will get it.
That was the easy part. The hard part is what comes next. And more specifically, who comes next.
The next commissioner walks into a league at the height of its economic power yet mired in the depths of public relations nightmares, and needs to be someone who understands the delicate yet vital balancing act of honoring what the WNBA was — including a loyal and devoted pre-Caitlin Clark, mega-expansion fan base — while guiding it into what it is now and still can be, with the super-popular Clark leading the push into previously untapped markets.
For NBA commissioner Adam Silver and the other decision-makers involved in finding Engelbert's successor, there is no room to get this wrong, not as the world is watching more than ever before and the

SULLIVAN, Page C9



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

It was a rough outing for Jake Bennett, who allowed three home runs in 5½ innings.

Angels make it tough for Bennett, Sox

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Angels 6 For Jake Bennett, Wednesday night was about The Wall and the walls.
Red Sox 4 The Wall is that proverbial, intangible roadblock that young players risk reaching — or slamming into — at this late stage of a long season. At by far the heaviest workload of his baseball life, 144⅓ innings, Bennett may well be there, with several starts and the postseason to go. And the walls? The literal, green, ancient walls of Fenway Park? They could not contain the series of rockets launched by the Angels against the perhaps fatiguing rookie lefthander.
Bennett doomed the Red Sox to a 6-4 loss with his worst start of the year: 5½ innings, six runs, three home runs.
“Just mistake pitches that they hit hard,” Bennett said. “It is what it is.”
It was a second dud in a row for the Sox, who are 80-67. They moved to a season-best 15 games above .500 with a victory Monday but dropped the next two and the series to lowly Los Angeles (56-90).

RED SOX, Page C6

► Kiner-Falefa's postseason vision for Red Sox coming into focus. On baseball, C6

INSIDE

‘C’ for coming soon
Sturm expects Bruins to name captain before the season. **C2**

Gauff gets it done
American dodges match points to make US Open semifinals. **C2**

Melrose dies at 70
Famed NHL coach, analyst passes after Parkinson's fight. **C9**



TIMOTHY A. CLARY/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Kazakhstan's Elena Rybakina reached the women's semifinals to take No. 1 in the rankings.

US OPEN

Gauff tops Andreeva for spot in semifinals

By Brian Mahoney
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Coco Gauff knows what she is up against in her US Open semifinal against Elena Rybakina, whose firepower has vaulted her to the top of the tennis rankings.

“I know I’m going to have some aces hit on me and some winners hit on me, but I’m going to keep fighting and give it my all,” Gauff said. “That’s all I can do.”

That’s how Gauff earned her first title in Flushing Meadows and why she’s still in the running for another.

Gauff fought off a couple match points in a tiebreaker and beat Mirra Andreeva, 2-6, 7-6 (9-7), 6-2, on Wednesday to set up a matchup against the new No. 1 in women’s tennis.

Gauff overcame a horrible start to give herself a chance at a second US Open title. She won the tournament in 2023, when she had to overcome a similar rough beginning against Aryna Sabalenka in the final.

Andreeva, the French Open champion, won the first 7 points and took the first set in 26 minutes before No. 4 seed Gauff regrouped. She said during the break after the first set she thought about fellow American Frances Tiafoe, who came from two sets down in his quarterfinal match a day earlier.

“So, honestly I was just trying to literally leave the court with no regrets,” Gauff said.

Rybakina edged Zheng Qinwen, 3-6, 6-1, 6-4, earlier Wednesday, guaranteeing she will become No. 1 in the WTA rankings after the tournament.

“Elena, well she’s the new world No. 1, so it’s going to be a

tough match,” Gauff said.

Current No. 1 Sabalenka faces No. 3 Jessica Pegula in the other semifinal Thursday. But no matter what happens in the remaining matches, Rybakina will end Sabalenka’s 99-week stay at No. 1 when the new rankings are released Monday.

“It’s just a number right now and of course I’m in the semis so my goal is to win the tournament,” Rybakina said. “It’s an amazing achievement but you know how quick everything can change in tennis, ranking-wise, during the match, so I feel like I just need to focus on my game, try to recover and enjoy tomorrow.”

It’s the first time since 1975 that all four of the women’s top seeds reached the US Open semifinals.

Gauff won a 39-shot rally to take a 5-3 lead in the tiebreaker, but Andreeva took the next 3 points to earn her first match point. Gauff erased that when the Russian sent a forehand long, then stopped Andreeva’s second chance at 7-6.

Then it was mostly all Gauff in the third set en route to her seventh Grand Slam semifinal.

Rybakina and Zheng were slated to start about eight hours after Ben Shelton finished off his win over defending champion Carlos Alcaraz at 3:33 a.m., the latest finish in US Open history.

Rybakina said she struggled with the sun and shadows in Arthur Ashe Stadium early on after starting later in the day in her previous matches.

Zheng capitalized on Rybakina’s early struggles to get her only break of the match against one of the best servers in women’s tennis and take a 5-3 lead in

the first set.

But Zheng, who had been playing from behind so much in Flushing Meadows, couldn’t hold onto the lead and Rybakina rolled through the second set in 38 minutes.

Zheng, the 2024 Olympic gold medalist from China, had to go through qualifying to make the main draw after elbow surgery dropped her down the rankings to No. 121. Once ranked No. 4, she is guaranteed to move back into the top 60.

But a double-fault gave her opponent a 5-4 lead in the third set and Rybakina served it out to reach the US Open semifinals for the first time.

Rybakina came into the tournament needing only to reach the semifinals to ensure she would move past Sabalenka. Had the 27-year-old from Kazakhstan lost before the final four, Sabalenka, Pegula, or Gauff could have been No. 1 next week by winning the tournament.

On the men’s side, Karen Khachanov reached his third Grand Slam semifinal when No. 28 seed Alexander Blockx stopped playing midway through the third set after Khachanov had won the first two. Blockx had his upper left leg wrapped and received treatment on his lower leg and back.

Khachanov, who reached the semis at the US Open in 2022 and the 2023 Australian Open, will play top seed Alexander Zverev in one semifinal match Friday. Zverev beat Botic van de Zandschulp, 6-2, 7-5, 6-1, putting him into the final four of every Grand Slam tournament this season. Shelton and Tiafoe will square off in an all-American match in the other semifinal.



LEONARDO MUNOZ/GETTY IMAGES

Ben Shelton (right) outlasted defending champion Carlos Alcaraz in a five-set quarterfinal marathon that ended at 3:33 a.m. Wednesday — the latest-finishing US Open match ever.

Sturm expects Bruins to name captain soon

By Jim McBride
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — The Bruins literally got back into the swing of things Wednesday at Pinehills Golf Club at their annual outing to support the Boston Bruins Foundation.

The players will trade in their golf bags for hockey bags next week when training camp opens Sept. 16.

Camp is always challenging and competitive, but it will be even more so this year with a compacted schedule that includes just four preseason games to accommodate the new 84-game regular-season slate.

The Bruins will play their four in six days beginning Sept. 20. The regular season starts Sept. 29.

“Yeah, it is [challenging],” said coach Marco Sturm. “Even for me. It is for all of us. In the summer you always try to talk to a lot of coaches around the league, and everyone is in the same boat. That’s a good thing. [It’ll be] really challenging.”

Sturm, who is heading into his second season behind the bench after leading the Bruins to a 100-point season and a playoff berth, noted that while seasoned veterans are “happy” with the shortened camp, younger players could be in for a big surprise.

Even rookie camp is just two practice days followed by two games at the Prospect Challenge in Buffalo. That’s not a lot of time to turn heads and make impressions.

“Maybe they’re going to play a game or two, that’s it. There’s not too many opportunities to shine and prove to me that [they] should make the team,” said Sturm. “So, it’s going to get harder for all of us: coaches, organization, players. It will actually be interesting to see how it turns out.”

Sturm said the lineup tinkering likely will continue into the season as he and his staff experiment with combinations and try to work out any kinks.

While most jobs are spoken for, Sturm and his assistants need to figure out how best to incorporate new faces, notably forward JJ Peterka and defensemen Will Borgen and Connor Clifton.

“The good thing is I’ve been around already one year, so that means I have a pretty good idea about some of our players,” said Sturm. “Having said that, now we have a guy like JJ, we have Borgen, Cliffy, we have a few guys, new guys here in the lineup. So that might take

time. The first choice might be not the right one as a [defensive] pair, or as a line. So definitely there will be some changes throughout camp, preseason, even start of the season. Who knows? So, we’ve just got to be patient, got to find the right fit like pretty much we did last year, and then go from there.”

Among those who will help make the decisions is new assistant coach Matt McIlvane, who replaces Jay Leach. Sturm and McIlvane previously worked together with the German national team.

“One of the reasons I brought Matt in is I worked with him before and he’s a great communicator and pays a lot of attention to details, and he’s a teacher,” said Sturm. “So, I really believe he’s going to be a great fit for our D corps. We still have some younger guys, too. He can really develop [them]. And also, on the [penalty kill]. Chris Kelly did an unbelievable job [and Matt is] going to work with him, too, on the PK. I think we finished very strong last year. We changed a lot of things, so we’ll try to continue that to be better right from the start.”

Sturm said he expects the club to name a captain before the season starts. Nobody has worn the “C” since Brad Marchand was traded at the 2025 deadline.

David Pastrnak, Charlie McAvoy, and Hampus Lindholm served as alternate captains last season.

“We’re still in the process. It’s been a lot of chatting, a lot of communication, but I think it’s always better when everyone comes back, and back in Boston, back in the same place, and sit down at one table,” said Sturm.

Sturm said input on the decision will come from a variety of sources, from the front office to the locker room.

“I always talk to my players, and some more than others, and kind of get a little bit of feedback what is happening in the room. It’s an honest group and I trust my players, and they always give me good feedback,” said Sturm. “They’re not going to say, ‘This guy should be the captain or not.’ But I think some of the guys give me good feedback about what is good. It’s not just [general manager Don Sweeney and team president Cam Neely]. I think we listen to everyone, and especially the guys in the room.”

Jim McBride can be reached at james.mcbride@globe.com. Follow him @globejimmcbride.



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Coach Marco Sturm attended the Bruins’ annual golf outing Wednesday at Pinehills GC.

PWHL, Scripps agree to TV deal

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

Part of the reason the PWHL chose to expand by four teams ahead of the 2026-27 season, and in particular why it added two teams in the western United States, is that the league remains on a quest for a national broadcast deal. Executives see a bigger footprint as a way to get there.

The PWHL made progress toward that goal this offseason and announced on Wednesday it had reached a national broadcast rights agreement with Scripps for the 2026-27 season.

Scripps Sports will air PWHL games in three national broadcast windows each week — two on its free streaming platform Scripps Sports Network, and a featured Saturday “Game of the Week” that will air exclusively in the United States on Ion, the company’s national sports and entertainment network.

Every game will still be available for streaming on the league’s website and YouTube channel for fans in the United States and worldwide outside of Canada.

“A season-long national television presence in the US is something we’ve been working toward and represents a significant step in our continued growth as a league,” PWHL executive vice president of business operations Amy Scheer said in a release. “Scripps continues to be a committed partner in shining a spotlight on women’s sports, and for the first time our American fans will have the opportunity to follow the league on national television throughout an entire season, making the PWHL more accessible than ever before.”

The PWHL, which added teams in Las Vegas,

San Jose, Calif., Detroit, and Hamilton, Ontario, for the 2026-27 season, has had national rights deals in Canada since the league’s inaugural season. Its US broadcasts, however, have largely been on regional networks.

NESN broadcast all Boston Fleet games last season on NESN or NESN+. It will continue to broadcast the majority this coming season, in addition to other PWHL matchups as the network’s schedule allows.

“We look forward to continuing to deliver the games locally to New England fans, alongside the national package announced this morning,” a NESN spokesperson said.

Scripps and Ion aired the PWHL’s first game on national broadcast television in the United States last year — a Takeover Tour game between Montreal and New York.

The 2026-2027 schedule has not yet been released, but the season likely won’t begin until after the IIHF Women’s World Championship concludes on Nov. 14, according to league sources.

For the second year, Ion will be the exclusive US home for the Walter Cup Finals in addition to airing a Walter Cup playoff series.

Scripps and Ion have positioned themselves as a hub for women’s sports through partnerships with the WNBA and NWSL, and the network recently added the tech-forward women’s golf league WTGL to its lineup.

“Women’s sports is a cornerstone of our mission to create meaningful connections between communities and the sports and teams they love,” Brian Lawlor, president of Scripps Sports, said in the release. “This partnership further demonstrates Ion as the premier destination for women’s sports.”

The Boston Globe

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NFL WEEK 1 SEAHAWKS 13, PATRIOTS 10



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Seahawks quarterback Sam Darnold departed and did not return after Dre'Mont Jones sacked him on the game's first possession.

PATRIOTS NOTEBOOK

Darnold's early exit a shocker

Seahawks' QB injures right hip in first quarter

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

SEATTLE — **Sam Darnold** exited Wednesday's 13-10 victory over the Patriots at Lumen Field after one offensive series when the Seahawks quarterback sustained a right hip injury, according to the team.

Darnold, who went 1-for-2 for 13 yards, was sacked by Patriots' edge defender **Dre'Mont Jones** on a third-down play, forcing a Seattle punt.

Moments later, he limped to the locker room, and was replaced by backup **Drew Lock**, who completed 16 of 22 passes for 187 yards and a 45-yard touchdown toss to **Jaxon Smith-Njigba** that tied it, 10-10, with 11:28 left in the fourth quarter.

Just before intermission, the team announced Darnold would be out for the remainder of the game.

Darnold led the Seahawks to the Super Bowl title last season. He threw for 4,048 yards with 25 touchdowns and 14 interceptions in the regular season as the Seahawks won a franchise-record 14 games.

Williams ready for challenge

Milton Williams is ready to run it back. The Patriots defensive tackle, who didn't miss a single training camp practice this summer, said before the season-opening loss against the Seahawks that he's healthy and ready for the challenge of the 2026 season. "Yeah, I'm feeling good. Ready to go," Williams said earlier this week. "Obviously, you know, training camp is training camp. I feel like the best days of training camp were the joint practices, because we got to go against somebody else. You know, we're going to practice against our own guys all year long.

"But yeah, we're finally getting a real game situation," he added. "Guys are chomping at the bit. I'm ready for it."

The 6-foot-3-inch, 290-pound Williams is coming off a dominant 2025 season. Channeling his inner **Vince Wilfork**, the big man was the centerpiece of the Patriots defensive front last season, finishing with 29 tackles and 3½ sacks in 12 regular-season games, all while playing a career-high 60 percent of the defensive snaps in the regular season.

His ability to occupy multiple blockers allowed teammates, among them **Christian Barmore**, to make plays all year long, and his standout leadership style endeared Williams to players and coaches alike.

"The way that he practices, his tempo and his energy, I think can be somewhat contagious in his ability to chase plays," coach **Mike Vrabel** said of Williams. "We talked about that so many times last year, when you would look and unfortunately it's a 20-yard gain, but it's Milt making a big hit, chasing the ball, whether that be in New Orleans or Tennessee. I think those things can be infectious to the defense."

Startling news

Vrabel startled everyone in the media workroom on Monday when he announced, unprovoked, that "**Caleb Lomu** has taken over for **Will Campbell** . . ."

Vrabel then waited a beat before adding "on the Weekend Update [responsibilities.]" The role, which had been handled by Campbell over the course of the 2025 season, is a mostly tongue-in-cheek job where weekly announcements are made on Fridays.

For his part, Campbell is happy to leave the responsibility behind.

"Zero sadness," Campbell said. "I was thinking that I was going to be stuck doing it. But I'm glad we're passing the torch."

Lomu said he got some advice from Campbell on how to handle the gig, saying

that you just need to relax and rely on a script that's prepared largely by some undisclosed joke writers and vice president of football operations and strategy **John "Stretch" Streicher**.

"Stretch handles most of it," Campbell said. "You just get up there and read what's on the paper. It's all about the delivery."

"He walked me through it on what to do, what to expect," Lomu said of Campbell. "We went over it. It's a fun thing to do, and so I'm just excited for it."

Pregame promotions

Prior to the game, the Patriots elevated running back **Lan Larison** and punter **Mitch Wishnowsky** from the practice squad to the active roster. The decision to add Larison, who a pair of receptions for 9 yards and two kick returns for 49 yards, was tied to the ankle injury **TreVeyon Henderson** sustained late last month. Henderson was ruled out on Tuesday. Larison, a 5-11, 209-pounder, was released on Aug. 30, but added to the practice squad a day later. Wishnowsky took the place of **Bryce Baringer**, who was hurt in the preseason and placed on short-term injured reserve. Wishnowsky wound up with four punts for 177 yards, including a long of 46 yards. . . Henderson, cornerback **Karon Prunty**, linebacker **Erick Hunter**, offensive tackle **Walter Rouse**, offensive lineman **Ben Brown**, and wide receiver **Efton Chism** were the Patriots' inactives. **Behren Morton** served as the emergency quarterback. . . Safety **Nick Emmanwori**, safety **Ty Okada**, wide receiver **Tory Horton**, guard **Beau Stephens**, tight end **Nick Kallerup**, and defensive end **Mike Morris** were the Seahawks' inactives, while **Jalen Milroe** was the emergency quarterback.

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	1	2	3	4	F
PATRIOTS	0	7	3	0	10
SEAHAWKS	0	0	3	10	13

At Lumen Field, Seattle
Attendance: 68,744. Time: 3:02.

Net yards rushing	
NE	109
SEA	97
Net yards passing	
NE	168
SEA	188
Total net yards offense	
NE	277
SEA	285
Time of possession	
NE	34:17
Sea	25:43

		NE	Sea
First downs	Total	19	13
	Rushing	7	4
	Passing	9	9
	Penalties	3	0
Conversions	Third down	5-16	2-11
	Fourth down	2-2	1-1
	Red zone efficiency	1-2	0-2
Rushing	Attempts	31	22
	Average gain	3.5	4.4
Passing	Comp.-att.-int.	23-33-3	17-24-0
	Avg. gain per pass play	4.7	7.2
	Sacked-yards lost	3-10	2-12
Total offense	Plays, pass and rush	67	48
	Avg. gain per play	4.1	5.9
Return yards	Total	107	119
	Punt returns-yards	0-0	1-9
	Kick returns-yards	4-107	3-80
	Int. returns-yards	0-0	3-30
Punting	Number-average	4-44.3	5-45.4
	Had blocked	0	0
Penalties	No.-yards	7-50	10-98
Fumbles	No.-lost	0-0	0-0

Scoring summary

SECOND QUARTER

New England 7, Seattle 0
Eli Raridon 2 yd pass from Drake Maye (Andy Borregales kick). Drive: 10 plays, 77 yards, 5:37.

THIRD QUARTER

New England 10, Seattle 0
Andy Borregales 50 yd FG. Drive: 8 plays, 39 yards, 3:11.
New England 10, Seattle 3
Jason Myers 30 yd FG. Drive: 7 plays, 31 yards, 3:40.

FOURTH QUARTER

New England 10, Seattle 10
Jaxon Smith-Njigba 45 yd pass from Drew Lock (Jason Myers kick). Drive: 5 plays, 67 yards, 2:44.
Seattle 13, New England 10
Jason Myers 26 yd FG. Drive: 8 plays, 39 yards, 3:30.

PATRIOTS STATISTICS						SEAHAWKS STATISTICS					
Rushing						Rushing					
Att.	Yds.	Avg.	Lg	TD		Att.	Yds.	Avg.	Lg	TD	
Stevenson.....	18	51	2.8	12	0	Price.....	10	52	5.2	13	0
Maye.....	7	47	6.7	16	0	Holani.....	8	29	3.6	9	0
Kiner.....	6	11	1.8	7	0	Lock.....	2	13	6.5	14	0
						Wilson.....	2	3	1.5	3	0
Passing						Passing					
Att.	Com.	Yds.	TD	Int.	Lg	Att.	Com.	Yds.	TD	Int.	Lg
Maye.....	33	23	178	1	3	19	Lock.....	22	16	187	1
							Darnold.....	2	13	0	13
Pass receiving						Pass receiving					
Tar.	No.	Yds.	Avg.	Lg	TD	Tar.	No.	Yds.	Avg.	Lg	TD
Stevenson.....	5	44	8.8	17	0	Smith-Njigba.....	8	122	15.3	45	1
Douglas.....	5	20	4.0	8	0	Kupp.....	2	35	17.5	24	0
Hollins.....	4	51	12.8	19	0	Russell.....	2	20	10.0	13	0
Henry.....	3	26	8.7	13	0	Barner.....	2	13	6.5	9	0
A.Brown.....	3	26	8.7	14	0	Price.....	2	6	3.0	4	0
Larison.....	2	9	4.5	11	0	Shaheed.....	1	4	4.0	4	0
Raridon.....	1	2	2.0	2	1						
Punting						Interceptions					
No.	Avg.	Lg	In	TD		No.	Yds.	Lg	TD		
Wishnowsky.....	4	44.3	46	3	0	Pritchett.....	1	30	30.0	30	0
						Love.....	0	0.0	0	0	
Kickoff returns						Punting					
No.	Avg.	Lg	TD			No.	Avg.	Lg	In	TD	
K.Williams.....	2	29.0	29	0		Dickson.....	5	45.4	50	3	0
Larison.....	2	24.5	27	0							
Tackles-assists-sacks						Punt returns					
Spillane 7-1-0, Woodson 5-0-0, Byard III 2-3-0, M.Jones 3-1-0, Ellis 3-1-0, Jacobs 3-0-1, M.Williams 2-1-0, Davis III 2-1-0, Obiazor 0-0, Gonzalez 2-0-0, Pettus 2-0-0, O.Jones 1-1-1, Durden 0-2-0, Ponder 0-1-0, Douglas 0-0-0, Woods 0-0-0, J.Wilson 0-0-0, Barmore 1-0-0						No.	Avg.	FC	Lg	TD	
						Shaheed.....	1	9.0	3	9	0
Tackles-assists-sacks						Kickoff returns					
						No.	Avg.	Lg	TD		
						Shaheed.....	3	26.7	30	0	
Tackles-assists-sacks						Tackles-assists-sacks					
Jones IV 8-5-0, D.Thomas 3-6-1, Pritchett 5-1-0, Jobe 5-1-0, Love 4-2-0, Nwosu 4-1-0, Witherspoon 0-5-0, Williams 3-1-1, Thomas II 3-1-0, Lawrence 1-2-0, Mills 2-0-0, Murphy II 2-0-0, Hall 1-1-1, Surratt 0-0-0, Reed 1-0-0, Foster Jr. 0-0-0, O'Toole 0-0-0, Russell 0-0-0, O'Connell 0-0-0						Jones IV 8-5-0, D.Thomas 3-6-1, Pritchett 5-1-0, Jobe 5-1-0, Love 4-2-0, Nwosu 4-1-0, Witherspoon 0-5-0, Williams 3-1-1, Thomas II 3-1-0, Lawrence 1-2-0, Mills 2-0-0, Murphy II 2-0-0, Hall 1-1-1, Surratt 0-0-0, Reed 1-0-0, Foster Jr. 0-0-0, O'Toole 0-0-0, Russell 0-0-0, O'Connell 0-0-0					



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots rookie tight end Eli Raridon (right) celebrates his first NFL touchdown catch with tight end Hunter Henry in the second quarter.

Drive chart

PATRIOTS								
No.	Qtr.	Time rec'd.	Began	Plays	Net yds.	1st downs	Poss. time	Result
1	1	11:42	NE8	8	37	2	4:13	Punt
2	1	4:35	NE20	5	20	1	3:13	Punt
3	2	14:48	NE23	10	77	5	5:37	Touchdown
4	2	4:39	NE8	8	45	2	3:49	Punt
5	3	14:53	NE29	8	39	2	3:04	Made FG
6	3	9:29	NE6	3	0	0	2:36	Punt
7	3-4	3:06	NE32	6	23	2	3:54	Interception
8	4	11:23	NE14	5	8	1	2:03	Interception
9	4	5:45	NE27	15	57	4	5:24	Interception
SEAHAWKS								
No.	Qtr.	Time rec'd.	Began	Plays	Net yds.	1st downs	Poss. time	Result
1	1	14:55	SEA24	5	25	2	3:13	Punt
2	1	7:29	SEA10	5	20	1	2:54	Punt
3	1-2	1:22	SEA14	4	17	1	1:34	Punt
4	2	9:06	SEA30	5	20	1	4:27	Punt
5	2	0:50	SEA7	6	19	1	0:50	End of Half
6	3	11:44	SEA29	4	19	1	2:15	Punt
7	3	6:53	NE43	7	31	1	3:40	Made FG
8	4	14:12	SEA33	5	67	2	2:44	Touchdown
9	4	9:20	NE47	8	39	3	3:30	Made FG
10	4	0:21	SEA20	1	0	0	0:21	End of Game

NFL WEEK 1 SEAHAWKS 13, PATRIOTS 10

It all fell apart quickly second time around

►ON FOOTBALL
Continued from Page C1
wasn't how I play football, and how I want to represent my game and playing quarterback for the Patriots."

The Patriots gave a clean, professional effort over the first 33 minutes — they didn't commit a penalty, allow a sack, or draw a penalty flag as they took a 10-0 lead early in the third quarter. The Seahawks were the ones making mistakes (the first seven penalties of the game), allowing sacks, and taking the life out of their usually raucous fans.

But the Patriots came unglued spectacularly in the second half, and it wasn't just Maye, who finished with just 178 passing yards and a touchdown and looked like the same skittish quarterback from the Super Bowl. The Patriots allowed three sacks in the second half. The penalties came in bunches (seven for 50 after half-time). And Jaxson Smith-Njigba scurried free for a 45-yard touchdown as the Seahawks came roaring back to win the NFL's Kickoff Game. The Patriots couldn't beat a backup QB, with Drew Lock replacing Sam Darnold (hip) after the first possession and throwing for 187 yards and a touchdown.

The Seahawks not only won both ends of the Super Bowl-Kickoff double-header, but they now have defeated the Patriots in six of their last seven matchups. For Patriots coach Mike Vrabel, who decided against playing his starters in any preseason game, it marked his fifth straight loss in a Week 1 game.

There's no need to panic after one loss, and the Patriots certainly proved last year that they can overcome a Week 1 defeat. But an offseason of change (six new starters and 24 new players) still produced the same result — a poor performance by Maye and painful loss to the Seahawks.

"You can say there's a full season ahead, but we got to get this thing going early," Maye said.

■ Maye is a terrific young quarterback with a bright future, but he's got to know better than to throw the ball up for grabs at the end of the game. The Patriots were in easy field goal range and just needed Maye to not be reckless. Now in his third year, Maye shouldn't be making those rookie mistakes.

"You can't throw three interceptions. Drake knows that," Vrabel said. "It's a long season, we're going to hold our head up high. We have nothing but the utmost confidence in [Maye], he's going to make a lot of plays for us."

■ I didn't love the Patriots' plan of swapping out Stefon

Diggs and Kayshon Boutte for Brown and Doubs, and now those moves are squarely under the microscope. Diggs and Boutte weren't the most physically gifted receivers, but they were steady and available, with Diggs playing in all 21 games last year, and Boutte in 18.

Meanwhile, Brown, known for a physical brand of football, is already out with an ankle injury that he suffered in the third quarter. And Doubs looked lost on Wednesday night, coming down with more drops (two) than catches (zero) on three targets. Doubs also tipped up a pass that resulted in the Seahawks' first interception.

■ Lumen Field is notoriously difficult on visiting teams, but it was the Seahawks who played sloppy, disjointed football for much of the night. The Seahawks committed the first seven penalties of the game and finished with 10 for 98 yards, including a roughing the punter flag that handed the Patriots 3 extra points. The Seahawks also had an illegal shift penalty that wiped out a touchdown in the third quarter.

The crowd finally found its voice in the fourth quarter as the Seahawks mounted the comeback, but the defending champs, who didn't play any starters in the preseason, played like they were still thinking about 2025.

■ The Patriots had a strange sequence at the end of the first half that cost them at least 3 points. Facing third and 5 from midfield with about a minute left, Maye handed off to Rhamondre Stevenson, who was stuffed for just 2 yards, and Vrabel sent on the punt team. The play call was strange enough — why not attempt a pass? — but if the Patriots were going to run on third down, they should have been prepared to go for it on fourth down.

Those missed points proved costly.

■ Though Doubs struggled, several other new Patriots made an impact. Third-round pick Eli Raridon scored a 2-yard touchdown on his first NFL catch to give the Patriots an early lead. Brown drew a 34-yard pass interference penalty (which should have been a touchdown with a better throw) that set up Raridon's score.

New defensive end Dre'Mont Jones had the early sack that resulted in Darnold's hip injury. And second-round pick Gabe Jacas, who did not have a particularly good training camp, looked quick and dangerous with his first sack and a 3-yard tackle for loss.

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Drake Maye began his third year in the NFL by throwing interceptions on his team's final three drives to fumble a 10-0 lead.

Brown's ankle injury a hard hit

►PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

Seahawks cornerback Nehemiah Pritchett's knee landing on Brown's ankle while he was trying to reach for the low pass.

"I threw one low to him," Maye said. "I should've hit him in the chest. I got to make a better play and make a better throw for him."

Brown appeared to be in obvious pain, while coach Mike Vrabel and the coaching staff ran onto the field. He was able to walk off the field, albeit slowly, under his own power and took off his helmet upon reaching the sideline.

Brown had to wait a moment to enter the blue medical tent, because tight end Hunter Henry was already inside, but immediately went in once Henry exited.

After several minutes, Brown emerged from the blue tent without his helmet or right

cleat. He walked back to the locker room with trainers.

Prior to his injury, Brown was moving well and caught three of his four targets for 26 yards. He also drew a pass interference penalty that set up a 2-yard touchdown pass from Maye to rookie tight end Eli Raridon for a 7-0 lead with 9:11 left in the second quarter. Brown served as a popular target for Maye on third down, with two of his three receptions converting for a first down.

The team initially listed Brown as questionable to return, before downgrading him to out at the start of the fourth quarter. Without Brown, the Patriots have Romeo Doubs, Mack Hollins, Kyle Williams, DeMario Douglas, and Efton Chism available at wide receiver. The team traded Kayshon Boutte in August.

Vrabel did not have an update on Brown after the game.

The Patriots will not practice until Monday.

Brown's extended absence would be a major loss for the Patriots' passing attack. Throughout training camp, the Patriots extolled the addition of Brown not only for his talent but also for his presence, which created opportunities for other receivers.

After Brown's injury, the big-bodied Hollins stepped up as Patriots' leading receiver with four catches on five targets for 51 yards. Three of his receptions came in critical moments, including a fourth-down conversion to keep the team's final drive alive.

Doubs, whom the Patriots signed to a four-year, \$68 million contract, finished the game without a catch. In the fourth quarter, Doubs was wide open when he dropped a pass that would have converted a second-and-14 attempt. He also was

the intended target on a pass that was tipped by safety Rodney Thomas, a Seahawks practice squad player, into Pritchett's arms.

Maye threw three interceptions, all after Brown left the game. He overthrew one pass across the middle intended for Douglas in traffic and then chucked a ball intended for Hollins into the end zone on the final play of the game.

Brown did not speak to reporters after the game, but his teammates expressed optimism about his potential return.

"He's going to fight hard to get back," Maye said. "I know he's going to want to get back out there quick. I think he's a competitor. He's going to help this football team a lot this year."

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DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Much to the delight of the home fans, Jaxon Smith-Njigba (center) raced 45 yards with a Drew Lock pass for the tying score.

What felt like a lock quickly went disaster

►SHAUGHNESSY
Continued from Page A1

ders, which no doubt made for the longest five-hour flight in aviation history for the defending AFC champs.

"We have to move on," Patriots coach Mike Vrabel said. "We know how hard the season is."

Playing about 830 miles north of their humbling Super Bowl loss to the Seahawks, the Patriots had complete control of their 67th season opener. A 2-yard touchdown pass to rookie tight end Eli Raridon and an Andy Borregales field goal looked like a commanding lead given Seattle's starting quarterback Sam Darnold was knocked out of the game in the first three minutes.

Summoning a time-tested tenet of the Bill Belichick era — one that reared its head last year when Broncos starting quarterback Bo Nix went down in the game before the AFC Champion-

ship — the Pats got a big break when Darnold injured his hip after only five plays.

On a third and 6 near midfield, Darnold was sacked by edge lineman Dre'Mont Jones, and limped to the sideline blue tent while Seattle punted. He soon left to the locker room, was listed as questionable to return, then ruled out before halftime.

It was Belichick's Sun Tzu (famous for "The Art of War") theory coming into play . . . *if you wait by the river long enough, the bodies of your enemies will float by.* Darnold was replaced by eight-year veteran backup Drew (Not Exactly A) Lock. There's no way the Pats were going to blow a 10-0, second-half lead to Drew Lock. Right?

Things started to shift late in the third. Lock floated a pass into the arms of Cooper Kupp at the 13, then had a touchdown taken off the board due to an illegal shift. Seattle settled for a

chip shot field goal to make it 10-3 with 3:13 left in the third.

Then we had the game's first turnover. Forcing a long pass to new toy Romeo Doubs, Maye watched as the ball was tipped by Rodney Thomas and landed in the arms of Nehemiah Pritchett.

Game On for the champs. On a fourth and 1 from the New England 45, Lock found Jaxon Smith-Njigba over the middle. The nimble receiver darted and weaved all the way to Tacoma in the most exciting play of the night to make it 10-10 with 11:28 left.

With the scored tied and all momentum moving to Seattle, Doubs dropped a sure first-down pass in the open field. On the next play, third and 14 from his own 22, Maye forced it over the middle in the direction of DeMario Douglas and it was easily picked by Julian Love, putting Seattle in great

position to win the game.

Lock moved the champs all the way to New England's 3 before settling for a 26-yard field goal and their first lead with 5:50 left. It was time for Maye to step up.

He did the job. For a while. With great play calling and clock management starting at his 27, he moved his team all the way to the Seattle 16. A field goal was a sure thing.

But the Pats got greedy. They didn't want overtime. They wanted the win.

Instead, they got the loss. (And if you thought things couldn't get any worse, A.J. Brown sustained an ankle injury in the second half and didn't return.)

Historically, the Seahawks have been a problem for New England. Seattle is 13-9 against the Patriots, including five consecutive victories. The last time the Pats beat the 'Hawks was in Super Bowl XLIX, when Pete Carroll

made the dumbest call in sports history, electing to throw a slant pass in traffic (remember Malcolm Butler?) from the 1-yard line. Apart from that game, New England's last win over Seattle was in 2008.

Season openers have not been Vrabel's friend; he's 2-6 in openers, including five straight losses. His Pats were beaten by the lowly Raiders in Foxboro last September. Now this.

It doesn't get much easier for the Pats in the next three weeks. New England plays host to Pittsburgh in the home opener Sept. 20, then travels to Jacksonville and Buffalo. Including Seattle, that means the Pats play four teams that combined to win 72 percent of their games last year.

Dan Shaughnessy is a Globe columnist. He can be reached at daniel.shaughnessy@globe.com. Follow him @dan_shaughnessy.

Patriots (0-1) in 2026

SEPT. 9 @SEA L, 13-10	SEPT. 20 PIT 1 p.m. CBS	SEPT. 27 @JAX 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 4 @BUF 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 11 LV 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 18 NYJ 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 22 @CHI 8:15 p.m. Ch. 5, Amazon	NOV. 1 @MIA 4:25 p.m. CBS	NOV. 8 GB 4:25 p.m. Fox	NOV. 15 @DET 9:30 a.m. Fox, Fox One	NOV. 29 @LAC 8:20 p.m. NBC, Peacock	DEC. 6 BUF 4:25 p.m. CBS	DEC. 10 MIN 8:15 p.m. Ch. 5, Amazon	DEC. 21 @KC 8:15 p.m. ABC, ESPN	DEC. 27 @NYJ 1 p.m. CBS	JAN. 3 DEN TBA	JAN. 10 MIA TBA
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Baseball

Kiner-Falefa’s playoff vision coming true

PETER ABRAHAM
ON BASEBALL

Isiah Kiner-Falefa signed with the Red Sox in February because he saw a path back to the postseason after nearly winning the World Series with the Blue Jays last year.

It looked like more of a dead end for the first three months of the season with how poorly the Sox played before their historic turnaround. Now the 31-year-old utility player is encouraged as the regular season winds down.

“There are different ways to win,” Kiner-Falefa said Wednesday before the Sox lost, 6-4, to the Angels. “One thing I really liked about Toronto last year was it seemed like it was a different guy stepping up every series, every game. “Whether it was a pitcher, a bullpen

guy, a bench guy, it seemed like everybody last year had a moment. I thought that was very special. I feel like we have the same thing this year.”

Kiner-Falefa mentioned the run-saving leaping catch Tsung-Che Cheng made to end the July 20 game against Baltimore that gave the Sox a 14-game win streak.

“That’s contagious,” Kiner-Falefa said. “That’s what I see in this team. There’s no quit, there’s no panic. There’s just a belief built over time, just by the way the season has gone. It’s a winning mentality.”

Kiner-Falefa has 21 games of postseason experience with the Yankees and Blue Jays. Among the Red Sox position players, only Willson Contreras (30) has more. So when Kiner-Falefa talks about how to handle those games, his voice is heard.

“In New York I was around the big boys and saw how they went about it,” he said. “Then last year, getting to play with George [Springer] was interesting.

“Seeing the way that he went about his business last year and how loose he was — treating every game like it’s just another regular-season game — showed me a lot. It’s not just another game; it’s a playoff game. But you have to stay loose. I enjoyed the way [the Blue Jays] approached it last season.

“As the time gets closer, I’ll definitely be more vocal with the guys about what I experienced with Toronto.”

Kiner-Falefa, who started at second base against the Angels on Wednesday night, was on the injured list from June 19-Sept. 1 with a bone bruise on his left forearm.

His rehabilitation assignment with

Triple-A Worcester lasted for nine games, longer than expected. But Kiner-Falefa told team officials he would stay in the minors until rosters expanded on Sept. 1.

He has since started four games and come off the bench in three others. Through Tuesday, Kiner-Falefa has hit .277 with a .713 OPS on the season and started games at second base, third base, and shortstop. He also can play first base when needed.

The defensive versatility should serve the Sox well in the postseason by creating midgame options for interim manager Chad Tracy to pinch hit in high-leverage situations.

“I think he’s comfortable pretty much anywhere,” Tracy said.

The Blue Jays lost Game 7 of the World Series, 5-4, in 11 innings against the Dodgers last season. Kiner-Falefa

was thrown out at the plate in the bottom of the ninth inning on a close play. He was an inch or two away from scoring the winning run and having a prominent place in baseball history.

“The experience of how close the team becomes — the plane rides, the ups and downs of the postseason — it’s so special,” he said. “It would have been nice to come out on top. Obviously, the goal is to win. But you have to enjoy everything that comes with it.

“This was my plan when I signed here. I saw a big vision for this team. I felt like the team was ready to take that next step. I’m glad we were able to turn it around and prove that vision right. Now we’ll see where it goes.”

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BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Roman Anthony hit a two-run homer in the fifth, but flied out to right to end the game.

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

Rutschman gets shot and rest for sore elbow

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

Adley Rutschman's right elbow still is bothering him, but this week the Red Sox tried a new fix: a cortisone injection.

The catcher got the shot postgame Monday, timed specifically so that he could miss games Tuesday and Wednesday, take advantage of the team's offday Thursday, and — the Sox hope — return to the lineup Friday.

“As we came home . . . we were looking for a window to do that, to get him over the hump,” interim manager **Chad Tracy** said before the Red Sox' 6-4 loss to the Angels Wednesday night. “Nothing different happened there, just the timing of the cortisone injection, you had to give him those days.”

Although Rutschman has been dealing with this for more than two weeks, the Red Sox have resisted putting him on the injured list, steadfast in their belief that they can help him tolerate the pain with frequent days off. He has started just seven of the past 16 games, no more than two in a row.

Last week, Tracy said Rutschman likely would have to manage the problem through the end of the season. Post-cortisone, he is supposed to be in better shape.

“I think we should be in a good spot,” Tracy said. “The whole thought around that was, if we got to a point we were going to do that, then we time it right to get through the end of the season . . . It was threading a needle there.

“The hope is that with something like this that you're going to get a pretty significant amount of relief. That paired with the amount of offdays that we have coming up — certainly [Rutschman] is not going to catch every game, but if we get to a spot where it feels really, really good, hopefully you're going to be using him quite a bit. So we'll see.”

In place of Rutschman, the Red Sox' marquee midseason acquisition, Tracy gave **Mickey Gasper** a start at catcher. It was his first appearance in a major league game there since June 22.

He was a steady member of the catcher rotation with Triple-A Worcester in July and early August, but since returning to the big leagues, his duties had been limited to DH and first base.

The Sox gave Gasper advance notice, he said, allowing him to catch Wednesday starter **Jake Bennett's** bullpen session two days prior.

Shipping up to Portland

Willson Contreras (left hamstring strain) will join Double-A Portland on Friday for a rehab assignment likely to last just one or two games, Tracy said.

Although the Red Sox gave Contreras the option to return to the active roster without a stint in the minors, since he has only been out a week-plus, his preference was to face live pitching, so the Sox obliged.

“He's been down for a while,” Tracy said. “[Therefore, Contreras wants] to get on his feet and actually see some pitching, move around at first, maybe get on base. He just wants to move around a little bit in that setting, prior to jumping right back in. It's a matter of preference for different guys.”

White gets tested

Eli White got medical imaging done Wednesday on what Tracy described as a “very sore” right foot.

That foot got jammed in the grated portion of the center-field fence during a late-inning catch attempt Tuesday. He stayed in the game, including striking out for the final out.

“We were optimistic about it last night, but he definitely was more sore [Wednesday],” Tracy said.

Some personnel news

Garrett Crochet (left shoulder injury) is set for another bullpen session Friday, his third in eight days . . . **Tyron Guerrero** (right shoulder inflammation) will throw live batting practice Saturday, which could clear the way for his return next week . . . **Tanner Houck** (Tommy John surgery last year) averaged 93 miles per hour with his fastball and touched 95.5 in his first rehab appearance with Portland on Tuesday, per Tracy. He'll pitch in another such game Friday, for 40-45 pitches . . . **Ceddanne Rafaela** (right quad strain) took batting practice on the field with Contreras. “He's doing well and getting better quickly,” Tracy said . . . As part of Suicide Prevention & Awareness Month, the Red Sox hosted Samaritans, Inc., as well as the Connor's Climb Foundation, a New Hampshire-based organization focused on suicide prevention education. Visit samaritanshope.org and connorsclimb.org for more information.

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Angels make it tough for Bennett, Red Sox

►RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

Entering the final frame, the Sox trailed by three. They managed to bring the potential tying run to the plate against closer Ben Joyce, but Roman Anthony flied out to right field for the final out.

Bennett, 25, had looked better lately following a mid-to-late August rest period. But he regressed again in the early innings. The Angels' homer-centric success provided perhaps the reddest flag yet for Bennett, who had a 2.35 ERA in his first nine games and a 5.08 ERA over the next nine.

In each of his past two outings, he has given up multiple home runs.

In his previous 59 games across the majors and minors, he had never yielded more than one.

“I actually thought the ball was coming out of his hand pretty good tonight,” interim manager Chad Tracy said. “When he's really good, he's relying on executing location, and I think he just left some balls in hittable areas.”

Bennett said: “I just felt like I didn't have as good of command as I normally have, left some balls over the middle of the plate, and they got hit hard.”

An eight-pitch sequence in the third inning swung the game.

The inning opened with back-to-back scorched singles from Oswald Peraza and Denzer Guzman. Tyler Heineman's sacrifice bunt moved them up for the top of the lineup.

Zach Neto got ahold of a fastball on the outer third of the plate and shot it to left field, eking it over the Green Monster for a three-run blast — his sixth hit and second homer in two games.

“With a base open, it caught a lot of the plate,” Tracy lamented.

Mike Trout followed with a double, then Jose Siri came through with a two-run home run into the Red Sox' bullpen — another fastball, closer to the

Angels 6, Red Sox 4

At Fenway Park

LA ANGELS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Neto ss	3	1	2	3	0	0	.244
Trout cf	4	1	1	0	0	0	.244
Siri rf	4	1	2	2	0	0	.225
Grissom 1b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.245
Moore dh	3	0	0	0	1	3	.181
Paris lf	3	0	0	0	1	1	.000
Meckler lf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.298
Peraza 2b	4	1	2	0	0	1	.225
Guzman 3b	4	2	3	1	0	0	.227
Heineman c	3	0	2	0	0	0	.179
Totals	32	6	12	6	2	5	

BOSTON	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Anthony dh	5	1	1	2	0	3	.236
Gasper c	4	0	0	0	0	1	.264
Abreu rf	3	1	1	1	1	0	.256
Story ss	4	0	1	0	0	1	.233
Sogard 1b	4	0	1	0	0	2	.266
Durbin 3b	4	0	1	0	0	1	.248
Duran lf	3	2	2	0	1	0	.207
Falefa 2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.269
Eaton cf	4	0	1	1	0	0	.139
Totals	35	4	8	4	2	8	

LA Angels.....005 100 000 — 6 12 0

Boston.....000 021 001 — 4 8 0

LOB—LA 3, Bos. 6. 2B—Trout (24), HR—Neto (25), off Bennett, Siri (8), off Bennett, Guzman (7), off Bennett, Anthony (4), off Johnson, Abreu (24), off Johnson. CS—Moore (2), S—Heineman. Runners left in scoring position—LA 3 (Trout, Peraza, Heineman), Bos. 3 (Anthony 2, Falefa). RISP—LA 2 for 5, Bos. 1 for 5. Runners moved up—Duran, Eaton. GDP—Trout 2, Heineman. DP—Bos. 3.

LA Angels	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Johnson W 4-8	6	5	3	3	1	5	103	5.12
Watson	2½	1	0	0	0	0	6	4.19
Saucedo	½	0	0	0	0	1	6	3.24
Natera	1	1	0	0	0	1	20	2.35
Joyce S 4	1	1	1	1	1	1	22	3.18

Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Bennett L 9-7	5½	9	6	6	28	3	69	
Olds	1½	1	0	0	1	1	20	1.38
Moran	1	0	0	0	1	1	12	3.41
Gamboa	1	2	0	0	0	1	12	1.29

Inherited runners scored—Saucedo 1-0, Olds 1-0. HBP—by Olds (Neto). Umpires—Home, Carlos Torres; First, Jacob Metz; Second, Mark Wegner; Third, Bruce Dreckman. T—2:44. A—35,428 (37,755).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED												
THIRD INNING												
ANGELS — Peraza singled to center. Guzman singled to center, Peraza to second. Heineman sacrificed, first to second, Peraza to third, Guzman to second. Neto homered to left, Peraza and Guzman scored. Trout doubled to center. Siri homered to right, Trout scored. Grissom grounded out to third. Moore struck out.												
FOURTH INNING												
ANGELS — Paris flied out to right. Peraza lined out to right. Guzman homered to left. Heineman singled to center and was out advancing, center to second.												
FIFTH INNING												
RED SOX — Duran singled to center. Falefa flied out to right. Eaton lined out to center. Anthony homered to right, Trout scored. Gasper struck out.												
SIXTH INNING												
RED SOX — Abreu homered to center. Story flied out to left. Sogard grounded out to second. Durbin grounded out to short.												
NINTH INNING												
RED SOX — Durbin struck out. Duran walked. Falefa flied out to left. On defensive indifference, Duran to second. Eaton singled to right, Duran scored. On defensive indifference, Eaton to second. Anthony flied out to right.												

middle. It was just the third opposite-field homer by a right-handed hitter at Fenway this year.

“An 0-and-2 pitch that looked like it caught too much of a good area,” Tracy said.

Guzman added a solo shot in the fourth.

Against righthander Ryan Johnson, meanwhile, the Red Sox fared poorly — a surprise considering how they handled him in a July meeting (four in-

AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
New York.....	83	62	.572	—
Boston	80	67	.544	—
Cleveland	74	73	.503	—
Toronto	73	74	.497	1
Texas.....	72	74	.493	1½
Baltimore	71	76	.483	3
Minnesota.....	69	77	.473	4½
Seattle	68	78	.466	5½
Detroit	67	79	.459	6½
Kansas City.....	65	82	.442	9
Athletics.....	59	88	.401	15



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

The Angels used two homers to put five runs on the scoreboard in the third inning at Fenway.

Baseball

	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
EAST							
Tampa Bay	87	58	.600	—	—	6-4	W 2
New York	83	62	.572	4	—	7-3	W 2
Boston	80	67	.544	8	—	6-4	L 2
Toronto	73	74	.497	15	1	6-4	L 1
Baltimore	71	76	.483	17	3	3-7	W 1
CENTRAL							
Chicago	75	70	.517	—	—	3-7	L 2
Cleveland	74	73	.503	2	—	5-5	L 1
Minnesota	69	77	.473	6½	4½	5-5	L 1
Detroit	67	79	.459	8½	6½	4-6	W 1
Kansas City	65	82	.442	11	9	3-7	W 1
WEST							
Houston	74	72	.507	—	—	6-4	L 1
Seattle	72	74	.493	2	1½	6-4	L 1
Texas	68	78	.466	6	5½	4-6	W 1
Athletics	59	88	.401	15½	15	6-4	W 1
Los Angeles	56	90	.384	18	17½	4-6	W 2

	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
EAST							
Atlanta	85	61	.582	—	—	4-6	L 3
Philadelphia	82	64	.562	3	—	6-4	W 1
Miami	72	75	.490	13½	6½	3-7	L 3
New York	68	78	.466	17	10	7-3	W 4
Washington	67	81	.453	19	12	2-8	L 7
CENTRAL							
Milwaukee	91	56	.619	—	—	6-4	W 3
Chicago	81	66	.551	10	—	4-6	L 4
Pittsburgh	73	73	.500	17½	5	8-2	W 3
St. Louis	72	75	.490	19	6½	4-6	L 3
*Cincinnati	69	76	.476	21	8½	5-5	L 2
WEST							
*Los Angeles	88	57	.607	—	—	7-3	W 6
San Diego	78	68	.534	10½	—	6-4	W 4
Arizona	78	69	.531	11	½	5-5	L 1
San Francisco	62	85	.422	27	16½	6-4	W 3
Colorado	55	90	.379	33	22½	3-7	L 3

* — Not including late game

RESULTS					
WEDNESDAY					
LA Angels 6	at Boston 4	NY Mets 15	at Miami 14		
At Detroit 7	Minnesota 2	At NY Yankees 6	Colorado 1		
At Athletics 2	Toronto 0	Tampa Bay 7	at Atlanta 2		
At San Francisco 7	St. Louis 6	At Kansas City 5	Arizona 2		
At Seattle 3	Texas 2	At Milwaukee 8	Chi. Cubs 6		
At San Diego 9	Washington 2	Pittsburgh 4	at Chi. White Sox 2		
At Baltimore 9	Cleveland 5	Cincinnati	at LA Dodgers		
At Philadelphia 11	Houston 7				

TUESDAY					
LA Angels 6	at Boston 1	At Milwaukee 4 (10 inn.)	Chi. Cubs 3		
Cleveland 9	at Baltimore 5	Pittsburgh 9	at Chi. White Sox 3		
Houston 6	at Philadelphia 5	Texas 10	at Seattle 5		
Minnesota 3	at Detroit 2	Toronto 4	at Athletics 2		
NY Mets 7	at Miami 5	At San Diego 5	Washington 4		
At NY Yankees 5	Colorado 3	At San Francisco 2	St. Louis 1		
Tampa Bay 7	at Atlanta 1	At LA Dodgers 3	Cincinnati 2		
Arizona 5 (11 inn.)	at Kansas City 3				



THEARON W. HENDERSON/GETTY IMAGES

Henry Bolte broke a scoreless tie in the third inning with a solo home run to help the Athletics blank the Blue Jays and win the three-game series.

THURSDAY'S GAMES										
	Odds	W-L	ERA	rec.	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA
TAMPA BAY AT ATLANTA, 12:15 p.m.										
Martínez (R)	-105	14-4	3.04	21-6	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	18.1	2.95
Pérez (L)	-115	8-9	3.25	12-11	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	13.1	4.05
HOUSTON AT PHILADELPHIA, 1:05 p.m.										
Javier (R)	+145	2-5	5.98	2-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	13.0	4.15
Wheeler (R)	-170	12-5	3.23	17-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	16.0	5.63
TEXAS AT SEATTLE, 4:10 p.m.										
deGrom (R)	+110	10-9	3.96	14-13	0-0	14.0	1.29	1-1	16.2	5.40
Gilbert (R)	-130	11-9	3.71	17-11	0-2	17.0	3.71	1-2	14.2	7.36
COLORADO AT NY YANKEES, 7:05 p.m.										
Feltner (R)	+275	5-9	5.91	8-13	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	15.2	9.19
Fried (L)	-345	4-4	2.73	9-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-1	14.1	11.81
PITTSBURGH AT CHICAGO WHITE SOX, 7:40 p.m.										
Jones (R)	-110	3-6	4.46	7-10	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	14.2	3.07
Castillo (R)	-110	4-11	5.57	8-15	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-2	10.2	11.81
Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season.										

LEADERS										
AMERICAN LEAGUE						NATIONAL LEAGUE				
Through Tuesday's games						Through Tuesday's games				
BATTING	AB	R	H	BI	Av.	BATTING	AB	R	H	Av.
Alvarez, Hou.	514	94	160	317		Arraez, Phi.	544	64	172	316
Simpson, TB.	514	58	158	307		Gonzales, Pit.	504	67	154	306
Rice, N.Y.	553	84	169	306		González, Mla.	568	85	171	301
DeLaughter, Cle.	445	56	131	294		Moreno, Ari.	417	60	125	300
Caglianone, KC.	474	66	134	283		Rumfield, Col.	492	62	147	299
Rafaela, Bos.	535	67	151	282		Freeman, LAD.	525	72	156	297
Caminero, TB.	550	89	155	282		McCarthy, Col.	475	71	139	293
Witt, KC.	496	83	139	280		Harris, Atl.	526	67	152	289
Aranda, TB.	530	68	148	279		Chourio, Mil.	461	81	132	286
Greene, Det.	452	70	125	277		Burleson, StL.	553	81	157	284
HOME RUNS						HOME RUNS				
Caminero, TB.	39					Schwarber, Phi.	43			
Alvarez, Hou.	38					Armstrong, CHC.	41			
Rice, N.Y.	36					Olson, Atl.	37			
Alonso, Bal.	34					Goodman, Col.	37			
Montgomery, CWS.	31					Devers, SF.	35			
Witt, KC.	30					Stewart, Cin.	31			
Murakami, CWS.	30					Ohtani, LAD.	30			
Okamoto, Tor.	30					Wood, Wsh.	30			
Dingler, Det.	26					Abams, Wash.	30			
Contreras, R.	26					Lowe, Pit.	29			
RUNS BATTED IN						RUNS BATTED IN				
Alonso, Bal.	97					Stewart, Cin.	107			
Alvarez, Hou.	93					Burleson, StL.	104			
Caminero, TB.	93					Walker, StL.	100			
Rice, N.Y.	88					Armstrong, CHC.	97			
Adell, Cle.	86					Abams, Wsh.	95			
Aranda, TB.	86					Devers, SF.	92			
Bell, Min.	85					Schwarber, Phi.	85			
Dingler, Det.	83					Turang, Mil.	86			
Montgomery, CWS.	83					Lowe, Pit.	83			
Okamoto, Tor.	83									

NOTEBOOK

Mesa, Jax help Rays top Braves; Yankees win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Victor Mesa Jr. had two hits, including a home run, **Griffin Jax** gave up only two hits and one run in five innings, and the Rays beat the Braves, 7-2, on Wednesday night in Atlanta to clinch the series win in the match-up of division leaders.

Including a 7-1 win on Tuesday night, the Rays have outscored the Braves, 14-3, in the first two games of the three-game series.

AL East-leading Tampa Bay hit four homers in Tuesday night's win. Mesa's homer was the Rays' only extra-base hit on Wednesday night, but Tampa Bay outhit Atlanta, 10-3, and added three steals. **Jorge Mateo** had a two-run single in a three-run second inning.

Lombard leads Yankees

Rookie **George Lombard Jr.** became the second-youngest player in Yankees' history to hit a grand slam as New York beat the visiting Rockies, 6-1.

Aaron Judge singled in the third for his first hit since returning from a broken rib a day earlier and had another hit in the eighth before being lifted for a pinch runner. Judge went 2 for 4 and his only chance in right field was a catch on **Kyle Karros** near the foul line in the fourth.

At 21 years, 99 days, Lombard became the youngest Yankee to hit a grand slam since **Mickey Mantle** (20 years, 283 days) connected against **Chuck Stobbs** of the White Sox at Comiskey Park on July 29, 1952.

Yankees second baseman **Jazz Chisholm Jr.** was placed on the 10-day injured list with a sprained right thumb.

Chisholm was injured on a slide at second base trying to stretch a single in the eighth inning of Tuesday's 5-3 win. He was tagged out by **Ezequiel Tovar**, and his thumb appeared to hit the Colorado shortstop's cleat.

Brewers sweep Cubs

Christian Yelich hit a three-run homer, **Logan Henderson** threw five innings of two-hit ball, and the host Brewers completed a sweep of rival Chicago, holding on for an 8-6 victory to extend their NL Central lead to 10 games over the Cubs.

Jackson Chourio and **William Contreras** also homered for majors-leading Milwaukee (91-56).

Mets outslug Marlins

Francisco Lindor hit a three-run homer, and **Christopher Morel** added a two-run shot as he finished a triple shy of the cycle and the Mets outslugged the host Marlins, 15-14, to complete a series sweep.

Lindor hit his 18th homer of the season in a six-run seventh inning that put New York ahead to stay.

Bolte sparks Athletics

Henry Bolte hit a solo home run in the third inning and **Tyler White** scored on a wild pitch as the Athletics beat the visiting Blue Jays, 2-0.

Big inning carries Orioles

Dylan Beavers had two hits and three RBIs in an eight-run third inning that carried the host Orioles past the Guardians, 9-5.

Coby Mayo tacked on a sixth-inning homer for the Orioles, who had lost seven of eight before cranking up their offense against Cleveland lefty **Foster Griffin** (15-5).

The Orioles played versatile **Blaze Alexander** on the 10-day injured list and are hopeful shortstop **Gunnar Henderson** can recover quickly from a knee injury.

Tigers get past Twins

Colt Keith homered and the host Tigers ended a seven-series losing streak with a 7-2 win over the Twins.

The Tigers hadn't won a series since taking two of three from the Guardians Aug. 11-13. They had lost 16 of their last 24 games before Wednesday's win.

Giants rally past Cardinals

Shay Whitcomb's RBI double capped a six-run rally with two out in the eighth inning as the host Giants beat the Cardinals, 7-6, to complete a series sweep.

Giants first baseman **Rafael Devers** did not play. His games-played streak ended at 309 games, 236 of which came with San Francisco and the first 73 with Boston.

Merrill powers Padres

Jackson Merrill homered twice, had a career-high six RBIs, and fell a double short of a cycle to help the Padres beat the visiting Nationals, 9-2, after the hottest first-pitch temperature in Petco Park history at 95 degrees.

The previous record was 93 on Sept. 10, 2015, in a game against the Rockies. Petco Park opened in 2004.

Mariners' Anderson wins first

Rookie **Kade Anderson** picked up his first major league victory with six sharp innings, and **Cole Young** hit a two-run double as the host Mariners beat the Rangers, 3-2.

ATHLETICS 2, BLUE JAYS 0

	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Av.
TORONTO	4	0	1	0	0	0	.327
Bateman rf-cf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.250
McAdoo lf	4	0	1	0	0	0	.274
Lukes ph-rf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.246
Springer ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.260
Sánchez rf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.260
Guerrero 1b	3	0	0	0	1	0	.260
Kirk dh	3	0	1	1	1	1	.276
Okamoto 3b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.235
Giménez ss	4	0	1	0	0	0	.245
Clement 2b	3	0	1	0	1	0	.273
Valenzuela c	3	0	0	0	0	2	.215
Straw cf-1f	2	0	0	0	1	1	.236
Smith ph-1f	1	0	0	0	1	1	.226
Totals	31	0	6	0	3	9	

	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Av.
ATHLETICS	4	1	1	1	0	2	.277
Bolte cf-1f	4	1	1	1	0	2	.277
Butler rf	4	0	0	0	0	2	.225
Clout 3b	4	0	0	0	0	2	.251
Sewald	1	1	2	0	0	0	.259
Clarke cf	0	0	0	0	0	0	.

Schools



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

At 6-feet, 5-inches and 295 pounds, Xaverian right tackle Jack Warren is one of three MIAA linemen committed to Villanova.

It's a block party

These star offensive linemen are happy toiling in the trenches

By Nate Weitzer
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Before every highlight catch, every laser throw, and every game-breaking run, there is a solid block up front.

Quarterbacks and running backs get the spotlight, yet offensive linemen may have the most important job in football, and their performance is often only noted when they make a mistake.

It can be a selfless job, brutally demanding and mentally taxing, with little fanfare, so why have so many great athletes committed to setting the edge for top-tier MIAA programs?

“This is biased, but I think it’s the most important position on the field,” said Jack Warren, a 6-foot-5-inch, 295-pound senior right tackle at Xaverian. “You can’t play football without us. We start every play. We snap it. And those dudes don’t get the stats if we’re not doing our job.”

With a father (Brent Warren) who starred for Brockton’s back-to-back Super Bowl teams in the early 1990s at 6-5, 338 pounds, Warren seemed destined to anchor the line. The same could be said of Milton senior Matthew Wagner (6-6, 285), whose father, John, played at Notre Dame.

Along with Catholic Memorial tackle Logan Hernandez (6-4, 275), who joins Warren and Wagner as Villanova commits (Class of 2031), these titans had unique journeys to their posts on state title contenders.

Wagner thought he would pursue basketball through college, until he grew from 5-10 to 6-4 in two years and was called up to the varsity sideline at the end of his freshman season to watch Milton win a Division 3 Super Bowl in 2023.

Growing up in Roxbury, Hernandez and his twin brother, Jeremy, were basketball lifers. Something clicked when Logan decided to try football as a sophomore, and after winning a D2 Super Bowl last winter, he earned a full athletic scholarship to Villanova.

“I was just playing for the love of the game at first, and then I noticed my talents could translate to the collegiate level,” said Hernandez.

Warren grew up playing basketball and baseball, until his father let him don the pads in eighth grade. After undergoing elbow surgery two years ago, the West Bridgewater resident focused entirely on football.

“There’s a legacy to it. I don’t want to let [my dad] down. I want to go out and do my best. He’s known, I’ve known, for a long time, that I’m going to be a lineman,” said Warren, adding he has no regrets about abstaining from youth football leagues.

“I’m kind of thankful, because now I’m seeing some friends getting burnt out and losing their love for the sport. And I’m just getting started.”

To the untrained eye, it might look like offensive tackles depend on brute force to exert their will. So much more goes into the position, starting with countless hours spent improving agility, mobility, and strength. Then there’s the mental reps required to learn dozens of formations and play calls ahead of each season.

So it tracks that some of the best offensive tackles in the state avoided sport specialization.

Central Catholic senior captain Brian Waller-Reitano (6-3, 295) started wrestling in kindergarten and won youth states in New Hampshire from fifth through eighth grade. The son of standout Central Catholic lineman and wrestler Paul Reitano (’00)



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

Catholic Memorial tackle Logan Hernandez grew up playing basketball in Roxbury before finding football.

went 59-3 on the mat and finished second at New England’s last winter, then committed to play football at Navy.

“There’s definitely a connection with leverage and balance. If I didn’t wrestle, I don’t think I’d be the football player I am now,” said Waller-Reitano, a three-time Merrimack Valley All-Conference player who has never missed a game due to injury.

To win the battle up front requires full concentration. Waller-Reitano pointed out that it is the rare position in sport where players aren’t necessarily following the ball, because they’re engrossed in their own battles.

Other top tackles in the MIAA this year include Saint John’s of Shrewsbury senior Owen Kerr (6-6, 305) and Chelmsford behemoth Seamus Harrington (6-7, 315), who is headed to Maine.

Chelmsford coach George Peterson

Week 1 picks

THURSDAY’S GAMES

Mansfield at Bridgewater-Raynham (6 p.m.): Some offenses might start slow after a truncated preseason, but these programs are capable of lighting up the scoreboard with B-R’s playing an air-raid style under Eian Bain and Mike Redding’s Hornets bringing back plenty of experienced skill players. **Pick:** MANSFIELD.
Needham at Natick (6 p.m.): Natick graduated a stable of elite linebackers and Needham is still rebuilding after a generational run in 2024. Which Bay State contender will open with a win? **Pick:** NATICK.
Marshfield at Milton (7 p.m.): We’ve got a couple of heavy hitters on the offensive line for both of these Division 3 hopefuls. Matt Wagner (6 feet, 6 inches, 285 pounds) anchors the edge for Milton and Aidan Nicholson (6-5, 290) is the top blocker for Marshfield’s fast-paced attack. **Pick:** MILTON.
Catholic Memorial at Andover (7 p.m.): In his second year at the helm, Andover coach Jay Fielding wants to play one of the best teams in the state right off the bat. Catholic Memorial certainly fits the bill. **Pick:** CATHOLIC MEMORIAL.

FRIDAY’S GAMES

Brockton at Barnstable (6 p.m.): The Boxers look to return to form under new coach Mike Norman Jr. Up first is their annual meeting with a Barnstable squad that is always physical up front under Ross Jatkola. **Pick:** BARNSTABLE.
King Philip at Walpole (6:30 p.m.): After 20 years as an ace defensive coordinator for King Philip, former Walpole star Matt Wassel (’91) shifts to the other side of this rivalry as an assistant for his alma mater. What follows should be an interesting chess match against former offensive coordinator and new KP head coach Anthony Vizakis. **Pick:** WALPOLE.
Duxbury at Scituate (7 p.m.): Coming off a 24-1 run (excluding a calculated Thanksgiving loss) with two Super Bowls, Scituate returns all the key pieces up front in its quest to win another title. Duxbury would love to reset those expectations with a statement win over a Patriot League rival. **Pick:** SCITUATE.
Tewksbury at Foxborough (7 p.m.): Perennial powers in Division 4 and 5, respectively, these programs meet for the first time. Foxborough coach Jack Martinelli and Tewksbury’s Brian Aylward have combined for 535 wins over 73 seasons. **Pick:** FOXBOROUGH.
BC High at Central Catholic (7 p.m.): An injury-plagued season limited BC High last year and Central Catholic flamed out in the playoffs. The host Raiders look to start the John Dubzinski era with a big win. **Pick:** CENTRAL CATHOLIC.
St. John’s Prep at Springfield Central (7 p.m.): Prep came back for a last-minute victory (36-35) at Springfield in last year’s opener and the 2026 edition should be equally exciting. **Pick:** SPRINGFIELD CENTRAL.

NATE WEITZER

starred at New Hampshire during Sean Devine’s tenure (1995-08) as an assistant with the program. Now Devine is the offensive line coach at Villanova, and he recruited Thomas Brown (’25) from Chelmsford, setting the stage for a big recruiting class.

Along with Harrington, Chelmsford has a standout center in senior Brady Burnham (6-0, 265), a sizable left tackle in senior Nkunim Nkansah (6-3, 255), and a potential difference-maker at guard, junior Brady Mahoney (6-5, 320).

“It starts and ends with the line, on both sides of the football,” Peterson said. “Your name never gets called, you’re not going to have the ball, but you are the gatekeeper of success.”

When Wagner and Warren squared off at a preseason camp this summer, they came away with mutual respect. The sons of linemen, both work out several times per week, both individually and with their teams. They have worked tirelessly to improve their agility and stamina so they can take reps on the defensive line. And both know the tricks to gain leverage in physical bouts.

They’re also setting the example for new starters.

“If we’re not doing the right thing, that can ruin the rest of the team,” said Wagner, describing how he would lead the incoming sophomore and junior linemen through simulated plays on Fridays during the offseason. “That’s what I’m trying to install in everyone’s mind.”

“It’s all about being selfless. Some people get their name in the paper, but not everyone. You have one bad snap and everybody is yelling at you, but that’s one bad snap out of a hundred good ones. So you need to have that mind-set of being ready to take any criticism that’s thrown at you, and to still be ready for that next snap.”

Nate Weitzer can be reached at nweitzer7@gmail.com.

Football schedule

THURSDAY’S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
BAY STATE — Needham at Natick, 6; Wellesley at Braintree, 6.
CAPE ANN — Amesbury at Lynnfield, 6.
MIDDLESEX — Lexington at Burlington, 6; Reading at Melrose, 7.
TRI-VALLEY — Medfield at Medway, 6.
NONLEAGUE — Archbishop Williams at Oliver Ames, 6; Arlington Catholic at Belmont, 6; Brighton at Hamilton-Wenham, 6; Canton at Holliston, 6; Framingham at Milford, 6; Malden Catholic at Medford, 6; Mansfield at Bridgewater-Raynham, 6; Newton North at Waltham, 6; Saugus at Cambridge, 6; Stoughton at Norwood, 6; Concord-Carlisle at Danvers, 6:30; Longmeadow at Abington, 6:30; Lynn Classical at Winchester, 6:30; Newton South at Brookline, 6:30; Catholic Memorial at Andover, 7; Chelmsford at Lincoln-Sudbury, 7; Dighton-Rehoboth/Bristol Aggie at Sharon/Dedham, 7; Franklin at Wachusett, 7; Grafton at Westwood, 7; Lynn English at Marblehead, 7; Marshfield at Milton, 7; Portsmouth (R.I.) at Tri-County, 7; St. Mary’s at Swampscott, 7.

FRIDAY’S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
CAPE ANN — Manchester Essex at Newburyport, 6:30.
MERRIMACK VALLEY — North Andover at Methuen, 7.
PATRIOT — Duxbury at Scituate, 7; Hingham at Hanover, 7; Pembroke at Whitman-Hanson, 7; Plymouth South at Silver Lake, 7.
SOUTH COAST — Somerset Berkley at Fairhaven, 6:30.
NONLEAGUE — Dover-Sherborn at Southeastern, 6; Norwell at Blue Hills, 4; Hopkinton at Wayland, 5; Arlington at Everett, 6; Bishop Feehan at Xaverian, 6; Brockton at Barnstable, 6; Cardinal Spellman at Wilmington, 6; Falmouth at West Bridgewater, 6; Greater Lowell at North Reading, 6; Hull at TechBoston, 6; Lynn Tech at Malden, 6; Mashpee at Martha’s Vineyard, 6; Minnechaug at Doherty, 6; Peabody at Somerville, 6; Quincy at Revere, 6; Randolph at English High, 6; Triton/pswich at Cathedral, 6; Wakefield at Greater Lawrence, 6; Wareham at Carver, 6; Westford at Lowell, 6; Weston at Latin Academy, 6; Woburn at Bellingham, 6; Ashland at Westborough, 6:30; Attleboro at Dorchester, 6:30; Billerica at Masconomet, 6:30; Diman at Joseph Case, 6:30; Greater New Bedford at New Bedford, 6:30; King Philip at Walpole, 6:30; KIPP at Salem, 6:30; Minuteman at Southbridge, 6:30; Monomoy/JP II at Cape Cod Tech, 6:30; Old Colony at Seekonk, 6:30; Pentucket/Georgetown at Dracut, 6:30; Plymouth North at Old Rochester, 6:30; Watertown at Whitier, 6:30; Winthrop at Essex Tech, 6:30; Apponequet at Middleborough, 7; BC High at Central Catholic, 7; Beverly at Haverhill, 7; Chelsea at Lowell Catholic, 7; Dartmouth at Bishop Stang, 7; Dennis-Yarmouth at Rockland, 7; East Boston at Boston Latin, 7; Groton-Dunstable/NM at Acton-Boxborough, 7; Lawrence at Ayer Shirley/Bromfield/Littleton, 7; North Quincy at Cohasset, 7; Shawheen at Bedford, 7; South Shore Voc-Tech at Neshoba Valley Tech, 7; St. John’s Prep at Springfield Central, 7; Stoneham at Gloucester, 7; Taunton at Weymouth, 7; Tewksbury at Foxborough, 7.

SATURDAY’S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
NONLEAGUE — Bishop Fenwick at Northeast, 10:30a; Sandwich at Upper Cape, 11a; Atlantis at Hope (R.I.), 12; Bay Path at Norton, 12; Bourne at Burricoat, 12; Mills at Blackstone-Millville, 12; Oakmont at Nauset, 1:30; Bristol-Plymouth at Mt. Hope (R.I.), 2; East Bridgewater at Nantucket, 2.

HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS’ SOCCER NOTEBOOK

Masconomet aims to reclaim D2 title

By Eli Cloutier

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Alison Lecesce has experienced 10 senior classes as the Masconomet girls’ soccer coach.

The 2026 edition is special, in numbers (13) and talent. In the past three seasons, the group has fueled a 57-5-4 run, outscoring opponents, 185-30.

“We’ve never had a class both as large and as talented as this one,” Lecesce said.

As sophomores, they were key cogs as Masconomet won the Division 2 title with a 5-0 victory over Duxbury. Last season, Duxbury ended the Chieftains’ season in the state semifinals.

Lecesce knows the loss will always be in the back of her players’ minds. But she trusts them to stay mentally strong and take the season one day at a time.

“It was definitely a difficult way to end, but that year we battled a lot,” senior captain **Maggie Blosser** said. “We can build off that and step it up again this year.”

Blosser and her twin sister, **Lily** — both committed to play at Maryland — headline the class alongside fellow captains **Sadie Morris** and **Ada Paglierani**, a stellar duo at centerback.

Maggie Blosser, a two-time Globe All-Scholastic selection, recorded 10 goals and six assists last season after a 34-goal, 12-assist sophomore campaign. Her sister, Lily, a midfielder, was sidelined last season with a torn ACL.

“It was pretty hard to watch and not be able to play,” Lily said. “So it’s so great to be able to play again.”

It’s a sentiment echoed by her teammates.

“We can trust Lily no matter where she is on the field,” said Morris. “Especially as her friend, it’s just great to see her back out there.”

In the back is senior keeper **Evy Mills** (38 career shutouts), a calming presence in goal and a strong communicator.

The Chieftains opened their season Tuesday with a 4-0 Northeastern Conference victory over visiting Peabody. Maggie Blosser and sophomore forward **Ella Cammarata** each scored twice, and Mills notched a clean sheet.

Masconomet took time to settle into the game, but once the Chieftains broke through, it opened up in their favor. The Chieftains play a style built on versatility: when they control the run of play, they hold possession and progress up the field quickly, but they’re just as comfortable striking on the counter.

“We’re really lucky that we have a deep bench this year, especially because we can punish teams later in the game when we have these pressure legs,” Lecesce said.

What sets Masco apart is not the sheer number of seniors, but the fact that most grew up playing youth soccer together.

“It also has built a layer of trust between all of us,” Morris said. “We all know that we have each other’s backs, and we all support each other wherever we are on the field, no matter who we’re playing with.”

The season’s ultimate goal: reclaiming the Division 2 title. Every year, Lecesce puts the state final on the schedule so the Chieftains are always aiming for

Globe Top 20

No.		Rec.	Last
1.	Medfield	0-0	1
2.	Bishop Feehan	1-0	2
3.	Duxbury	1-0	3
4.	Concord-Carlisle	1-0	4
5.	Wellesley	0-0	5
6.	Natick	0-0	6
7.	Franklin	1-0	7
8.	Masconomet	1-0	8
9.	Norwell	0-0	9
10.	Central Catholic	1-0	10
11.	Hopkinton	0-0	11
12.	Needham	0-0	12
13.	Hingham	1-0	13
14.	Braintree	0-0	14
15.	Winchester	0-0	15
16.	Belmont	0-0	16
17.	Cohasset	0-0	20
18.	Lynnfield	1-0	-
19.	Lincoln-Sudbury	0-1	18
20.	King Philip	0-1	17

the top, but the focus remains on the next practice or game.

The ultimate reminder? Masconomet had its 60-game unbeaten streak snapped in last year’s opener, 1-0, to Marblehead.

“We’re trying to take this season one game at a time and focus on each individual team,” Morris said. “Our team honestly really needed it because prior to that, there had been a lot of pressure.”

Corner kicks

■ Walpole junior **Aubrie Ma** received the news of a lifetime last week: she was one of 24 players selected for the US under-17 national team training camp in Fayetteville, Ga., held from Sept. 7-14.

When she told coach **Peter Salmans** before last Tuesday’s scrimmage against Sharon, he initially misheard her and failed to grasp the magnitude of the news.

“I thought it was like an ID clinic, which, I know she’s had those,” said Salmans. “She posted on Instagram, then I saw, ‘Oh jeez, she’s actually on the national team roster.’”

Despite the initial miscommunication, Salmans wasn’t surprised that Ma had earned the call-up.

“Her ceiling as a player is clear,” said Salmans.

A forward for her club team, NEFC, Salmans plans to use Ma as an attacking midfielder to get her on the ball as frequently as possible. Against top Bay State foes Natick, Wellesley, and Needham, Ma has the one-on-one skills to break out of pressure and the vision to set up her teammates in transition.

“There were coaches that came up to me last season and were just like, ‘Jeez. We tried to throw different things at her, different players at her, and there’s just nothing we could do to stop her,’” said Salmans.

Junior center back **Madison Walzer** and senior captain forwards **Ryan McDonnell** and **Katie McDonald** are among eight returning starters looking to advance out of the first round for the first time since 2021.

“We’re really hoping to get over the hump and win our first playoff game,” said Salmans. “I think our team has the potential to go further.”

Correspondent Henry Dinh-Price contributed to this story.



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE GLOBE

Maggie Blosser helped Masconomet win a state title as a sophomore, and hopes to cap her senior year with another.

Commissioner search is critical for the WNBA

►SULLIVAN
Continued from Page C1

league is flourishing more than it ever has.

Before we look forward, it's important to look back. Engelbert's seven-year term as the league's first official commissioner (her predecessors all carried the title president), from a business perspective, oversaw quantifiable successes. A lucrative media-rights deal, a new collective bargaining agreement, viewership, attendance, franchise expansion, outside investment — all of it increased exponentially.

But over time, and with alarming frequency, Engelbert repeatedly showed an inability to meet the league's important, public-facing moments. Foremost among that was her relationship with players, which never needed to be chummy to the point of acquiescence, but needed a softness of touch. (Consistently referring to players as just another set of “stakeholders” was not the best approach.) Engelbert was maddeningly slow to understand issues that mattered most to those players, and she lost their trust when they felt she failed to stand up for them.

What started out with such promise, when Engelbert oversaw the successful “Wubble” 2020 season during the COVID-19 pandemic and later introduced the in-season Commissioner's Cup, has been hurtling downhill.

She failed to manage Clark's amazing entry into the league, somehow ill-prepared for scrutiny and interest that everyone saw coming given Clark's transcendent collegiate career. Engelbert had to be dragged into getting chartered air travel for players, who were concerned not simply over issues of comfort or physical recovery, but of safety, with public travel exposing them to scary public confrontation.

She was slow to acknowledge obvious issues with poor officiating. She bungled the chance for a seamless entry into the Boston market, letting the Sun move to Houston despite a more lucrative offer from a former Celtics owner. She fumbled an answer about the rise of social media vitriol, particularly racist and misogynistic comments, aimed at players, spinning it as something positive because it reflected the passion of sports rivalries.

And, most recently, she left a gaping leadership void while the likes of Enes Kanter Freedom and Royce White hijacked the league for their own misguided debate about trans athletes in sports, declaring themselves female and entering the WNBA Draft in a ploy to exploit transgender athletes in the league (of which there are none, zero, nada).

Clearly, Engelbert's time has run out. It will be fascinating to see what the WNBA values in finding the next commissioner. Another business-heavy résumé that lands squarely behind Silver and the NBA in the pecking order of autonomy? Or might Silver and Co. seek out more of a basketball insider, someone with league history, a la former player/front office veteran Swin Cash or Bethany Donaphin (currently the WNBA's head of league operations)?

The time feels right for a strong personality to be in charge, someone willing to stand ground on the important issues of inclusivity, social justice, and advocacy that formed the bedrock of the league since its inception 30 years ago. At the same time, though, a person who can continue to oversee enough growth in revenue that the necessary financial ties to the NBA grow looser and looser.

Silver declined a request from the Globe to comment on what the search might focus on, but in parsing his comments upon Engelbert's announcement, it does seem clear the balance between business and leadership is important.

“Cathy has presided over the WNBA through the most significant period of growth in the league's 30-year history,” he said. “We are grateful for Cathy's leadership and unwavering commitment to the advancement of women's basketball.”

The league's celebratory 30th season returns to action after the conclusion of the FIBA World Cup this weekend, and the countdown to Engelbert's departure begins in earnest.

“In 2019, I had the privilege of being appointed the league's first commissioner and to lead a league with enormous potential yet untapped awareness and significant undervaluation. Over the years, it has been amazing to watch WNBA players thrive and lead the massive cultural surge around women's sports,” she said in her announcement.

“I retire knowing we have built something bigger, stronger, and more enduring than we could have imagined. I am grateful to the WNBA and NBA team owners and staff, players, investors, fans, and the powerhouse league office staff, who believed in what this league could become. I retire with immense gratitude and tremendous optimism for the future of the WNBA, with the best yet to come.”

Time will tell.

Tara Sullivan is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at tara.sullivan@globe.com. Follow her @Globe_Tara.

SportsLog

Coach, analyst Melrose dies

Barry Melrose, a hockey player-turned-coach who led the Kings to the 1993 Stanley Cup Final before going on to a long career in broadcasting the sport, has died. He was 70. ESPN announced Melrose's death Wednesday after his wife informed the network. Melrose stepped away from his analyst role in 2023 after being diagnosed with Parkinson's disease. **Wayne Gretzky** at the time said Melrose was “bigger than any team.” Melrose had a relatable everyman's broadcasting style, bringing a sense of humor to his insights, and was easily recognized by his goatee and slicked-back hair. “For decades, Barry Melrose was one of the most distinctive and trusted voices in hockey,” ESPN said in a statement. “His knowledge of the game was deep, his candor was refreshing and his passion was unmistakable.” Melrose spent 2½ years with the Kings before getting fired. He joined ESPN in 1996 and was there until 2023, except for a 16-game stint coaching the Lightning in 2008-09.

Ducks waive Boxford native Kreider

The Ducks placed veteran forward **Chris Kreider** on waivers in the first step to terminate his contract, a person with knowledge of the move confirmed to the Associated Press. Kreider is a 14-year NHL veteran who completed his first season in Anaheim and was entering the final year of his contract. By terminating the contract, the Ducks will free up \$6.5 million in salary cap space. Kreider, 35, must first clear waivers, after which he would become an unrestricted free agent. The Boston College product had 22 goals and 50 points in 75 games last season. Overall, he's an 11-time 20-goal-scorer who spent his first 13 seasons with the Rangers.

MISCELLANY

Gazdag bags winner late for Revolution

In his second appearance with the Revolution, **Dániel Gazdag** delivered. His 93rd-minute goal gave New England a 2-1 win over New York City FC at Citi Field. **Ilay Feingold** crossed into the box, Gazdag chested it down to his right foot, and buried the winner past **David Freese**. The pair appeared to give New England the lead moments prior, only to have a goal called back for offside. **Carles Gil** gave the Revolution (12-8-4, 40 points) a 1-0 lead in the 12th minute on a penalty after **Aiden O'Neill** was called for a handball. **Luighi** had tied the game for NYCFC in the 71st minute, tapping in a goalmouth pass from **Nicolás Fernández**. The Revolution are 2-1-0 on their current four-game road trip that comes to an end Sunday at Orlando City . . . **Han Xu** had 21 points and 11 rebounds to help China top Puerto Rico, 75-72, in the qualifying round of the women's FIBA World Cup in Berlin. **Isobel Borlase** scored 30 points and **Zitina Aoku-so** made a go-ahead layup with 24 seconds left to help Australia hold off Italy, 82-80. Australia will play Spain in the quarterfinals while China faces France. The US will face Hungary and host Germany plays Belgium.

Schools

CROSS-COUNTRY	
BOYS	
BAY STATE	
Brookline 15.....	Needham 50
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Nantucket 20.....	Sturgis East 39
Nantucket 18.....	Sturgis West 43
Nauset 24.....	Monomoy 32
Sturgis West 28.....	Sturgis East 30
CMAC	
Keefe Tech 19.....	Monty Tech 42
COMMONWEALTH	
Shawsheen 25.....	Whittier 30
GREATER BOSTON	
Somerville 23.....	Revere 38
NORTHEASTERN	
Beverly 24.....	Danvers 31
Peabody 22.....	Marblehead 37
Swampscott 15.....	Salem 50
NONLEAGUE	
Dartmouth 27.....	Bp. Stang 28
Falmouth 16.....	Barnstable 39
GIRLS	
BAY STATE	
Needham 27.....	Brookline 30
Wellesley 15.....	Frammingham 50
Weymouth 20.....	Wellesley 37
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Nauset 24.....	Monomoy 37
Sturgis East 19.....	Nantucket 41
Sturgis East 20.....	Sturgis West 38
Sturgis West 23.....	Nantucket 34
CMAC	
Monty Tech 24.....	Keefe Tech 32
GREATER BOSTON	
Somerville 16.....	Revere 49
NORTHEASTERN	
Danvers 26.....	Beverly 32
Swampscott 17.....	Salem 44
NONLEAGUE	
Dartmouth 25.....	Bp. Stang 32
Falmouth 19.....	Barnstable 36

FIELD HOCKEY	
BAY STATE	
Milton 2.....	Brookline 0
Natick 8.....	Frammingham 0
Walpole 6.....	Braintree 0
Wellesley 2.....	Newton North 1
CAPE ANN	
Essex Tech 4.....	Triton 1
Ham. Wenham 4.....	Amesbury 1
Manchester 5.....	Rockport 1
Newburyport 2.....	Lynnfield 1
N. Reading 3.....	Pentucket 2
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
Notre Dame (H) 5.....	Ursuline 3
COUNTY	
Belchertown 6.....	Amherst-Pelham 0
DUAL COUNTY	
Concord-Carlisle 7.....	Bedford 1
Walham 5.....	Westford 0
Weston 4.....	Newton South 1
MERRIMACK VALLEY	
Andover 6.....	Lowell 0
Central Cath. 3.....	Tewksbury 0
Chelmsford 7.....	Haverhill 0
Methuen 6.....	Dracut 0
MID-WACH	
Marlborough 4.....	Algonquin 1
PATRIOT	
Duxbury 2.....	Marshfield 1
Hingham 6.....	Hanover 0
Pembroke 0.....	Plymouth North 0
Scutuate 11.....	Plymouth South 0
Silver Lake 3.....	Whit. Hanson 1
NONLEAGUE	
Barnstable 5.....	Sturgis East 1
Bay Path/David Prouty 3.....	Gr. Lowell 1
Belmont 2.....	Watertown 1
Black-Mill. B.....	Wor. Tech/Wor. North 0
Carver 4.....	Fairhaven 0
Doherty 4.....	Tyngsboro 2
Gardner 2.....	Bromfield 1
Grafton 16.....	Oxford 0
Groton-Dunstable 2.....	Lunenburg 0
Hopedale 4.....	Nipmuc 0
Littleton 1.....	Clinton 1
Naragansett 9.....	Maynard 0
NDA-Worcester 2.....	Leominster 1
Peabody 3.....	Revere 1
Quabbin 3.....	Shrewsbury 0
St. Paul 4.....	South High 0
Shepherd Hill 3.....	South High 0
S. Hadley 3.....	Smith Academy 0
Uxbridge 9.....	Northbridge 0

GOLF	
BOYS	
BAY STATE	
Frammingham 256.....	Newton 241
Milton 229.....	Needham 233
Natick 233.....	Brookline 237
Walpole 238.....	Braintree 250
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Dennis-Yarmouth 281.....	Falmouth 250
CAPE ANN	
Newburyport 181.....	Lynnfield 156
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
Xaverian 209.....	Malden Cath. 239
CMAC	
St. Paul 165.....	Monty Tech 168
DUAL COUNTY	
Boston Latin 223.....	Westford 250
Newton South 228.....	Lincoln-Sudb. 229
Walham 238.....	Concord-Carlisle 232
Weston 244.....	Walton 249
HOCKOMOCK	
Milford 158.....	Taunton 166
MAYFLOWER	
Blue Hills 123.....	Old Colony 2
MERRIMACK VALLEY	
Andover 231.....	Chelmsford 237
Andover 231.....	Chelmsford 237
Central Cath. 237.....	Haverhill 237
Chelmsford 237.....	Tewksbury 279
Dracut 280.....	Billerica 233
Dracut 280.....	N. Andover 232
N. Andover 232.....	Billerica 233
NORTHEASTERN	
Marblehead 432.....	Beverly 282
Massconnet 39.....	Danvers 33
PATRIOT	
Duxbury 240.....	Marshfield 248
Hanover 236.....	Quincy 276
Scutuate 241.....	N. Quincy 277
Whit. Hanson 218.....	Plymouth North 241
PIONEER	
Dartmouth 122.....	Barnstable 128
SOUTH COAST	
Apponequet 259.....	Digh-Rehoboth 271
SOUTH SHORE	
Abington 122.....	Rockland 98
Norwell 111.....	Bridgewater 89
SUBURBAN	
Hampshire 163.....	Belchertown 17
TRI-VALLEY	
Dover-Sherborn 206.....	Hopkinton 227
NONLEAGUE	
Easthampton 167.....	Monson 186
Marlborough 183.....	Millbury 185
Norwood 226.....	Weymouth 238
St. John's (S) 177.....	Shrewsbury 201
Taunton 166.....	Turners Falls 195
Tantasqua 162.....	E. Longmeadow 130

SOCCER	
BOYS	
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
Card. Spellman 5.....	Cathedral 0
CMAC	
Assabet 4.....	Hopedale 1
HOCKOMOCK	
Stoughton 5.....	Canton 0
SOUTH COAST	
Digh-Rehoboth 3.....	Bourne 1
Fairhaven 1.....	Apponequet 0
Gr. New Bedford 2.....	Joseph Case 1
Old Rochester 3.....	Seekonk 0
TRI-COUNTY	
Somerset Berkley 3.....	W. Bridgewater 1
TRI-VALLEY	
Franklin City Tech 3.....	Smith Voc. 2
TRI-VALLEY	
Bellingham 4.....	Medway 0
Dedham 1.....	Dover-Sherborn 0
Hopkinton 1.....	Holliston 0
Medfield 8.....	Ashtland 0
Norton 3.....	Millis 2
Westwood 4.....	Norwood 1
NONLEAGUE	
Abby Kelley Foster 3.....	Parker Charter 1
Arlington 2.....	Wilmington 1
Belmont 3.....	Watertown 2
Burncoat 0.....	South High 0
Chicopee 6.....	Frontier 2
Keefe Tech 5.....	Bay Path 0
New Bedford 5.....	Barnstable 0
Oliver Ames 4.....	Needham 0
Reading 3.....	Melrose 1
Southeastern 3.....	Randolph 1
Tri-County 6.....	Old Colony 1
Wakefield 2.....	Woburn 0
Westfield 2.....	Springfield Central 0
Winchester 5.....	Stonham 1
GIRLS	
BAY STATE	
Needham 5.....	Brookline 0
COMMONWEALTH	
Lowell Cath. 5.....	Minuteman 3
COOMBS	
Minnechaug 5.....	Westfield 2
SOUTH COAST	
Digh-Rehoboth 6.....	Bourne 2
Old Rochester 5.....	Somerset Berkley 1
TRI-VALLEY	
Dover-Sherborn 2.....	Dedham 0
Hopkinton 1.....	Holliston 0
Medfield 4.....	Ashtland 0
NONLEAGUE	
Arlington 2.....	Wilmington 0
Auburn 1.....	Northbridge 1
Blue Hills 1.....	Holbrook 0
Hopedale 6.....	South High 0
Keefe Tech 2.....	Weyland 2
Leicester 3.....	Uxbridge 1
Lexington 3.....	Burlington 1
Malden Cath. 2.....	Dracut 2
Melrose 3.....	Reading 0
Monte 2.....	Weyland 2
Montrose 2.....	Beaver CD 1
Mt. Greylock 5.....	Mount Anson (Vt.) 1
O'Byrant 1.....	Fontbonne 0
Oxford 11.....	Worcester Tech 0
Pittsfield 4.....	Drury 3
St. Mary's 7.....	Lynn Classical 0
Sutton 3.....	Medway 1
Tri-County 1.....	Old Colony 0
Ursuline 1.....	Latin Acad. 0
Westford 1.....	Boston Latin 0
Winchester 3.....	Stonham 0

VOLLEYBALL	
GIRLS	
BAY STATE	
Braintree 3.....	Walpole 0
Brookline 3.....	Milton 0
Natick 3.....	Frammingham 0
Newton North 3.....	Wellesley 2
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Nantucket 3.....	Nauset 2
Sandwich 3.....	Sturgis East 1
CENTRAL	
Ware 3.....	Springfield Sci-Tech 0
DUAL COUNTY	
Acton-Boxboro 3.....	Lincoln-Sudbury 1
Bedford 3.....	Concord-Carlisle 1
Cambridge 3.....	Boston Latin 0
Newton South 3.....	Weston 0
Westford 3.....	Waltham 0
MAYFLOWER	
Bristol Aggie 3.....	Southeastern 0
Holbrook 3.....	Blue Hills 0
South Shore 3.....	Bristol-Plymouth 0
Tri-County 3.....	Old Colony 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY	
Chelmsford 3.....	Lowell 0
NORTHEASTERN	
Beverly 3.....	Peabody 2
Massconnet 3.....	Marblehead 0
Swampscott 3.....	Salem 0
SOUTH COAST	
Digh-Rehoboth 3.....	Bourne 1
Fairhaven 3.....	Apponequet 0
Joseph Case 3.....	Gr. New Bedford 0
Old Rochester 3.....	Seekonk 0
SOUTH SHORE	
Carver 3.....	Abington 0
TRI-VALLEY	
Ashland 3.....	Medfield 2
Bellingham 3.....	Medway 0
Hopkinton 3.....	Holliston 0
Norton 3.....	Millis 0
Norwood 3.....	Westwood 0
NONLEAGUE	
Abby Kelley Foster 3.....	Wor. Tech 0
Barnstable 3.....	Notre Dame (H) 0
Bp. Feehan 3.....	La Salle (R.L.) 0
Brookton 3.....	Card. Spellman 0
Cristo Rey 3.....	Nashoba Tech 1
Danvers 3.....	Triton 0
Doherty 3.....	Marlborough 0
Keefe Tech 3.....	Blackstone-Millville 2
Lynn English 3.....	Georgetown 0
Monty Tech 3.....	University Park 0
Wareham 3.....	Rising Tide Charter 0

■ For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/high-schools.

College football

THURSDAY'S GAME	
Florida A&M at Miami.....	8
FRIDAY'S GAMES	
Rutgers at Boston College.....	7:30
Richmond at NC State.....	7
Norfolk St. at Virginia.....	7
Villanova at Louisville.....	7
Missouri at Kansas.....	8

Basketball

FIBA WOMEN'S WORLD CUP	
QUARTERFINALS	
Thursday's games	
United States vs. Hungary.....	5:30a
China vs. France.....	5:30a
Belgium vs. Germany.....	11:45a
Australia vs. Spain.....	2:45

Soccer

MLS

EASTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Nashville.....	24	16	5	3	53
Miami.....	23	12	7	4	43
New England.....	24	12	4	8	40
Charlotte.....	24	11	6	7	39
Chicago.....	22	11	5	6	38
Orlando.....	24	9	4	11	31
Cincinnati.....	23	8	7	8	31
Philadelphia.....	24	8	6	10	30
NYCFC.....	24	7	8	9	29
Toronto.....	24	6	11	7	29
NY Red Bulls.....	23	7	10	7	29
D.C. United.....	22	5	10	7	25
Columbus.....	23	6	5	12	23
Atlanta.....	24	6	4	14	22
Montreal.....	24	5	6	13	21

WESTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Vancouver.....	22	13	4	5	43
Houston.....	22	12	4	7	40
L.A.F.C.....	24	10	7	7	37
Dallas.....	23	10	7	6	37
St. Louis.....	23	7	6	10	27
San Jose.....	23	10	5	8	35
Colorado.....	23	10	1	12	31
Portland.....	23	9	4	10	31
San Diego FC.....	23	8	6	9	30
Real Salt Lake.....	22	8	9	5	29
Minnesota.....	23	7	8	8	29
Seattle.....	23	7	8	8	29
Seattle.....	22	6	9	7	27
Austin.....	23	6	7	10	25
Spokane FC.....	23	4	3	16	15

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS

New England 2

at Charlotte 1

at D.C. United 2

Columbus 1

at Toronto 2

Nashville 1

Charlotte 2

at Montreal 1

Orlando 3

at Atlanta 2

Philadelphia 5

at Chicago 0

Miami 2

at Chicago 1

Real Salt Lake

at Houston 0

Dallas

at Minnesota 0

Colorado

at Austin 0

LA Galaxy

at Vancouver 0

St. Louis

at Portland 0

NY Red Bulls

at L.A.F.C 0

San Jose

at San Diego FC 0

Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

BOSTON BASU, John Arun ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj SMITH, Dennis A. BRIDGEWATER PRUNIER, Theresa BRIGHTON BASU, John Arun	DEDHAM CLEARY, Anne Tredennick JOHNSON, Dorothy DORCHESTER SMITH, Dennis A. HINGHAM GORFINKLE, Constance S. LEXINGTON RICCI, Steven Anthony	LYNNFIELD PHILLIPS, Joann MILTON SMITH, Dennis A. NEEDHAM CLEARY, Anne Tredennick ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj NEWTON BASU, John Arun ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj	VACHON , AnnLee OSTERVILLE CLEARY, Anne Tredennick RANDOLPH OBEY, Theresa R. SOMERVILLE RICCI, Steven Anthony STOUGHTON OBEY, Theresa R.	WELLESLEY CLEARY, Anne Tredennick ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj WESTON CLEARY, Anne Tredennick WESTWOOD OBEY, Theresa R. WEYMOUTH OBEY, Theresa R. SMITH, Dennis A.	OUT OF STATE CALIFORNIA DUBREUIL, Francis William FLORIDA PHILLIPS, Joann MAINE PHILLIPS, Joann	NEW YORK SMITH, Dennis A. RHODE ISLAND ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj
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GORFINKLE, Constance S.

She filled a corner of this world with light.

Constance “Connie” (née Golub) Gorfinkle, age 91, of Hingham, Massachusetts, died peacefully in her sleep, on the morning of September 8, 2026.

Nearly 70 years before her passing, as a young literature student at Bennington College in Vermont, Connie wrote about the lifelong search to understand oneself and, through that understanding, the world. “The bard must first study himself,” she wrote in her 1957 senior thesis. “He must understand his being —his desires, his fears — and then he may begin to understand the world.”

In many ways, Connie spent the rest of her life doing exactly that: looking closely, asking questions, and sharing her creativity, perspective, and love of art with the world around her.

Born to Sadie and Paul Golub in 1935, Connie was raised in Newton, Massachusetts and graduated from Newton North High School. She went on to attend Bennington College, embarking upon what would become a truly formative period in her life. In a publication marking her class’s 50th reunion, she wrote that her primary interest at Bennington had been “to shape a human being out of the chaotic and confused girl who arrived at college.” She sought out professors across disciplines, from literature to history, later acknowledging their role in teaching her how to think, research, and work.

In 1957, Connie married Herbert “Herb” Gorfinkle, with whom she built a life and family in Hingham. Together they raised three daughters, Elisabeth, Jeanne and Anne. Reflecting on their 47-year marriage, Connie frequently credited Herb, with supporting her work outside the home and making it possible for her to both be a mother and pursue her passions as an arts critic. They also bonded over their shared love of Hingham, which became deeply important to them both. Connie was involved with the Hingham Historical Society, while Herb served for many years as Harbor Commissioner.

Connie’s professional life grew from the two passions that had animated her at Bennington: literature and the arts. Following graduation, she began her career volunteering at the Museum of Fine Arts and the Museum of Science in Boston, as well as doing

promotional work for a regional theater company. Around 1965, she found what she would later describe as her dream job: theater and arts critic for “The Patriot Ledger” in Quincy.

She would remain with The Patriot Ledger for more than four decades, covering theater, film, dance, opera, crafts, literature, and the fine arts. In retirement, she continued writing, contributing pro bono to the South Shore Art Center and the Atlantic Symphony Orchestra. For Connie, art was more than entertainment. In her senior thesis, she described the creative impulse as an “everlasting fire” that had to be sustained, and art itself as an offering capable of refining and enlarging human life. Her career became, in its own way, an expression of that belief.

Her life was also marked by profound loss. Connie and Herb’s daughter, Elisabeth, died at only 38, followed by Herb two years later. Decades afterward, Connie wrote candidly that his death had in some ways been even harder because she felt “utterly alone in [her] grief”. But she also wrote of the love and support provided by her daughters Jeanne and Anne and the joy she found in her grandchildren.

Her later life included a move to Hull and a deepening involvement with the Old Ship Church congregation in Hingham. Connie liked to say that it was the Old Ship Meetinghouse’s striking architecture — the 900-year-old timbers supporting the building’s dramatic vaulted ceiling — that first drew her toward Unitarian Universalism and the community that would sustain her through old age. At Old Ship, she found purpose, a new way to express herself through the choir, and encouragement to continue exploring the questions that had occupied her all her life.

She also became an outspoken advocate for clean energy and action on climate change, causes for which she would march shoulder to shoulder with her fellow parishioners. Her concern for the arts and her concern for the world were not separate impulses. Both grew from a conviction that critical engagement with the world around us matters, and that a person has an obligation to use whatever gifts she possesses in service of something greater than herself. Connie reflected on that duty in



her thesis, writing, “Because that is the trademark of the true artist; his perseverance; never backing down from what he considers right, even in the face of the strongest disapproval.”

At 72, writing for Bennington’s 50th reunion, Connie concluded that life was good; she was grateful to still be able to write about the people and things she admired, and she counted among her great joys her daughters, her grandchildren, her friends, her work, and living by the water. She remarked that every day she woke to the knowledge that she was “very lucky — to be happy, healthy, fulfilled, and comfortable.”

Connie is survived by her daughters, Jeanne and Anne; her brother, Mark; and sister, Phyllis; and her grandchildren, Alyssa, Emmanuelle, Louise, Harriet, Joseph, Katherine, James and William. She was predeceased by her husband, Herbert Gorfinkle; and her daughter, Elisabeth MacDonald.

As we process Connie’s passing, we may find solace in the remarkable wisdom she left behind in her Bennington senior thesis. Reflecting on the passage and succession of generations, she wrote,

“The world is his now, while only a short while ago it belonged to someone else. And for the time that his star shone in the sky, that other one tore the earth apart to find his way and filled a corner of it with light.”

Nearly seven decades later, it is difficult to imagine a better description of Connie’s own life. She, too, spent her years finding her way—and in doing so, filled a corner of the world with light.

Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to attend the Funeral Service, at 11 AM, on Friday, September 11, at the Old Ship Church, 90 Main Street, Hingham. Burial will be private. Please see www.Keohane.com for directions and online condolences.



BASU, John Arun



Of Brighton, passed away, on September 4, 2026, beloved husband of the late Marjorie Young Basu. Son of the late Major Nalinaksha Basu and Shinn Chowdhry Basu. Brother of Usharani Misra; brother-in-law, Major Balendu Prakash Misra. John did his initial schooling with his sister, June, in London, U.K. Thereafter, he studied in India at La Martiniere College, Lucknow, Sherwood College, Nainital, and St. Xavier’s College, Kolkata. A brilliant achiever, he completed his B.Tech and M.Tech degree in Electrical Engineering from Jadavpur University, Kolkata. He taught several years at Wynberg-Allen School, Mussoorie. He was on the managing committee of Children’s Academy College, Lucknow. He also taught at the University of New Hampshire, U.S. John and his beloved wife, Marjorie were married at the Brighton Allston Church, 40 years ago, and he has been an active and devoted member of the congregation since then. John was a State-level champion in Debating, Boxing, Tennis, Swimming and an outstanding orator. As a child, he acted in the movie Ceasar and Cleopatra, alongside his mother, Shirin and Hollywood stalwart Vivien Leigh. Visiting Hours in the Lehman Reen & McNamara Funeral Home, 63 Chestnut Hill Ave. (nr. Brighton Courthouse), BRIGHTON, on Monday, September 10, from 5:00-7:00pm. Funeral Service on Friday, September 11, at 10am. Interment to follow at Newton Cemetery, Newton, MA. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. For directions and guestbook, please visit www.lehmanreen.com All services will be livestreamed at the link, <https://www.harborview.live/>

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CLEARY, Anne Tredennick “Annie”



Age 79, of Osterville, Massachusetts, died peacefully, on September 6, 2026, at Massachusetts General Hospital in Boston, with her children by her side.

One of six children, Annie was born in Hartford, Connecticut, on March 23, 1947, and grew up in Meriden, in the beloved family home known to all as the Big House. She moved to Boston to attend the Katharine Gibbs School, and fell in love with life in the city, living there and working in the world of advertising at Hill Holliday. Her working years were brief but formative, it was in that chapter of her life that she met Robert B. Cleary. They were married at the Big House in 1976, and Annie turned to what she considered her true calling, raising her family. She and Bob shared thirty-nine years together until his death in 2015.

Weston was home for much of her life, complemented by treasured seasons in Osterville on Cape Cod and in Jupiter, Florida. In her later years, Osterville became her home. Oyster Harbors Club, Brae Burn Country Club, and The Loxahatchee Club were each a cherished part of her life.

Above all, Annie was devoted to her family and friends. Raising her children and delighting in her grandchildren was the joy of her life. She shared an especially close bond with her three sisters, and gave that same steadfast love to a circle of fiercely loyal friendships she kept for decades. That devotion took shape in what she made by hand: her needlepoint and decoupage were never merely pastimes but expressions of her love for others. Her decoupage pieces, each carrying her personal touch and a flourish of her signature pink, made their way to family and friends. Most treasured of all were the Christmas stockings she stitched by hand, keepsakes that hold a lasting place in the lives of many. Every Christmas she made English toffee and gave it out to all, a treat so beloved that everyone looked forward to it. She also loved building gingerbread houses with her grandchildren. Loving, caring, loyal, and honest to a fault, she was happiest in good company, on the tennis court, on the golf course with her women friends or beside her many Westies, long a family trademark. More recently, she had taken up mah-jongg with real devotion, treasuring the hours spent learning and playing the game alongside her friends.

She was predeceased by her husband, Bob; and three of her siblings, her brother, Mark Tredennick; and her sisters, Nicky Doyle and Mary Gould. She is survived by her children, Meghan and her husband, Peter and Andrew and his wife, Emily; her stepchildren, Robert, Christin and her husband, Rick, Brian; ten grandchildren, Henry, Gus, and Georgia; Drew, Claiborne, and Evelyn, Alexandra, Robert, and Christopher; and Chloe; two great-grandchildren, Emmett and Carter; and her siblings, Stephen Tredennick and Alexandra “Coe” Barakos.

Visiting Hours will be held at the George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 477 Washington St. (Rt.16), WELLESLEY, on Thursday, September 10, from 4:00 to 7:00 p.m. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated at St. Julia Parish, in Weston, on Friday, September 11, at 10:30 a.m., followed by Burial at Linwood Cemetery, in Weston. A reception will follow at Brae Burn Country Club, in Newton.

In lieu of flowers, gifts in her honor may be sent to the MGB Cancer Institute Development Office, 399 Revolution Drive, Somerville, MA 02145 or visit give.massgeneralbrigham.org or The Boys & Girls Clubs of Boston, 200 High Street, Suite 3B, Boston, MA 02110, Attn: Beckie Crawford.

Online guestbook, at gfdoherty.com

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Obituaries

Jon Small, 79, director and Billy Joel collaborator

By Sopan Deb
NEW YORK TIMES

Jon Small, a Grammy-nominated director of music videos and concert films, and an early bandmate and musical collaborator of Billy Joel, died Sept. 4 in West Palm Beach, Fla. He was 79.

Joel announced the death on Instagram on Monday. The cause was cancer, his son Sean Weber-Small said in an email.

Mr. Small and Joel had a tumultuous relationship, but their friendship would form the basis for launching one of the most successful and enduring careers in American pop music.

The two became close friends in the 1960s, when Mr. Small persuaded Joel to join his Long Island, N.Y., band, the Hassles, with the promise of being able to play a Hammond B-3 organ.

“I had super long hair,” Mr. Small told Newsday last year. When he went to Joel’s home for the first time, he recalled that Joel told his mother, Rosalind Joel, that he wanted to look like Mr. Small.

“And she looks at me and goes, ‘Oh, great,’” Mr. Small said.

The band released two albums. Though neither was particularly successful, the Hassles were inducted into the Long Island Music and Entertainment Hall of Fame last year.

Afterward, Mr. Small and Joel broke off to form a heavy metal duo called Atilla. Joel played the organ and Mr. Small was the drummer. They released one self-titled album in 1970. Joel did not consider the album, which was full of screaming and distortion, to be among his finer works.

“I never stop denigrating my work from that period,” Joel told The Toronto Star in 2005. “Total crap.”

Around this time, Mr. Small introduced Joel to his wife, Elizabeth Weber. The three were living together when Joel and Weber began an affair.

“It was a very devastating thing for me, because these were basically my two best friends,” Mr. Small said in “And So It Goes,” a two-part 2025 HBO documentary about Joel.

Joel said in the documentary that he felt “very guilty” about the affair, which ended his musical partnership with Mr. Small.

“They had a child. I felt like a homewrecker,” Joel said, adding: “I was just in love with a woman and I got punched in the nose, which I deserved. Jon was very upset. I was very upset.”

Distraught, Joel began drinking heavily and twice attempted suicide. Mr. Small took Joel to the hospital after one of the attempts.

“Even though our friendship had blown up, Jon saved my life,” Joel said in the documentary.

Joel and Weber married in 1973 and she became his manager as his career took off. It was after meeting Weber that Joel started writing the more personal songs that would make him a household name. (Weber and Joel divorced in 1982, the same year that Mr. Small married Jeanine Lust, to whom he remained married for the rest of his life.)

Jonathan Craig Small was born on Long Island on Jan. 3, 1947, to Hy Small, a musician, and Sydelle Small, the owner of a wallpaper store in Syosset, N.Y.

After the dissolution of his marriage with Weber and his partnership with Joel, Mr. Small built a successful career as a self-taught director of live events and music videos, working with Enrique Iglesias, Garth Brooks, Reba McEntire, Vince Gill, and many others. He directed the music video for “Highwayman,” a hit for the Highwaymen, a supergroup featuring Willie Nelson, Johnny Cash, Kris Kristofferson, and Waylon Jennings, as well as the video for Run DMC’s collaboration with Aerosmith on “Walk This Way.”

Mr. Small’s survivors include Sean Weber-Small, his son with Weber, and Allison Small, his daughter with Lust.

DUBREUIL, Francis William



Died peacefully, in Pasadena, California, on August 22, 2026, after a long illness. He was 77.

Frank was born and raised in Westport, Massachusetts, the fifth of seven children born to Lydia (Banville) Dubreuil and Leo R. Dubreuil. He was a student at Saint George School and at Bishop Stang High School, and he credited his teachers there with inspiring him to pursue his education. Frank distinguished himself early on as a bright and curious student who excelled and took pleasure in academics. After graduating magna cum laude from Boston College with a BS in Economics, he went on to receive a JD from Harvard Law School and an MS in Business from Stanford Graduate School of Business.

A long-time partner at Goodwin Procter & Hoar in Boston and at Wilson Sonsini in Palo Alto, Frank focused on family estate planning and tax law. He took great satisfaction in using his legal acumen to steer clients toward effective philanthropy. For four years, he was Senior Vice President and National Managing Director of Global Wealth Management at AllianceBernstein in San Francisco, and he retired in 2015 as a practicing shareholder at Hopkins Carley in Palo Alto. Frank loved and respected the law, and believed in the ethical responsibilities that accompanied his work.

An avid student of history, Frank enjoyed historical biographies and documentaries. He loved libraries, college campuses, the seashore and the halls of Congress as they were when he was young. A lifelong Democrat, Frank never stopped believing in democracy and good government.

Dearest to Frank’s heart were his children and grandchildren. He believed in and supported their dreams and helped them in every way he could. He was a devoted husband to Marcia; and a steadfast and beloved son-in-law to her parents, Charles and Jessie Beall. He was a loyal and generous son, brother, uncle, mentor and friend. Frank adored his dogs and found immense joy in his garden. It felt appropriate that he shared his name with ‘Francis Dubreuil,’ a prize-winning tea rose introduced in 1894. He was a dedicated, adopted Californian who always rooted for the Red Sox. Frank had a beautiful singing voice and a resonant laugh. He loved George and Ira Gershwin, Ella Fitzgerald, James Taylor, and Otis Redding. The shifting of the constellations fascinated and delighted him, and he never missed an opportunity to stand outside taking in the full moon with his family.

He is survived by his wife of 50 years, Marcia Beall Dubreuil; his three children, Jessie Dubreuil, her spouse, Aran Nichol; and their daughter, Helen Dubreuil Nichol; Owen Dubreuil, his former spouse, Rachel Hirshberg; and their children, Henry Dubreuil and Lola Dubreuil; Ellen Dubreuil and her spouse, Timothy Finn; his sister, Claudette Rowland; his brother-in-law, Charles R. Beall, Jr.; and many nieces and nephews. He was preceded in death by his parents, Leo and Lydia Dubreuil; and his siblings, Irene Wright, Leo Dubreuil, Lucille Dubreuil and Michael Dubreuil. His brother, James Dubreuil, died on August 25, 2026.

Frank’s family wishes to extend their utmost appreciation and love to his kind and thoughtful caregivers both in Palo Alto and in Pasadena.

A Service will be held at Alta Mesa Cemetery, in Palo Alto, on October 2, 2026, at 1:30pm. In lieu of flowers, donations may be made in his name to National Public Radio. <https://www.npr.org/donations/support?donate=npr>

GORFINKLE, Constance S.

See Enhanced Listing

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To access death notices and obituaries online, visit **boston.com/obituaries**.

The Boston Globe

JOHNSON, Dorothy (Serviss)

Of Dedham, MA, died peacefully, at home, on September 2, 2026.

Dorothy was born in Snohomish, Washington, on 28 September 1929, to Otto F. Serviss and Dollie Thomson Serviss. She was raised in Everett, Washington, and graduated from Everett Washington High School. She earned a Bachelor's degree from the former Northwest Christian College in Eugene, Oregon.

After college, Dorothy moved to Colorado to live with her brother, Victor. She met Leo F. Johnson at Denver University, and they married at the university chapel. The couple moved to Fargo, North Dakota, where their son, Timothy was born in 1956. They spent most of their lives in the Boston area and were longtime members of King’s Chapel in Boston.

Dorothy devoted many years to volunteer work as a tutor of English as a Second Language (ESL), most recently with the Literacy Volunteers of America at the Morrill Memorial Library in Norwood. She maintained a lifelong interest in genealogy, and researched and self-published the story of her family, “The Serviss and Thomson Families and Their Johnnycake Journey.”

She was preceded in death by Leo, in 2019; their son, Timothy in 2021; and her brothers, Beryl and Victor. Dorothy is survived by Timothy’s partner, Catherine Tocci of Brookline; her nieces, Suzanne Fryer (Al) of Colorado Springs, CO and Sharon Balch (Fred) of Park City, UT; and great-nephews, Michael of Bryce Canyon City, UT and Christopher (Melissa) of Salt Lake City; as well as the children of several cousins.

Family and friends anticipate holding a Memorial Gathering at Traditions of Dedham, where Dorothy and Leo made their home during the past decade. Interment will be alongside Leo and Timothy at the Goodland County Cemetery, Kansas, near Leo’s childhood home.

In lieu of flowers, please make a donation to the charity of your choice.

OBEY, Theresa R.

Age 96, of Weymouth, formerly of Randolph, entered into eternal life, on August 29, 2026. Mrs. Obey was a waitress at The Top of the Hub Restaurant in Boston for many years, until a work injury forced her retirement at age 75. She attended “Coffee Club,” where she had many friends. There was nothing she loved more than being together with her family. Devoted mother of Steven and his wife, Mary of Weymouth, Douglas and his wife, Maureen of Westwood, Thomas and his wife, Lai Ha of Stoughton and Ruth Mahoney of Hanover. Grandmother to 12 grandchildren and 16 great-grandchildren. Funeral services are private. Arrangements by the Clancy Lucid Funeral Home, WEYMOUTH. For messages and directions, see clancy lucid.com

PHILLIPS, Joann Hudson



Joann Hudson Phillips, age 86, passed away on September 4, 2026, peacefully at her home, in John’s Island, Indian River Shores, Florida.

Joann grew up in Rockland, Maine where she met and married her high school sweetheart, George Phillips. George and Joann settled in Lynnfield, Massachusetts, where they raised their four children, Jeffrey, Peter, Kathryn and Andrew. Joann loved the beach and owned a summer home on Wingaersheek Beach, Gloucester, Massachusetts, for 40 years, a site of special memories for her children and grandchildren. It was the light and beauty of the beach and ocean that led her to embark on a 30-year passion for painting. Over her painting career, she participated in exhibits at the North-shore Art Association in Gloucester, MA, at the St. Botolph’s Club in Boston as well as annual art shows at Wingaersheek Beach in Gloucester and at John’s Island Club Indian River Shores.

Joann devoted much of her time to helping others and until recently she oversaw and volunteered at the Tam-bourine Thrift Shop in Vero Beach.

She was preceded in death by her parents, Robert Hudson and Mary Bird; as well as her sister, Judy Brooks of Daly City, California in 2024; and one son, Peter Phillips in 2015. She is survived by her husband of 65 years George Phillips of Indian Shores; and sister, Sandy Strine of Wilmington, Delaware; her children and their spouses: Jeffrey Phillips and Martha Southgate, Kathryn and John Kearney and Andrew and Christine Phillips; and a daughter-in-law, Stacy Benedict; as well as her eight grandchildren: Nathaniel Phillips, Ruby Phillips, Evelyn Kearney, Aaron Kearney, William Phillips, Aidan Phillips, Caroline Phillips and Floyd Phillips. Joann and George celebrated their 65th wedding anniversary on August 19, 2026.

A Mass of Christian Burial will take place on Monday, September 14, 2026, at 10am, at Holy Cross Catholic Church in Vero Beach.

In lieu of flowers, please donate to the VNA Hospice Foundation in the name of Joann Phillips at 920 37th Place, Suite 101, Vero Beach, FL 32960 or <https://vnatc.org/waystogive/memorials-and-honorariums/>

A guestbook is available at www.strunkfuneralhome.com

PRUNIER, Theresa



Age 93, of Bridgewater, MA, passed away peacefully, on September 4, 2026. She was the loving wife of Joseph for 42 years, before his passing in 1999.

Born in Norwood and raised in Canton, Theresa was the daughter of Edward and Jeanette McManus. She attended St. John the Evangelist High School and graduated in 1950. After graduation, she worked as a book-keeper in Boston and continued in the accounting field, until her retirement in 1995.

Theresa raised her family in Holbrook, where she was active in town politics and was a member of the Holbrook Historical Society. She enjoyed vacations to Cape Cod and New Hampshire with her family. In her retirement years, she enjoyed traveling with her husband to California, Florida, and Canada. Theresa was an avid gardener and Bridge player. She enjoyed arts and crafts, antiques, and interior designing with her daughter, Barbara, as well as visiting with friends and family.

She is survived by her three sons, Richard (wife, Maryanne), Edward and David (wife, Ana); four granddaughters; two great-grandsons; her sister, Mary Camara of Raynham; and several nieces and nephews. She was preceded in death by her husband, Joseph; her daughter, Barbara; and her brother, John.

The family wishes to extend their gratitude to Life Care Center of Acton for the loving care they provided Theresa.

Family and friends are invited to honor and Celebrate Theresa’s Life at the Shepherd Funeral Home, 216 Main St., KINGSTON, MA, on Monday, September 14, from 8:30am to 9:30am.

A Funeral Mass will be said at St. Joseph’s Church, 272 Main St., Kingston, MA, at 10:00am. A graveside service will be held at National Cemetery in Bourne, MA, following the Funeral Mass.

RICCI, Steven Anthony “Steve”



Age 61, of Lexington and Somerville, passed away on August 31, 2026.

Born in Cambridge in 1965, to Anthony “Tony” Ricci and Susan Ricci, he grew up in Somerville and graduated from Lexington High School, class of 1983. In high school, he became involved in photography of many styles, something that became a lifelong hobby, with several family members enjoying framed landscape photos taken by him.

As a youth in Scouts and at the local recreation center, he developed an interest in target sport shooting, becoming a distinguished expert, and creating good sportsmanship, friendship, and a traditional quiet concentration in this endeavor.

History was also a passion, and growing up in the birthplace of America, he joined the historical recreated British 10th Regiment of Foot, with which he participated in reenactments, including the Battle of Fort Ticonderoga, and numerous times in the Battle of Lexington.

He also found interest in the early computer sciences, which later became his major field of profession, developing from his university business and accounting studies. Steven took pride in continued learning, achieving several degrees, including a Bachelor’s from Bentley College and a Master’s from Worcester Polytechnic Institute, among many other certifications and advanced programs.

He leaves his father, Anthony and Anthony’s, and partner, Linda; his mother, Susan; his younger brother, Peter and wife, Becky; niece, Jo; nephew, Quinn; and many local cousins, as well as extended family in Maine and around the country.

Family and friends are invited to Visiting Hours and a Service, at the Shawsheen Funeral Home, 281Great Rd., BEDFORD, MA, from 4 - 6 pm, on Monday, September 14, 2026; immediately following, there will be a repast at the American Legion Post 221, 357 The Great Road, Bedford, MA. A private burial will take place at a later date. For more details, please visit Shawsheenfuneralhome.com

Share a special memory

Add a cherished memory or condolence to the online guestbook at **boston.com/obituaries**.

ROGERS, Barbara Joan, rscj



A member of the Religious of the Sacred Heart of Jesus, died on September 7, 2026, in Barnstable, MA. Daughter of the late Charles F. and Barbara (Murphy) Rogers; she is survived by her brother, Charles F. Rogers, Jr. (Martha) of Providence, RI; her sisters, Sally J. Rogers of New York City and Nancy E. Rogers of Rumford RI; and her brothers, Paul V. Rogers (Barrett) of Bethesda, MD, Michael L. Rogers (Christine) and Patrick A. Rogers (Megan), both of Rumford, RI. She was the aunt of Charles (Sarah), Peter (Meaghan), Mary Adair (John), David (Marina), Christopher (Abigail), Emily, Colin, Michael (Megan), Matthew, Margaret, Katherine, Anne, Daniel, Timothy, Claire, Ellen, Brendan and Madeleine; as well as her grandnieces and grandnephews, Maeve, Charles, Henry, Knox, Chase, Bode, Bennett, Frances, Penny, Jack, and Michael. She is also survived by her dear friend and caregiver, Kathleen Scully Hodges; and Sarah McReil and Liam McReil. The Religious of the Sacred Heart mourn the loss of their sister. Barbara was deeply loved by her family, religious sisters, and many friends. She was widely respected for her wise leadership, kindness, and generosity.

A graduate of the Convent of the Sacred Heart Elmhurst, Manhattanville College, and Yale University School of Management, Sister Rogers entered the Society of the Sacred Heart in 1978, made her first vows in 1980 in the chapel at Newton Country Day School of the Sacred Heart, and made her final profession in 1985. Sister Rogers worked at the Sacred Heart schools in Princeton, NJ, Bethesda, MD, Chekalini, Kenya, Miami, FL and Newton, MA.

Barbara served as Headmistress of Newton Country Day School of the Sacred Heart for 34 years (1989-2023). She transformed the school, while maintaining its deep roots in the Sacred Heart mission. A visionary and determined leader, she was known for her courage, candor, and willingness to say what needed to be said. Above all, she was devoted to educating young women to lead with faith, intellect, integrity, courage, and confidence.

Barbara also served as President of the Association of Independent Schools in New England, and as a trustee of the College of the Holy Cross, Manhattanville College, Mother Caroline Academy, St. Sebastian’s School, St. John’s High School in Shrewsbury, and Catholic Memorial School. In recognition of her transformative leadership and lifelong commitment to Catholic education, the College of the Holy Cross awarded her an honorary Doctor of Humane Letters in 2025.

In lieu of flowers, donations in memory of Sister Barbara Rogers, rscj, may be made to the Sacred Heart Endowment at Newton Country Day School of the Sacred Heart. Established to honor Barbara’s legacy and leadership, the Endowment provides tuition assistance, carrying forward her commitment to ensuring that a Sacred Heart education is accessible to a diverse community of young women.

Gifts may be made through the Sacred Heart Endowment or mailed to: Newton Country Day Advancement Office, 785 Centre Street, Newton, MA 02458.

Please designate gifts: Sacred Heart Endowment in Memory of Sister Rogers.

Memorial gifts may also be made to the Society of the Sacred Heart, United States – Canada Province, in support of the life and mission to which Barbara devoted herself.

A Wake will be held on Friday, September 11, 2026, from 4 to 8pm, at Newton Country Day School of the Sacred Heart. The Funeral Mass will follow on Saturday, September 12, 2026, at 11:30am, at Campion Center, 319 Concord Road, Wfston, MA 02493. For online guestbook, gfdoherty.com

George F. Doherty & Sons
Wellesley 781 235 4100

Funeral Services

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www.stmichaelcemetery.com

SMITH, Dennis A.



Age 87, of Weymouth, died peacefully on Monday, September 7, 2026, at the South Shore Hospital in Weymouth.

Raised in Dorchester, son of the late Arthur and Beatrice (Walsh) Smith.

Beloved husband of Susan Oliverio of Weymouth. Devoted father of Marianne “Mam” Smith of New York, William “Billy” Smith and his wife, Kathryn of Rome, Tara Stark and her husband, John of Wisconsin, Molly Oliverio and her fiancé, Andrew Fleming, Evelyn “Evy” Oliverio, all of New York. Loving grandfather of Drew Freimanis and his fiancée, Kara Dubria of New York, Raina Keller of Texas, Mia Keller of Washington D.C., Layla Stark of Wisconsin, Lucia and Dennis Smith, both of Rome. Dear brother of the late Arthur Smith and the late Robert Smith.

Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to greet the family during the Visiting Hours on Sunday, September 13, 2026, from 2-5 PM, in the McDonald Keohane Funeral Home, NORTH WEYMOUTH, at 40 Sea Street (off Route 3A - Bicknell Square).

A Celebration of Life Service will be held in the funeral home, at 1 PM, on Monday, September 14, 2026, prior to the Funeral Mass in St. Jerome Church, Weymouth, at 2 PM.

Interment in Milton Cemetery is private. Late U.S. Marine.

In lieu of flowers, donations to Tunnel to Towers foundation: www.t2t.org

To read the complete obituary, please visit: www.Keohane.com



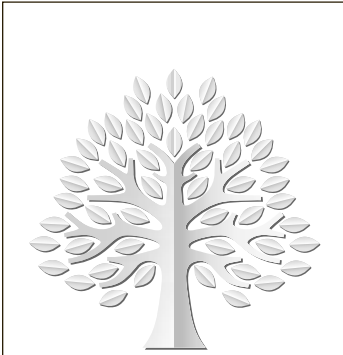
VACHON, AnnLee



A lifelong resident of Newton, AnnLee (Mitchell) Vachon passed away peacefully, on September 4, 2026.

Visitation and Services will take place at Newton Cemetery Chapel, on Saturday, October 3. Friends and family are invited to gather for Calling Hours from 1:00 to 2:30 p.m., with a Service to follow, at 2:30 p.m. For complete obituary, please visit BurkeFuneralHomes.com

Burke & Blackington
West Newton



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To access death notices and obituaries online, visit boston.com/obituaries.



SCOTT A GARFITT/INVISION/AP

Casey Affleck, pictured Tuesday at the photo call for the film “Company,” which he directed, at the 83rd Venice International Film Festival in Venice, Italy.

Casey Affleck reveals death of his and Ben’s father during Venice Film Festival press conference

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

Timothy Affleck, the father of actors Ben and Casey Affleck, has died, the younger Affleck brother revealed Tuesday during an appearance at the 83rd Venice International Film Festival.

While speaking at a press conference for his latest directorial effort, “Company,” Casey told reporters in attendance that his new film is dedicated to both of his late parents. Ben and Casey’s mother, Christopher Anne Affleck, died in June at the age of 83. According to the Hollywood Reporter, she had been diagnosed in December with pancreatic cancer.

“It’s dedicated to my parents because I lost both my mom and my dad this year,” Casey, 51, said during Tuesday’s press conference in Venice. “They’re very important to me, and I really wanted to show this movie to them, and I didn’t get to. I think they would’ve liked it.”

The date and cause of death for Timothy have not yet been revealed.

According to a 2000 New York Times interview with Ben, his father and mother divorced in the ’80s when he was 11. Timothy, who had playwright

aspirations and also worked as a janitor and a mechanic, struggled with alcoholism during his life. However, he stopped drinking in 1990, according to the Times piece. Ben, who has dealt with his own struggles with alcoholism, praised his father for maintaining his sobriety in a 2012 interview with Barbara Walters.

“My father was a — what did they call him — a real alcoholic. He, you know, drank all day, drank every day, and to his credit, he got sober ultimately,” Ben told Walters. “He’s been sober for several decades, which I think is pretty impressive.”

In a 2022 interview with the Globe, Ben reflected on spending time with his father during his youth in Cambridge.

“[G]rowing up in Central Square, my dad worked at a bar called the [Prospect] Buffet, where he was a bookie, and then at the Cantab Lounge,” Ben said. “My parents were divorced, and I’d go see my dad before and after work. My brother and I were there all the time.”

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

ASKING ERIC

Friends constantly cancel plans

Q. Over the years people have said things to me such as, “I can’t go to lunch with you today after all. I’m going to go to lunch with John instead.” Or at the last minute, “I can’t go to see the play with you this evening. My boyfriend says we’re going someplace else.”

Sometimes people fail altogether to show up for plans made in advance, without a word of apology or explanation ever. Upon next seeing them, they behave as though nothing had happened. If I gently inquire what had happened to our plans, they start in with the defensive, manipulative psychobabble, and gaslighting.

I have heard excuses made for people who can’t be counted on. I have been called petty and rigid. I have been told I take these things too personally.

After being treated shabbily at the hands of others, I say and do nothing further and remain civil and decent to them but from a low-contact distance, and I no longer reach out to them with friendly gestures until if and when they can prove that it is a genuine, mutual, responsible, and courteous friendship.

What are your thoughts on the matter? Do you have any suggestions concerning what I could or should be saying and doing, or not saying and not doing, concerning people who behave like this?

STOOD UP

A. If this is happening enough times to become a pattern in your life, you might look for ways of breaking or avoiding said pattern.

Though you can’t change the behavior of others, I wonder if there are commonalities in some of the people with whom you’ve had conflict about showing up in the past. Might you pour more of your energy into friendships with people who see you for who you are and can respect your desire to be more attentive to keeping plans?

It may also help, in the future, to tell prospective new friends that you sometimes have issues with people canceling at the last minute or for no reason and that it’s something about which you’re sensitive. This gives new friends helpful information that can guide their actions. Ideally, a new connection, knowing this, would choose to communicate with you differently should they need to reschedule.

Q. I am one of four adult siblings. “Kelly” is the only sibling who does not live locally. In April, another sibling, “Betty,” sent a text to the group saying that Kelly and her family would be coming for

a visit and that everyone was invited to Betty’s lake house.

I knew immediately that the proposed date would not work for my family because we already had prior commitments. However, since no one asked whether the date worked for my family — or for our fourth sibling — I didn’t say anything at the time.

As the date got closer, more specific plans were discussed on the group text. At that point, I let them know that the date didn’t work for my family, while also saying that we appreciated the invitation.

After the gathering at the lake house, I texted, “Hope you had a fun weekend. Sorry our schedules didn’t align and have a safe trip home.” Betty responded that because the plans had been made in April, there had been plenty of time for us to make it work.

I understand that they chose a date that worked for them, and I accept that my family was not able to attend. What frustrates me is the implication that we should have rearranged (un-changeable) plans that were already made months in advance of the announcement in April.

Am I being unreasonable in thinking that I should have a say in choosing a date when the intention is for all of us to get together? If I want to make plans with someone, I ask about their availability, and we find a date that works for everyone involved. I don’t choose a date unilaterally and then put the responsibility on the other person to rearrange their existing commitments.

DIDN’T GET A VOTE

A. You’re not wrong here. Group planning 101 involves at least attempting to achieve consensus around availability before setting plans in stone.

It makes sense that Betty would defer a bit to Kelly’s schedule, since she was traveling from out of town. But if the desire was to bring everyone together, it would have made sense to poll the group.

It’s interesting that this pushback is coming from Betty and not Kelly, since Kelly was the person who didn’t get to see everyone. Betty might have an opinion about what you should have done with your schedule, but you don’t need to give it any more time or attention. Your efforts might be better spent finding a time and place to connect with Kelly.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Thursday September 10, 2026

Thursday September 10, 2026								Movies		Sports		
		7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	This Old House	Old House	POV "The Ride Ahead"			Pony Boys	Amanpour and Company (N)		
4	WBZ CBS	Game Day	Jeopardy!	Big Brother (N)		Fall First Look (N)	Ghosts	Elsbeth "Glamazons"		News (N)	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	9-1-1 "Mother's Boy"		9-1-1: Nashville "Let It R.I.P."		9-1-1: Nashville "Don Begins"		NewsCenter 5	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live		Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)		7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Remembers (N)		9-1-1: Nashville		9-1-1: Nashville		News (N)	J.Kimmel	
10	NBC Boston	Boston News (N)	Hollywood (N)	Law & Order: SVU "Charisma"		Law & Order: SVU "911"		Law & Order: SVU "Undercover"		Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
10	WJAR NBC	News (N)	Extra (N)	Law & Order: SVU "Charisma"		Law & Order: SVU "911"		Law & Order: SVU "Undercover"		News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Life-Pangea	Windows	Granite State (N)	Man in Red Bandana ('17)		Leaning Out		Amanpour and Company (N)		
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Big Brother (N)		Fall First Look (N)	Ghosts	Elsbeth "Glamazons"		12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFX FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	1% Club "Second Chance Night"		Best Medicine "Norway No How"		Boston 25 News at 10PM (Live)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) News (N)	
27	WUNI	Rosa "Sin miedo" (N)		Tan cerca "Dudas y secretos" (N)		Tierra de amor y coraje (N)		Corazón de oro (N)		Noticiero N+	SaborDe/ (:35) Noti..	
36	WSBE PBS	Cook's Country	Story-Public Sq	Our Town RI "Tiverton"		Barbra Streisand: Timeless: Live in Concert				PBS News Hour		
38	WSBK	Big Bang		WBZ News 8p (N)		48 Hours "The Farris Wheel" (N)		Perfect	Perfect	Flip Side	Flip Side	
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Shakespeare		TURN: Washington "Houses Divided"		Promises/Rev.	Still Here: Native	PBS News Hour (N)		
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		Unusual Suspects		
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Trivial Pursuit "The Main Event"		9/11 Remembered: 25 Years Later (N)		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Modern Family	
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud	Family Feud	1% Club "Second Chance Night"		Best Medicine "Norway No How"		12 News	Nation (N) (Live)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	
68	WBXP ION	(:55) FBI "Closure"		FBI "Little Egypt"		FBI "The Lives of Others"		FBI "American Idol"		FBI "An Imperfect Science"		
PREMIUM CABLE												
Cinemax	(6:45) ★★ Bad Santa 2 ('16)			(:(20) ★★ Kingsman: The Golden Circle ('17) Julianne Moore, Taron Egerton, Colin Firth.					(:(40) ★★ Red Sparrow ('18) Jennifer Lawrence.			
Flix	(5:55) ★★ The Brothers Grimm			★★★ Best in Show Parker Posey, Michael Hitchcock.				★ My Boss's Daughter ('03) Tara Reid, Ashton Kutcher.		★★★ Don Jon ('13)		
HBO	(:(20) ★★ Stoker ('13) Matthew Goode, Nicole Kidman, Mia Wasikowska.			A K (N) (P)		(:(40) A K		(:(25) Lanterns "Episode 4"		(:(20) A K "Welcome to Topeka"		
HBO 2	(:(05) Knock Knock ('15) Ana de Armas, Keanu Reeves.			(:(45) Conan O'		(:(25) ★★ The Long Walk ('25) Mark Hamill, Judy Greer, Cooper Hoffman.				(:(10) ★★ Murder on the Orient Express		
Paramount-Sho	(6:00) ★★ Congo ('95) Dylan Walsh.			★★ Godzilla ('14) Ken Watanabe, Elizabeth Olsen, Aaron Taylor-Johnson.				(:(05) ★★ Blade Runner 2049 ('17) Harrison Ford, Ryan Gosling.				
Showtime 2	(6:00) ★★ Top Gun ('86)			★★★ Top Gun: Maverick ('22) Miles Teller, Jennifer Connelly, Tom Cruise.				(:(15) ★★ Edge of Tomorrow ('14) Emily Blunt, Brendan Gleeson, Tom Cruise.				
Starz!	(6:10) The Take			(:(45) ★★ The Bourne Legacy ('12) Rachel Weisz, Ed Norton, Jeremy Renner.				(:(05) Fightland		Blood and Bone ('09)		
TMC	(6:05) ★★ Total Recall ('90)			★★ The Hunted ('03) Benicio del Toro, Tommy Lee Jones.			(:(35) Not Without Hope ('25) Josh Duhamel, Quentin Plair, Zachary Levi.				(:(40) Basic Ins...	
SPORTS												
CBSSN	World Poker Tour			World Poker Tour		World Poker Tour		World Poker Tour		World Poker Tour		
ESPN	2026 US Open Tennis Women's Semifinals From the USTA Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in Flushing, N.Y. (N) (Live)										SportCtr (N) (Live)	SportsC. (N) (Live)
ESPN2	Football (N)	SEC Storied Wishbone			30 for 30 Catholics vs. Convicts				30 for 30 Pony Excess			
Fox Sports 1	NFL Films Presents	Travis	Kevin H Hour (N)	SPEED With (N)	IndyCar Racing Freedom 250 Grand Prix of Washington, D.C.				IndyCar Racing			
Golf	Thank You	DP World Tour Golf Amgen Irish Open, First Round										
NBA	(6:30) Ba..	A Rose	NBA Playback 2025: Denver vs. Houston				The Association History in the Making					
NBC Sports	(6:30) Early (N)	Early Edition	Best of Zolak and Bertrand			Quick Slants		Boston Sports (N) (Live)		Boston Sports		
NESN	Wm. Soccer Northeastern at Harvard (N)					Chat (N)	Liverpool Football Liverpool at Ipswich					
FAMILY												
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty		
Disney	ZOMB-IES: Re-	Series Shorts	Kiff	Kiff	Kiff	Kiff	Vampi-rina	Place	Ladybug	Ladybug		
Encore Family	(6:30) Paul Blart: M...			★ Paul Blart: Mall Cop 2 ('15)			(:(35) A Dog and Pony Show			What's Cooking?		
Nickelodeon	★★ The Boss Baby 2: Family Business			Friends		Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..		

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	News	Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	First 48 "Jacked; Fallen Idol"		The First 48 "Underworld" (N)		Ted Bundy: the "Dark Secrets" (N)		Ted Bundy: the (N)		(:(05) The First 48	
AMC	(6:00) ★★ Lethal Weapon 4 ('98)				TNA IMPACT! (N) (Live)				★★★ Men in Black	
Animal Planet	Pit Bulls-Parole "Behind Bars"		Pit Bulls-Parole "A Long Time Coming"		Pit Bulls and Parolees "The One"		Pit Bulls-Parole "Eye of the Storm"		Pit Bulls "A Street Dog Named Desire"	
BBC America	(5:30) Demolition M...		★★★ The Fifth Element ('97) Gary Oldman, Bruce Willis.						★★ Constantine	
BET	(6:30) ★ The Intruder ('19) Meagan Good, Joseph Sikora, Michael Ealy.				★★ Lakeview Terrace ('08) Patrick Wilson, Kerry Washington, Samuel L. Jackson.				Martin	
Bravo	Housewives/OC "Ring of Truth"		Housewives/OC "Forbidden Fruit" (N)		Housewives "The Price of Perfection"		Housewives/OC "Forbidden Fruit"		Next Gen NYC	
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
CNN	OutFront	(Live)	Cooper 360		The Source With		CNN NewsNight (N)		Laura	(Live)
Comedy Central	The Office	(:35) The Office	(:10) The Office	(:45) The Office	(:20) The Office "The Seminar"		(:55) The Office	The Office	The Daily Show (N)	(:35) Family G..
CSPAN	(3:00) Campaign 2026 "Republican Midterm Convention, Day 2" (N) (Live)						Campaign 2026			
CSPAN2	(3:00) Campaign 2026 "Road to the Capitol - Democrats on the Trail"						Campaign 2026			
Dest. America	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea
Discovery	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..	How/Ma..
Discovery Life	Trauma: Life in ER		Trauma: Life in ER		Trauma: Life in ER		Trauma: Life in ER		Trauma: Life in ER	
E!	(4:00) Titanic		★★★★ Titanic ('97) Kate Winslet, Billy Zane, Leonardo DiCaprio.							
Encore	Movie	★★ Scary Movie 3 ('03)			★★ Non-Stop ('14)			(:(50) ★★ The Housemaid ('25)		
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Bobby Flay "Fabio Viviani: Giostra"		Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby
Fox News	Ingraham	(Live)	Jesse (N) (Live)	Hannity (N) (Live)					Fox News (N) (Live)	
Freeform	(5:30) Finding Nemo		(:(55) ★★ Finding Dory ('16)		Runway (N) (SF)			The 700 Club		
FUSE	Cher: Life in the Spotlight			Dolly Parton: Queen			Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters
FX	(5:30) Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 3			Adults	Adults	(:(05) There's Something About Mary				
FXM	(:(15) ★★ In Time ('11) Justin Timberlake.			★★ Alita: Battle Angel ('19) Rosa Salazar.			Movie			
Hallmark	(6:00) Falling Togeth...		Garage Sale "Murder in D Minor"				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Mystery 101		Mystery 101: Playing Dead ('19)				Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote	Murder, She Wrote
HGTV	Totally '90s House		Totally '90s House		House Hunters	House Hunters	House (N)	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters
History	History's Greatest Mysteries		Navy SEALs: America's Secret Warriors "Part 1"				(:(05) Navy SEALs: America's Secret Warriors "Part 2"			
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	C. Wonder (N)	Gotta See (N) (Live)			The List (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		Patricia (N) (Live)	
ID	Murder "Dorothy Did Right"		Murder "Murder on the Mountain"		The Murder Tapes "The Drop Off"		Homicide Hunt "Fractured Glass"		Homicide "Hold the Line"	
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men
Lifetime	NCIS "Heartland"		NCIS "Nine Lives"		NCIS "Murder 2.0"		(:(05) NCIS		(:(05) NCIS "Cloak"	
LMN	(6:00) A Stranger's ...		Kidnapping My Own Daughter ('26)				The Hand That Robs the Cradle ('23)			
MAGN	Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid	
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)	
MTV	★★★ 21 Jump Street ('12) Jonah Hill.						★★★ 22 Jump Street ('14) Jonah Hill.			
National Geographic	Lost "Secrets of the Nubian Pharaohs"		Lost "Secrets of the Tomb Raiders"		Lost "Cleopatra's Perfume"		Lost "Ramses' Lost Temple"		Lost "The Curse of Tutankhamun"	
NatGeoWild	Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection	
NECN	News	NBCYOU	Dateline		Dateline		Rescue		OpenHou..	1st Look
NewsNation	Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo		On Balance		On Balance		Katie (Live)	
Ovation	Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin	
OWN	Videos		Videos		OWN "OWN Spotlight: Luther Never Too Much"		First-Time			
Oxygen	(6:00) Unforgettable		Dateline: Unforgettable "Detective Story"				The Hooters Murders: Deadly Shift			
Paramount	(6:00) Dodgeball: A ...		(:(05) ★★ ★★ Role Models ('08)				(:(20) Dodgeball: A True Underdog Story			
QVC	La-Z-Boy (N) (Live)		Fall Home (N) (Live)		Inside Q (N) (Live)		Susan Graver Style (N) (Live)			
Science	Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of		Mysteries of	
Sundance	Law & Order "Virus"		Law & Order "Securitate"		Law & Order "Manhood"		Law & Order "Benevolence"		Law & Order "Sweeps"	
SyFy	(6:30) ★★ ★★ Star Trek Into Darkness ('13) (P)					★★★ Star Trek Beyond ('16) Chris Pine.				
TBS	Big Bang		Big Bang		Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Jokes (N)	Foul Play
TCLM	(6:00) The Haunting		★★★★ Spartacus ('60) Laurence Olivier, Jean Simmons, Kirk Douglas.							
TLC	Last Resort		90 Day: The Last Resort (N)				1000-lb Roomies (N)		ER: Ca.	
TNT	(5:30) Road House		★★★★ The Dark Knight Rises ('12) Anne Hathaway, Christian Bale.							
Travel	Doomsday- Ca.		Doomsday- Ca.		Doomsday- Ca.		Doomsday- Ca.		Doomsday- Ca.	
TruTV	(6:30) FIBA W. World		Cup TBA vs. France		Dunkman		★★★ Jerry Maguire ('96) Tom Cruise.			
TV Land	Raymond		Raymond		Raymond		Raymond		King	King
TV One	CosbySh..		CosbySh..		Uncensored		Different	Different	Different	Different
USA	Law & Order: SVU "Gray"		★★ Any Given Sunday ('99) Cameron Diaz, Dennis Quaid, Al Pacino.							
			Any Given Sunday							
VH-1	Chris (N) Chris (N)		★★ She's the Man ('06) James Kirk, Amanda Bynes.							
WE	NCIS "Baltimore"		NCIS "Swan Song"		NCIS "Pyramid"		NCIS		NCIS "Restless"	

WBUR announces its largest fund-raising endeavor ever

\$125m campaign follows federal defunding of public media

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

WBUR is seeking to raise \$125 million in a major fund-raising campaign, the largest such effort in its history.

The Boston public radio giant embarks on the campaign more than a year after President Trump signed a law rescinding federal funds for public media.

The station began the campaign prior to the rescission in 2023, but the loss of funding “added to the sense of urgency and to the gap that we needed to fill,” WBUR chief executive Margaret Low said in an interview with the Globe. She said that the organization

is “bullish” on meeting its goal, which she added would help to offset the loss of federal funding.

Donors have already committed \$100 million as part of the effort, Low said, which is titled “The Campaign for WBUR: 90.9 Reasons to Believe” in a nod to the station’s FM radio frequency. The campaign — which Low made public during an appearance on the station’s “Morning Edition” program — is focused on raising money for the station’s annual fund, local journalism, and innovation. WBUR also hopes to strengthen its endowment to help sustain the NPR station for years to come.

“This is not just crisis funding. This is for the long-term well-being and health of the organization,” Low said in the interview. “The response from the community has been so powerful that we believe we can close out what was to be a five-year campaign one year early in June of 2027.”

WBUR isn’t alone in pursuing a major fund-raising campaign. Just under a year ago, on the day that federal funding for public media expired, Boston public media giant GBH said it would seek to raise \$225 million to help fund its journalism, children’s and educational programming, and

WBUR, Page D2



NICK GRACE/BOLT CREATIVE GROUP FOR WBUR

WBUR is “bullish” on meeting its \$125 million goal and hopes to strengthen its endowment to help sustain the station for years to come.

Restive stop

Inside N.H.’s troubled I-95 service plaza project



NEW HAMPSHIRE LIQUOR COMMISSION

An aerial view of the two New Hampshire service plazas along I-95. The envisioned construction project involves two state-owned properties on I-95 in Hampton, one northbound and one southbound, where the existing New Hampshire Liquor & Wine Outlets operate.

By Beth Treffeisen
BOSTON.COM

On either side of Interstate 95 in Hampton, N.H., two weathered red barns greet thousands of motorists each day.

The paint is sun-bleached, the parking lots are stained with oil, and the restrooms are showing their age. For many travelers, the main attraction is the tax-free alcohol from the state liquor outlets situated on the sites.

New Hampshire officials have envisioned something more: modern service plazas with restaurants,

fuel, EV charging, visitor information, and other amenities that could serve as a gateway to the Seacoast.

But the state’s effort to find a private developer to rebuild them has become increasingly complicated.

New Hampshire has gone through two procurement processes for the project. The first was canceled after the state Department of Justice identified a procedural problem affecting the bid review. The latest process is being challenged in court by one of the companies that submitted a proposal, while the state has declined to identify the developer it has shortlisted.

The project would transform two heavily traveled commercial properties in the state. I-95 carries an av-

erage of 86,000 vehicles a day through Hampton, with summer traffic topping 125,000, the state said.

For local business leaders, the plazas could also be an opportunity to introduce travelers to the Seacoast rather than simply giving them a place to stop for a bottle of liquor.

“We want it to showcase the region and make it feel like it is part of the region and reflect our region, versus just another rest stop like on the Mass. Pike, which are very generic and sterile,” said Ben VanCamp, chief collaborator and president of the Chamber Collaborative of Greater Portsmouth.

NEW HAMPSHIRE, Page D3

Anthropic signs up for Kendall Square space

AI firm known for its Claude chatbot could double team here

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

As Anthropic ramps up its political presence on Beacon Hill, it’s also expanding its office footprint in Cambridge.

The San Francisco-based AI company best known for its Claude chatbot said it has signed a long-term lease for 24,000 square feet over two floors at the One Kendall Square office and lab complex owned by Alexandria Real Estate Equities. Anthropic currently employs more than 50 people at a WeWork co-working space in Cambridge, but will have room to more than double the size of its local team, with 120 workstations at One Kendall.

In a prepared statement, Governor Maura Healey hailed the news, saying Anthropic’s growing presence is adding to the local innovation economy’s momentum. (Anthropic says it is not looking for any state or local tax breaks for the expansion.)

“Cambridge is a natural place for Anthropic to put down roots,” the company’s cofounder and president, Daniela Amodei, said in a statement. “It’s where some of the world’s leading life science researchers are using Claude to acceler-

ANTHROPIC, Page D2



NOAH BERGER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Company cofounder and president Daniela Amodei called Cambridge “a natural place for Anthropic to put down roots.”

Tesla to let other EVs use its chargers on Mass. Turnpike, I-95

Doubles total ports open to all electric drivers at state’s rest stops

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

Tesla has opened its fast charging stations at state-owned rest stops on the Mass. Turnpike and I-95 to other brands of electric vehicles, giving drivers four more places to quickly recharge, the Massachusetts Department of Transportation announced on Wednesday.

Tesla, which operates about one-third of all fast chargers in the state, had previously kept the coveted rest stop charging locations exclusive to Tesla drivers. Now, under an amended agreement with MassDOT, drivers of non-Tesla EVs can charge at the stations in Lexington and Newton on I-95 and both rest stops in Charlton on the Mass. Turnpike.

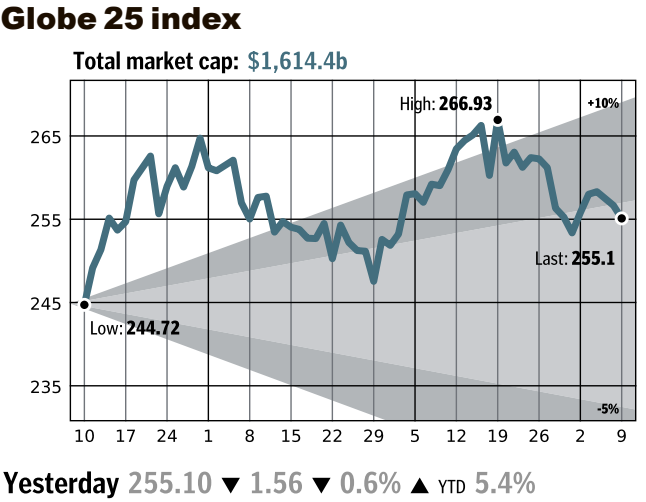
The deal comes as MassDOT has struggled to improve charging options on the Turnpike after a plan collapsed last year to have convenience store operator Applegreen over-

EV CHARGERS, Page D2

THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts



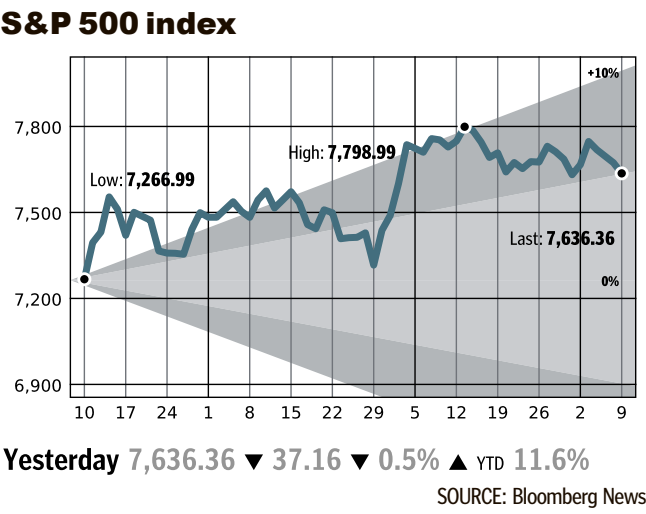
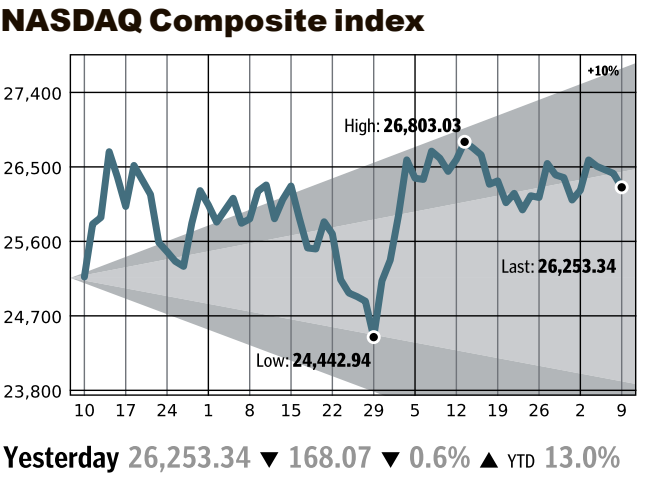
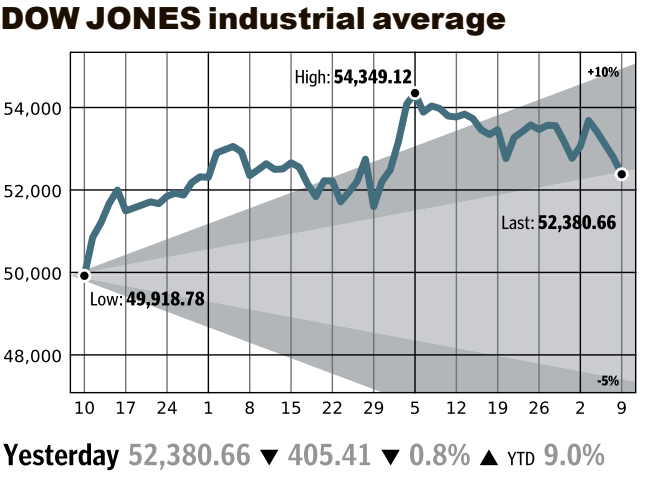
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	951.04	-20.27	-2.1	253.3
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	605.69	+2.67	+0.4	224.0
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	365.07	+1.87	+0.5	176.9
TJX COS INC (TJX)	126.12	-2.80	-2.2	138.7
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	521.12	-7.78	-1.5	132.1
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	175.43	-0.30	-0.2	81.7
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	44.96	-0.02	-0.0	65.2
TERADYNE INC (TER)	383.69	+11.63	+3.1	60.0
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	135.61	-4.72	-3.4	54.1
STATE ST CORP (STT)	191.89	+0.01	+0.0	52.7
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	32.08	-0.47	-1.4	43.7
WATERS CORP (WAT)	404.81	+1.90	+0.5	39.8
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	258.00	-2.10	-0.8	34.5
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	115.22	-0.86	-0.7	34.3
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	210.73	-1.77	-0.8	31.1
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	70.44	-1.05	-1.5	26.5
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	42.62	-0.68	-1.6	25.8
VERALTO CORP (VLT)	94.72	-0.81	-0.8	23.1
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	143.03	+1.94	+1.4	21.9
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	286.12	+11.32	+4.1	21.9
MKS INC (MKSI)	268.05	+2.55	+1.0	18.1
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	315.70	-1.43	-0.5	16.7
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	110.75	+5.14	+4.9	15.9
PTC INC (PTC)	128.89	-4.37	-3.3	14.0
VICOR CORP (VICR)	183.87	-9.45	-4.9	8.5

Markets

Gas companies rise amid oil spike

Stocks on Wall Street lost ground again Wednesday as the price of crude oil climbed back above \$100 a barrel amid further escalation in the US war with Iran. The losses were broad, with retailers among the companies that pulled the market lower. Amazon fell 1.8 percent, Starbucks lost 1.9 percent, and Home Depot dropped 1 percent. Every sector within the benchmark S&P 500 declined except for energy, which rose as oil companies notched gains. Exxon Mobil rose 2.2 percent and Chevron added 1.9 percent. Oil prices drove much of the action on Wall Street. The US destroyed five Iranian tankers on Tuesday in a series of attacks between the two nations. The conflict that began in February has essentially shut down traffic in the Strait of Hormuz, where a fifth of the world’s oil supply passed before the war began. The price of Brent crude, the international standard, rose 3.4 percent to settle at \$101.21 a barrel. It marks the first time the price surpassed \$100 a barrel since July. The Iran war is likely going to keep oil prices elevated at least through the US midterm elections in November, President Trump said Wednesday.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS



Apple unveils first foldable iPhone

But big \$1,999 price tag could be a tough sell

By Kalley Huang
NEW YORK TIMES

CUPERTINO, Calif. — Apple introduced a foldable iPhone on Wednesday, making the most significant change in 19 years to the company’s most important product.

During a 75-minute recorded presentation at its headquarters in Cupertino, Apple unveiled the iPhone Duo, a foldable smartphone with a bendable display that opens and closes like a book. When folded, it will be similar in size to a passport. When it’s open, consumers will be able to use two apps at the same time across a larger display. The phone will start at \$1,999 and will be available Oct. 23.

“Others have created foldables that just feel like two phones awkwardly stuck together,” said John Ternus, Apple’s new CEO. The new Apple phone, he added, “will redesign the experience of using a foldable phone.”

Foldable smartphones have been commercially available since 2018, but the category has not yet made inroads with consumers. Last year, consumer



JEFF CHIU/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The iPhone Duo will be available starting Oct. 23.

electronics companies shipped nearly 20 million foldable phones — or less than 2 percent of all smartphone shipments — according to Counterpoint Research, which tracks smartphone markets.

Apple’s product event on Wednesday was Ternus’s first since taking over leadership of the company. He was the company’s head of hardware engineering before succeeding Tim Cook as chief executive last week. In the recorded presentation, Ternus emphasized Apple’s work on artificial intelligence and described iPhones as the ideal device to be a “personal intelligent hub.”

Over the nearly two decades since it debuted in 2007, the iPhone has become Apple’s biggest business, now accounting

for half — or more than \$200 billion — of its annual revenue. The business has continued to grow, even as the iPhone has faced criticism for improving only incrementally.

With the iPhone Duo, Apple is establishing a new high-end option for its lineup of phones and trying to prove that it can still create innovative products.

The iPhone Duo is hitting the market in a difficult environment for consumer electronics. The artificial intelligence boom has created a global shortage in memory chips, making the component more expensive for devices such as phones, computers, and video game consoles.

In June, Apple increased the prices of Macs and iPads. In July, said it expected to pay even more for memory in the current



MARIO TAMA/GETTY IMAGES/FILE

Drivers of EVs that don’t have Tesla’s North American Charging System port will need a special adapter to connect to the four newly opened stations on the Mass. Pike and I-95.

Tesla agrees to let other EVs use its chargers on Mass. Turnpike, I-95

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haul 17 state rest stops and add dozens of new fast chargers. That’s left non-Tesla EV drivers with just a half-dozen relatively slow charging spots at Pike rest areas.

Adding more charging options should help alleviate one of the main concerns deterring drivers from going electric: fear of running out of juice. Adding 32 fast charging ports doubles the number of ports open to all EV drivers at state-owned rest stops. Before the new Tesla deal, EV drivers had access to 18 high-speed ports at six rest areas scattered across I-95 and Routes 3, 6, and 24, plus 12 relatively slower fast chargers along the Pike.

Still, challenges remain from the end of federal subsidies and a lack of lower-cost EVs on the market.

The state is counting on convincing almost 1 million drivers — about one out of five — to switch to electric by 2030 in order to meet its climate goal of reducing emissions to half of

The deal comes as MassDOT has struggled to improve charging options on the Turnpike.

1990 levels. EV sales slowed last year after the Trump administration eliminated subsidies and other rules that encouraged purchasing electric vehicles. The number of EVs and plug-in hybrids on the road in Massachusetts continues to increase slowly, exceeding 170,000 as of July 1, up 12 percent over the past year, according to the Registry of Motor Vehicles.

To use the four newly opened stations on the Mass. Pike and I-95, drivers of EVs that don’t have Tesla’s North American Charging System (or NACS) charging port will need a special adapter. Rates at Tesla’s

Supercharger stations vary during the day. At the Newton station, for example, non-Tesla drivers typically will pay 46 cents per kWh at night and up to 70 cents during peak daytime hours.

Tesla built one of the first national charging networks to encourage drivers to purchase the company’s EVs. The company started opening parts of its Supercharger network to other brands in 2023 and has built some stations, including in Lynnfield and Foxborough, with cables and built-in adapters to connect easily to non-Tesla vehicles not equipped with an NACS charging port.

Massachusetts still has yet to open a charging station funded by the 2021 National EV Infrastructure program. MassDOT last year approved sites along I-495 in Wrentham and Littleton, along I-195 in Wareham, and along Route 2 in North Adams and Lancaster.

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quarter.

The foldable iPhone is “part of experimentation around how to continue to grow iPhone” as a business, said Gene Munster, a managing partner at Deepwater Asset Management, an investment firm. “They think about this holistically and how they can continue to turn the screws to get you to move higher” in the product lineup, he added.

The iPhone Duo could add significantly to the market for foldable smartphones, but it would remain a slice of the overall market for phones. Next year, Apple is expected to ship more than 12 million foldables — 5 percent of all iPhone shipments — according to Counterpoint.

On Wednesday, Apple also updated traditional models of the iPhone. The iPhone 18 Pro will have a new chip, the A20 Pro, that allows it to run Apple’s most advanced AI models. Apple extended the phone’s battery life, so it can play videos for 36 hours on the iPhone 18 Pro and for 48 hours on the iPhone 18 Pro Max. The phone also has a new system of cameras, including one that can change how much light it lets in.

Both models will be \$100 more expensive than their predecessors. The iPhone 18 Pro will start at \$1,199 and the iPhone 18 Pro Max will start at \$1,299.

WBUR launches fund-raiser

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future operations. A GBH spokesperson said the station has raised \$86 million since launching the campaign.

“Congress told us to ‘go fund ourselves,’ and that’s exactly what we are going to do,” GBH chief executive Susan Goldberg said at the time.

While both organizations are home to local NPR stations, GBH is a much larger operation overall as one of the largest producers of programming for PBS and PBS Kids.

Leaders across the industry warned that many smaller stations, particularly those in more rural areas that relied on public funds

‘Congress told us to ‘go fund ourselves’

SUSAN GOLDBERG, GBH

as a significant percentage of their operations, would be at risk of folding.

Neither WBUR or GBH were among the local organizations that relied heavily on direct federal funding, but the interconnectedness of the public media system means that the loss of federal funding still posed a substantial risk to their businesses.

So far, however, public media has been able to stave off a wipeout of its most vulnerable stations thanks to a surge in short-term funding.

Aidan Ryan can be reached at aidan.ryan@globe.com. Follow him @aidanfitzryan.

Anthropic signs lease for Kendall Square office space

►ANTHROPIC
Continued from Page D1

earlier this year to lobby Beacon Hill on its behalf, and more recently made tens of thousands of dollars in political contributions in the state. Anthropic backs AI transparency rules and safeguards that the state Senate included in its version of an economic development bill this summer; the fate of those AI limits remains subject to conference committee negotiations over the broader bill between House and Senate leaders.

Anthropic is planning to move into One Kendall early next year. The expansion comes as Anthropic tries to get a suite of guardrails for the largest AI companies over the finish line at the Massachusetts Legislature, in what it says would be the strictest industry rules implemented in any state so far.

Toward that end, Anthropic hired Tremont Strategies Group

such as California and New York. The tech giants would need to identify AI capabilities that could pose catastrophic risks, and put systems in place to mitigate those risks, including whistleblower protections.

The Senate bill, though, goes further by also requiring third-party reviews every four months of big “frontier” AI models, like those from Anthropic and OpenAI, to identify potential risks. Anthropic backs this measure, putting the company at odds with rivals OpenAI and Google over how strictly AI should be regulated.

Amodei’s statement, though, doesn’t mention the political fight underway in Massachusetts and instead emphasizes how around one million people here use its products in some form, including Claude Science, a recently launched AI “workbench” for biopharma researchers. Amodei added: “We’re excited to grow our team alongside the scientists, universities, and institutions tackling some of the world’s most important problems.”

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TALKING POINTS

LABOR

LAWSUIT: AMAZON DID NOT PROVIDE WORKERS THAT WERE PREGNANT BASIC RIGHTS



A group of former Amazon warehouse employees is suing the company for systemically discriminating against pregnant workers, accusing the company of denying them basic accommodations and penalizing some who took breaks to pump milk or time off for hospital visits. The four plaintiffs filed a proposed nationwide class action in a Brooklyn, New York, federal court Tuesday, accusing Amazon of violating the 2022 Pregnant Workers Fairness Act, which requires employers with 15 or more workers to provide a “reasonable accommodation” for pregnancy and childbirth related medical conditions. To refuse an accommodation, companies must show it would create “undue hardship” for the business. “Denying a pregnant worker a stool, a lighter workload, or a bathroom break is a violation of federal law — it’s that simple,” said Inimai Chettiar, president of A Better Balance, a nonprofit organization that is representing the plaintiffs along with the law firm Emery Celli Brinckerhoff Abady Ward & Maazel. Amazon denied the accusations, saying the lawsuit’s description of events is inaccurate. “Ensuring the health and well-being of our employees is one of our greatest responsibilities, and we strive to provide a safe and supportive environment for everyone, which includes supporting tens of thousands of employees with pregnancy accommodations each year,” said Kelly Nantel, an Amazon spokesperson. Nantel said Amazon has approved “more than 99.9 percent of pregnancy related accommodations” over the past year and that “the accounts shared by A Better Balance contain inaccuracies and omit important details.” — ASSOCIATED PRESS

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

ANTHROPIC RESEARCHERS RAISE ALARM OVER AI ACCELERATION



For years, the artificial intelligence industry raced to improve its technology as quickly as possible. Now some researchers are increasingly sounding the alarm about the need to slow down. Jacob Coxon, an Anthropic researcher who previously worked at OpenAI, said Tuesday that he had resigned from Anthropic because “neither company is acting responsibly.” The two leading AI labs are sprinting to build “superhuman systems that can hack anything, revolutionize any field overnight, and acquire real power and resources” without building in appropriate safeguards, he said in a social media post. Coxon’s warning echoed concerns that other AI experts have voiced in recent months. Some AI leaders have long believed that the technology could create doomsday scenarios if left unchecked, and their concerns heightened after OpenAI’s models broke out of its systems in July and hacked Hugging Face, an AI model library. That same month, more than 1,300 employees at top AI companies, including Anthropic, OpenAI, Meta, and Google’s DeepMind, signed an open letter calling on the US government to create rules to slow AI development. In August, more than 100 major tech companies committed to providing their best AI models to organizations like hospitals and infrastructure providers so they could prepare for AI-powered cyberattacks. OpenAI also said last month that it would expand safety testing and slow the release of a new model, Astra, which has powerful cybersecurity abilities. Some critics have argued that AI companies are overhyping the technology to make their products appear more valuable. Several lawmakers said Wednesday, however, that they were taking Coxon’s warning seriously. “Safety researchers are resigning, powerful AI models are breaking out of their labs, and companies are racing ahead anyway,” US Representative Lori Trahan, D-Mass., wrote in a social media post. “It’s past time for Congress to get off the sidelines and do its job.” While leading AI labs have agreed that the government should place restrictions on the pace at which the technology is developed and released to the public, many companies are fiercely competing with one another and fear falling behind their rivals if they pause. “They are locked in a race to get there first — they believe no one else will act responsibly, so they must do it themselves, despite the risk,” Coxon said in his social media post. At least one Anthropic employee agreed with Coxon’s assessment. “We really do earnestly believe AI could kill all humans!” Evan Hubinger, who works at Anthropic on creating AI that aligns with human ethics and values, wrote on social media. Hubinger said he believed the risk of AI eliminating humanity was greater than 10 percent within the next decade. “I believe Anthropic is trying its best, but we do not yet have a plan to solve alignment for superintelligence and are not clearly on track to,” he added. Anthropic and OpenAI did not respond to requests for comment about Coxon’s comments. Coxon and Hubinger also did not respond to requests for comment. — NEW YORK TIMES

SOCIAL MEDIA

NEW MEXICO ALONE IN LAWSUIT AGAINST META OVER FACEBOOK’S CAMBRIDGE ANALYTICA SCANDAL



Attorneys representing the state of New Mexico told jurors that targeted political ads, attempting to lower Democratic turnout during the 2016 election, used Facebook data sold to a political consulting firm during opening statements in a trial over the platform’s data protections. Facebook’s attorney said the social media company investigated suspicious third-party apps following the breach and told jurors the state’s evidence is outdated because safeguards have improved. Opening statements began in Santa Fe on Wednesday morning, just weeks after 48 US states reached a landmark settlement with Meta, which addressed child safety concerns and privacy issues surrounding the same data breach. So far, New Mexico is the only state that has pushed the case toward trial, as part of its go-it-alone approach to prosecuting Meta, which owns Facebook and Instagram. In court documents, the state argues Facebook failed to alert or protect users from a personality quiz on the social platform that harvested data from roughly 87 million Facebook profiles and sold it to a political consulting firm, Cambridge Analytica. The data was used to generate targeted ads during the 2016 presidential election. Randi McGinn, the attorney representing New Mexico, said Cambridge Analytica used Facebook profile data to geographically target Democratic voters with messaging such as “Hillary’s got it, you don’t need to vote,” in an alleged attempt to reduce voter turnout. The now-defunct firm’s clients included the 2016 campaign for Donald Trump. Facebook’s attorney, Dane Butswinkas, said the platform has come a long way since the Cambridge Analytica data breach. Facebook conducted independent investigations and tried to stop suspicious third parties from harvesting user data following revelations about how the data was used. The company also banned apps and referred suspicious developers to regulators, he said. The trial is expected to last around four weeks and will include a video deposition of Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg (left). The state is seeking the maximum civil penalties under New Mexico’s Unfair Practices Act, up to \$5,000 per violation, and an injunction to halt future breaches of user data. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

MEDIA

TRUMP’S MIDTERM CONVENTION MAY STRUGGLE FOR RATINGS AGAINST NFL KICKOFF



President Trump prides himself on his television ratings. But on Wednesday and Thursday night, his speeches at the Republicans’ midterm convention confront one of the few forces in American culture that reliably draws a bigger audience than the president: the National Football League. Trump’s remarks Wednesday night coincided with the first game of the NFL season, a Super Bowl rematch between the New England Patriots and the Seattle Seahawks. On Thursday night, Trump is scheduled to speak again during a San Francisco 49ers-Los Angeles Rams game that will be streaming on Netflix. Roughly 28 million people tuned in for last year’s NFL opener. The Republican gathering in Dallas this week, engineered by Trump as a party-boosting spectacle before the midterm elections, is likely to struggle to match the mass audiences that the traditional nominating conventions achieve in presidential election years. ABC, CBS, and NBC say they have no plans to preempt primetime shows for Wednesday or Thursday’s festivities, as they typically do for the quadrennial party conventions. CNN and MS NOW said they would air their usual evening programs and pivot to Dallas if news warranted. For those wanting to follow along in Dallas, countless streaming services and online outlets, including The New York Times, will carry a live feed. On cable, C-SPAN is planning full coverage, while simultaneously airing speeches by Democratic candidates on C-SPAN2. Fox News aired a special two-hour “Hannity” Wednesday night and will again on Thursday evening at 9 p.m. Several of the network’s other programs have relocated to the American Airlines Center in Dallas for the event. — NEW YORK TIMES

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The mystery behind N.H.’s troubled I-95 service plaza project

►NEW HAMPSHIRE
Continued from Page D1

“Not like we get a say, but we want it to highlight what we have to offer and be a good partner to our local business community,” he added.

The new plazas

The project involves two state-owned properties on I-95 in Hampton, one northbound and one southbound, where the existing New Hampshire Liquor & Wine Outlets operate.

According to the latest procurement documents, the existing facilities would be demolished and replaced with at least a 16,000-square-foot service building and a 22,000-square-foot liquor store at each location.

A private developer would finance, build, and operate the non-liquor-store portions of the plazas under a 35-year ground lease. The state would own and operate the new liquor stores. The New Hampshire Liquor Commission is the state’s sole retailer of spirits, with the system generating hundreds of millions of dollars in sales each year for state services.

The new plazas are envisioned to include restaurants, convenience stores, fuel, EV charging, restrooms, visitor information, and parking for cars, trucks, and buses. The state also wants the design to reflect New Hampshire’s culture and tourism identity.

The properties already generate significant revenue. The two liquor stores bring in about \$45 million in annual revenue each year, according to the Liquor Commission, and the agency expects the new stores to generate even more.

The procurement process that got complicated

The Liquor Commission began looking for a private developer in late 2025.

By March of this year, two groups had emerged: The Common Man Roadside, the New Hampshire company behind the Hooksett Welcome Centers, and Massachusetts-based Global Partners, which partnered with Manchester developer Dick Anagnost.

Global Partners is no stranger to highway service-plaza fights. The Newton-based company lost a bid to redevelop and operate 18 Massachusetts service plazas, sued MassDOT over the decision, and is now watching the state go through the procurement again after the winning bidder, Applegreen, pulled out.

But in New Hampshire, the first procurement soon ran into its own problems.

On April 24, the commission canceled the procurement after the New Hampshire Department of Justice identified a “procedural deficiency” that affected the review of all submissions.

The commission issued a new solicitation in May.

Both Common Man and the Anagnost-Global team resubmitted their proposals. But this time, it appears that Common Man did not make the shortlist.

On July 31, the commission announced that one bidder had been selected to advance to the next stage, but did not identify the company.

“The RFP process is still ongoing, and by law, we cannot share additional details about the RFP participants at this time,” the commission said in a statement.

The Selection Committee for the NHLC is expected to recommend a bidder by Sept. 18, with a final award expected by the end of the year. The Long Range Capital Planning Commission must approve the recommendation, and the governor and Executive Council must then approve the final ground lease. The state hopes to open the new service plazas in 2028.

Global Partners declined to

comment. Anagnost said he could not discuss the bid because the details are being kept confidential.

“I’m a New Hampshire guy, I do [this] for a living,” Anagnost said when asked why he submitted a proposal.

The legal wrinkle

Common Man Roadside has sued the Liquor Commission over the procurement process, saying it faces “irreparable harm.”

The company filed a complaint in Merrimack Superior Court on Aug. 17. A closed hearing was held Sept. 1.

Much of that filing remains confidential because it contains what the complaint described as confidential business and financial information.

Last week, the court issued an order on a largely redacted petitioner’s reply denying the preliminary injunctive relief sought by Common Man, declining to halt the procurement process while the legal challenge proceeds.

The judge said Common Man had not established a sufficient likelihood of success on the merits of its legal challenge.

The court concluded that the commission “had a lawful and otherwise valid basis for the overarching action implicated by the Petitioner’s claims of error,” according to the summary of the order. The judge added that even if the NHLC “may have erred in other aspects of its determination,” that would not entitle Common Man to the extraordinary relief it was seeking.

The judge also said that, even if Common Man had shown a sufficient likelihood of success, an injunction would not be appropriate because state law provides a specific process for bidders to challenge errors in an agency’s vendor-selection process.

The court said halting the procurement through an injunction could conflict with that statutory framework and raise separation-of-powers concerns.

“This ruling reaffirms that the selection process has been comprehensive, deliberate, and most importantly, lawful,” the New Hampshire Liquor Commission said in response to the ruling.

The process, the commission said, was aided by experts and designed to evaluate bidders against “rigorous criteria,” including comprehensive financial disclosure and demonstrated access to capital required to “successfully build one of the most consequential pieces of real estate available in New Hampshire.”

Common Man has not responded to a request for comment on the lawsuit or the procurement process.

What locals want

Local business leaders say they were encouraged by Common Man’s initial proposal, particularly its plans to make the plazas feel connected to the Seacoast.

VanCamp and John Nyhan, president of the Hampton Area Chamber of Commerce, both wrote letters supporting Common Man during the earlier procurement.

Nyhan said he was disappointed to learn that Common Man had not advanced in the latest round of the process.

“I think everybody is deserving of [knowing] what the disqualification was because no one can tell us,” Nyhan said.

Regardless of who ultimately gets the contract, Nyhan said the state should view the plazas as more than just places to buy liquor.

“It’s a major travel stop for people looking for information on where to go, where to stay, and where to eat,” he said. “It’s much more than just a liquor store.”

Mass. recreational pot industry tops \$10b in gross sales

By Katie Castellani
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Ten years after voters legalized recreational marijuana in Massachusetts, the adult-use cannabis industry here has topped \$10 billion in gross sales, a milestone that comes as the industry faces myriad changes and challenges.

“So I’d say it’s a mixed bag. I don’t know if we necessarily want more people using intoxicating substances, whether they’re cannabis or alcohol or whatever,” Cannabis Control commissioner Anthony Wilson said Tuesday. “On the other hand, we’ve created a market that’s creating jobs, that’s providing a revenue to the state, and more importantly, feeding families, and is not having some of the negative, scary social impacts that people were worried about ten years ago.”

Voters approved the ballot measure regulating adult-use marijuana in November 2016, and the state’s first two retail stores opened around two years later. Leading up to the 2016 election, opponents — including Governor Maura Healey, who was attorney general at the time — raised public health and safety concerns about legalizing recreational marijuana.

Adult-use retailers, which include marijuana retail stores, delivery operators, and some microbusinesses, reached the \$10 billion mark on Saturday, according to CCC data.

The adult-use cannabis market “reliably generates” more than \$1.5 billion in gross sales each year, said CCC executive director Travis Ah-

ern.

“As the industry enters its next phase with new license types and operators, we look forward to continuing our mission of overseeing a safe, equitable cannabis market for Massachusetts consumers and patients,” Ahern said in a statement.

While the commission is working on implementing regulations allowing adults to consume marijuana products in public settings, voters in November will weigh in on a ballot question to repeal the legalization of non-medical marijuana.

Wilson said the question “doesn’t really come up at all in the building,” and commissioners are focused on regulating the market that’s in place.

“I would say if the ballot question passed, that would 100 percent affect the work that we do,” Wilson said. “I’m really big on destigmatizing the industry. So, you know, if it doesn’t pass, the numbers by which it doesn’t pass, I think, will say more towards those efforts.”

The Coalition for a Healthy Massachusetts, the campaign backing the question, argues marijuana legalization has led to public health issues, higher rates of impaired driving, and presents greater risks for children, teens, and pets. A recent UMass/WCVB poll found that 55 percent of the 800 registered voters opposed the proposal and 33 percent said they supported it.

As far as access, Wilson said more widespread availability of products and falling prices have



STEVEN SENNE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The milestone comes as a question on November’s midterm ballot will determine whether to repeal legal status or keep laws the same.

made recreational cannabis easier for consumers to get. As of September, 300 of the state’s 351 municipalities have either a physical retailer or allow cannabis delivery, according to the CCC.

“So, we’ve got a pretty good market saturation in terms of access, in terms of dispensaries sprinkled across the state, so more people are closer to one than they had been previously, and then price has gone down precipitously in the past, I think five or six years,” he said. “So, it’s accessibility on two different levels: physical accessibility as well as financial accessibility.”

In April, the CCC voted to tem-

porarily freeze the issuance of cultivation licenses in an effort to help businesses in the face of declining prices and rising flower supply. At that point, the price per gram of flower hit a record low of \$3.89, according to CCC data. And prices fell to \$3.83 per gram in July.

Wilson said the market saturation needs to be studied more, but he would “certainly say the market is maturing.” He added that declining prices have coincided with when marijuana was legalized in other states.

“The moratorium is a pretty good step, but I would say I don’t actually think we really know con-

cretely if, you know, there really is oversaturation or just the natural maturity of the market because again we live in these bubbles — Massachusetts can’t sell to Connecticut, Connecticut cannot sell to Massachusetts,” Wilson said, referring to the licensing freeze. “Meanwhile, the same population of consumers can cross borders and buy it.”

CCC chairman Chris Harding said the industry is an “integral part” of the state economy.

“This is a significant moment for the Massachusetts adult-use industry and for the state. An industry that isn’t even a decade old has become an integral part of our economy, counting hundreds of businesses of all sizes and employing nearly 15,000 people,” Harding said in the press release on the \$10 billion sales threshold.

Adult-use cannabis products are subject to a 6.25 percent state sales tax and a 10.75 percent excise tax, while cities and towns that host licenses can also receive a local option tax up to 3 percent for their budgets. The state sales and excise tax revenues flow to the General Fund for legislative appropriation, MBTA, Massachusetts Small Business Association, the Cannabis Social Equity Trust Fund, and municipalities that host social equity licensees. Also, most excise tax revenues go to the Marijuana Regulation Fund for legislative allocation to several agencies and issues, including the CCC, public safety, and the Bureau of Substance Addiction Services.



JOHN TLUMACKI/BOSTON GLOBE

By law, nurses must give 10 days notice before a strike.

Nearly 2,000 BMC nurses to vote on potential strike

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Nearly 2,000 unionized nurses at Boston Medical Center will vote Wednesday and Thursday on whether to authorize a strike as union contract negotiations stall over pay and workplace safety.

The nurses, represented by 1199 of the Service Employees International Union, have been bargaining with management of New England’s largest safety-net hospital for more than six months, according to the union. Members, who work at BMC’s main campus and the BMC-affiliated Brockton Behavioral Health Center, say they’re among the lowest paid in Boston and that uncompetitive wages are making it hard to fill needed job openings.

“We’d rather be taking care of our patients than taking to the streets, but we will do whatever it takes to win the wages our families need to survive, staffing levels that ensure quality care for our patients, and safe workplaces for our co-workers,” said Carrie-Ann White, an intermediate care unit nurse at BMC.

In a statement, BMC said it remained committed to negotiating in good faith to reach a fair and sustainable contract. “At the same time, any agreement must reflect the significant financial pressures facing BMC, our health system, and the broader health care industry,” it said.

BMC stands to take an outsized financial hit as federal changes to Medicaid eligibility take effect in the coming months, which hospital representatives expect to increase the number of uninsured patients there, the Globe has previously reported. Roughly 40 percent of BMC’s patients are on Medicaid, the government insurer for the poor and disabled.

In May, BMC reported operating losses of \$41.7 million for the first six months of its fiscal year, worse than the \$30.4 million in losses for the same period the year before. BMC attributed much of the financial issues to its acquisition of two hospitals ravaged by underinvestment that were formerly owned by Steward Health Care, which declared bankruptcy in 2024.

If the nurses vote to authorize a strike, that would not necessarily guarantee a walkout, but it would

give the union the ability to schedule one. By law, health care unions must notify hospitals of a strike at least 10 days in advance to allow the facilities time to minimize interruptions to patient care.

The move by the BMC union is the latest action by nurses in Massachusetts who are demanding higher pay to keep up with the state’s high cost of living.

Earlier this summer, nearly 4,000 nurses at Brigham and Women’s Hospital walked off the job in the state’s largest nurses strike in history. The one-day strike stretched into a five-day saga after the Brigham, one of Mass General Brigham’s two flagship hospitals, locked out the striking nurses. The union, represented by the Massachusetts Nurses Association, and the health system still have not reached an agreement.

Nurses at UMass Memorial Medical Center’s University Campus in Worcester authorized a 14-day strike in early July over chronic staffing shortages. The union, which has not gone on strike, is seeking more competitive wages to recruit and retain staff.

The BMC union picketed in late July alongside unionized doctors in training in an effort to move management toward an agreement.

At the picket, Kristen Lawlor-Emus, who had worked as a registered nurse at BMC since 2003, said she made above \$100,000 a year after more than two decades on the job. That’s a far cry from what nurses at other hospitals can make, Lawlor-Emus said. At the Brigham, for instance, nurses with the same tenure can make at least \$220,000, according to Mass General Brigham.

A group of Massachusetts legislators sent a letter to BMC chief executive Dr. Alastair Bell on Aug. 25 urging the health leader to invest in nursing staff.

“Nurses have repeatedly demonstrated their commitment to the hospital’s mission and the community it serves,” the state legislators wrote in the letter. “They deserve a contract that reflects the value of their work and provides a foundation for long-term recruitment and retention.”

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Boston Dynamics spinoff betting on robot companions

By Beth Treffeisen
BOSTON.COM

A Boston Dynamics spinoff is combining advanced robotics and movie-style character design to create robots that can interact with people in real time.

Dynamic Creatures announced its creation Tuesday with plans to design and build interactive character robots for entertainment and hospitality businesses. The mobile robots will be designed to move naturally through guest environments, respond to people, and adapt to interactions as they happen.

“For decades we’ve fallen in love with characters brought to life by incredible creators,” chief executive Marc Theermann said in an announcement video. “From heartbreaking animations to thrilling superheroes and special effects, these movie characters have fueled our imagination and become part of our lives.”

As Theermann spoke, a purple robotic dog walked across the screen behind him, then turned toward the audience, offering a glimpse of the type of characters

the company hopes to create.

“At the same time, robotics pioneers like Marc Raibert and my friends at Boston Dynamics have taught machines to walk, run, see, and interact with the world around them,” Theermann said. “Today these worlds are finally coming together.”

Raibert is the executive director at RAI Institute and founder of Boston Dynamics.

Dynamic Creatures says it is combining robotics, animatronics, artificial intelligence, reinforcement learning, and storytelling to create characters that can move, interact, and build relationships with people.

“Over the next five years, robots will enter every aspect of our daily lives,” Theermann said. “Our goal isn’t simply to build better robots, but to create companions and redefine what it means to live together.”

The company is initially targeting theme parks and other location-based entertainment venues, such as hotels and resorts, casinos, museums, cultural institutions, cruise ships, and live



venues. It also plans to work with TV and movie studios and eventually could expand into luxury retail and automotive brand experience centers.

Other potential uses include roaming entertainment, brand ambassadors, concierge services, and personalized visitor experiences.

Dynamic Creatures said it is already working with a large theme park and a retailer on guest-facing character experiences designed to feel “personal, attentive, and memorable.” The company did not identify the partner.

The company is headquartered in Boston and is hiring locally.

“Dynamic Creatures is opening an important new frontier for advanced robotics,” said Amanda McMaster, interim chief executive of Boston Dynamics.

Dynamic Creatures chief executive Marc Theermann (left) and chief technology officer Farbod Farshidian have designed interactive robot pets as companions of the future, along with mechanical characters that could interact with people at theme parks.

FDA fills roles in drugs, vaccines, tobacco

By Matthew Perrone
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The administration of President Trump filled four senior positions at the US Food and Drug Administration on Tuesday, promoting several officials who had been serving in acting roles to permanently fill the spots, including the agency’s top leaders for drugs and vaccines.



AL DRAGO/NEW YORK TIMES

The appointments follow high-profile departures earlier this year.

er in the FDA’s psychiatric drug division before briefly leaving government to work at a nonprofit pursuing the development of psychedelic drugs. He returned to the FDA as a deputy director last year.

As the FDA’s top drug regulator, Davis will be in a position to oversee the review of a series of upcoming psychedelic drugs being studied for psychiatric conditions, including psilocybin, MDMA, and LSD. Both Trump and Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy have emphasized the need to speed up reviews of psychedelics.

HHS also named Karim Mikhail to take over as director of FDA’s vaccines center on a permanent basis. Mikhail, a pharmacist and longtime pharmaceutical executive, joined the FDA last spring and stepped into the vaccines spot after the resignation of Dr. Vinay Prasad.

Prasad stepped down in March following numerous controversies surrounding vaccines, gene therapies, and biotech drugs. It was his second time leaving the

role in less than a year, following complaints from biotech executives and patient groups over the handling of new drugs targeting rare diseases.

Prasad was also an outspoken critic of the agency’s approach to COVID-19 vaccines. Working with former Commissioner Dr. Marty Makary, Prasad developed stringent new requirements for the development of updated COVID-19 shots. Among other steps, the policy requires vaccine-makers to conduct new, lengthy studies before tweaked vaccines can be approved for healthy adults and children.

Makary resigned from the agency in May after months of complaints from health industry executives, antiabortion activists, and tobacco companies. The frustration with him came to a head over the agency’s lack of movement on flavored e-cigarettes, which are a priority for large and small vaping companies.

Since his departure, the agency has cleared a series of new products, including new varieties of nicotine pouches and e-cigarettes.

The agency announced that Bret Koplow, a career FDA official, would become director of the Center for Tobacco Products. He’d been serving in an acting role since the ouster of the previous director early in the Trump administration.

A fourth official, Jared Seehafer, will serve in a newly created position overseeing artificial intelligence and technology, according to the government announcement.



DOONESBURY by Garry Trudeau



DUSTIN by Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker



RED & ROVER by Brian Basset



ARCTIC CIRCLE by Alex Hallatt



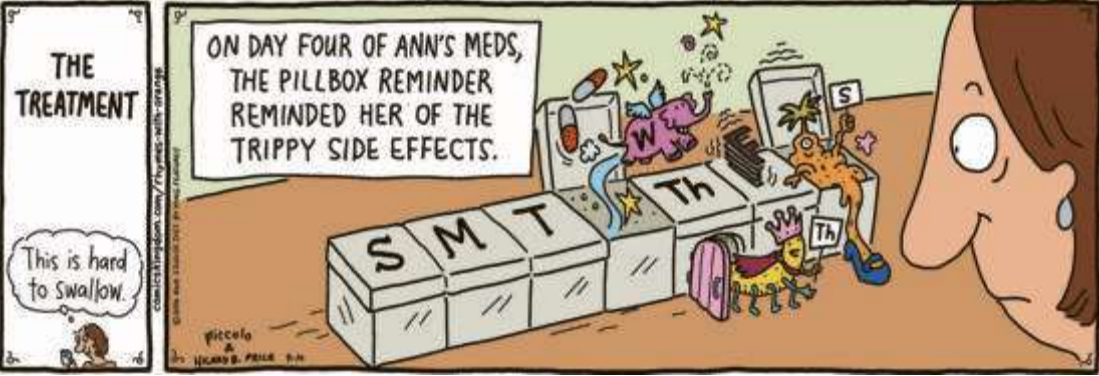
FOR BETTER OR FOR WORSE by Lynn Johnston



CURTIS by Ray Billingsley



RHYMES WITH ORANGE by Hilary Price



ARLO & JANIS by Jimmy Johnson



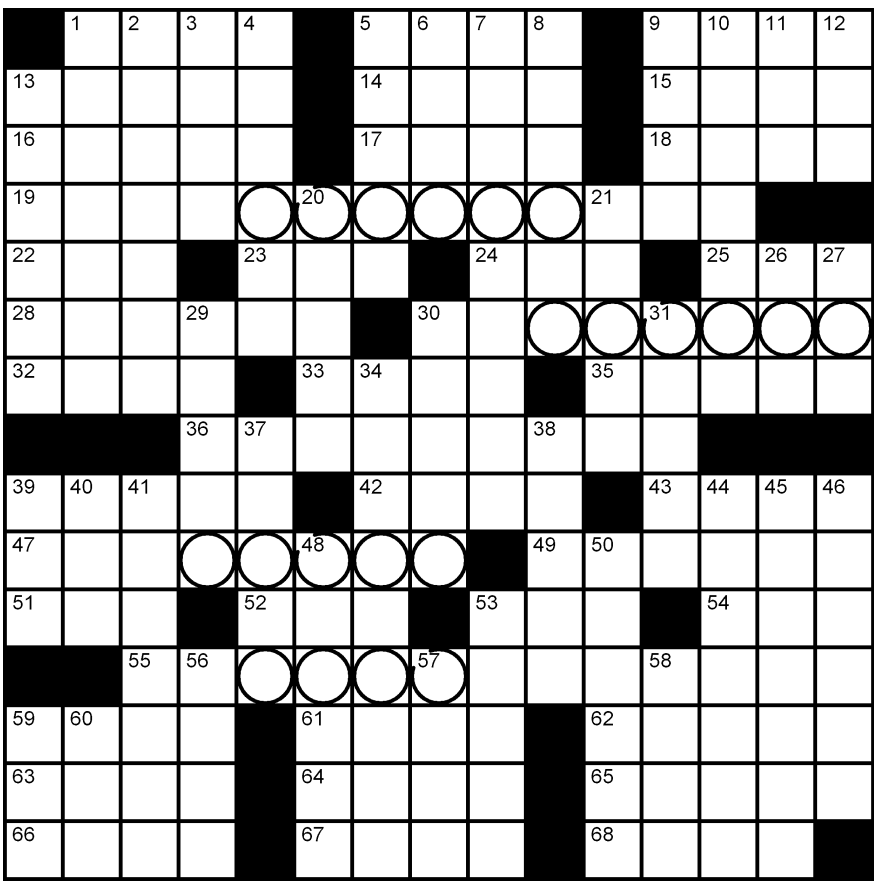
UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

WOULD YOU CARE TO DANCE? BY RICKY SIROIS | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

- ACROSS**
- Tailors' edges
 - "Hilarious!"
 - "Back in Black" band
 - The world's oldest-known boat is one
 - "The Wire" character who said, "You come at the king, you best not miss"
 - Forearm bone
 - Quality that's a plus
 - Took off
 - Bread with a palindromic name
 - Cloven-footed climbers (In this answer, note letters 5-10)
 - Newbery-winning author of "Crispin: The Cross of Lead"
 - Prior to, poetically
 - Ride the bench
 - Hero, by another name
 - Clap back
 - Singer with the band Cult Jam (... letters 3-8)
 - Cookie created to mimic Hydrox
 - X-rated material
 - Hurried along
 - Inquiry at a formal, and a theme hint
 - Plot of math class?
 - Pop star Dua
 - Stick in one's
 - Blissfully titled Zendaya show (... letters 4-8)

- Full-arm tattoo
- EGOT winner Brooks
- ___ milk
- Hawaiian souvenir
- Part of some German surnames
- Like Nelson Mandela's movement (... letters 3-6)
- Pasta in a baked dish
- Scissors' sound
- Moore of "This Is Us"
- "Awesome!"
- Treats, as a sprained ankle
- Impulses
- Cold and wet
- Manhattan finance inits.
- One of up to 4 million, for an orchid

- DOWN**
- Hosts in one's home
 - Connected, as a bathroom
 - Faucet brand
 - Volleyball position
 - TV host Mandel
 - "You got that right!"
 - Retires
 - Stella ___ (beer brand)
 - Father's sister
 - Word that differentiated "Coca-Cola" from New Coke
 - Double-helix molecule
 - Has the ability
 - Chevy muscle car
 - Creatively pretentious
 - Home video game pioneer



- Employ
- Spoiled
- Pizzazz
- Saint ___ (Caribbean island)
- Knight stick?
- Tendency toward aggressive tactics
- Something hilarious

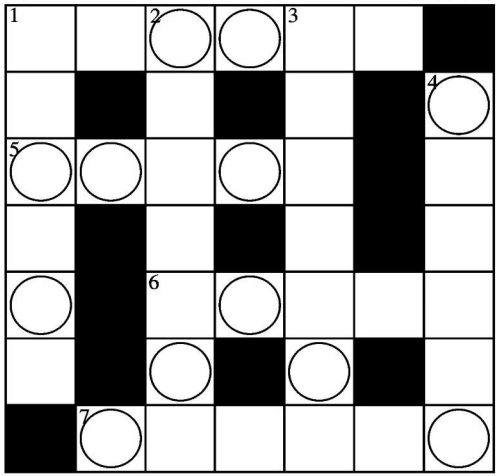
- Stunning weapon
- Precious stone
- Bemoan
- HS course that covers the Aeneid
- "A dish best served cold"
- Sidestepped
- Baconator's chain

- Dried grape
- Decisive kind of test
- Run out
- Small cut
- Pizzas, e.g.
- Long-eared leaper
- Canadian alphabet ending
- "Hazy" brew

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt

9-10-26



CLUE

ACROSS

ANSWER

- ___ ship
- Fad
- Feature, attribute
- Short ___

CLUE

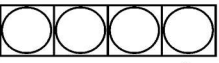
DOWN

ANSWER

- Flinch, shrink
- Seaside
- Raise
- Unsettle

BONUS

CLUE: This product was introduced by Nabisco in 1934.



How to play
Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.
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ANSWERS: 1A-Crazie 6A-Trait 7A-Grieve 1D-Recall 2D-Coastal 3D-Elevate 4D-Rattle B-Ritz Crackers
Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

